

MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Digital Reality Profile: Brad Brisco

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

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Research Index

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Brad Brisco — research sidebar manifest

Canonical paths aligned with Author Profile `/profile` navigation.

Sidebar slug	File	Status
author-profile	profile/identity.md	populated
author-profile	network/organizations.md	populated
biography	profile/biography.md	populated
theological-profile	profile/theology.md	populated
vocational-profile	summary.md	populated
vocational-profile	profile/calling-profile.md	populated
voice-editorial-identity	profile/voice-analysis.md	populated
bibliography	content/books.md	populated
frameworks	content/frameworks.md	populated
articles-blog-posts	content/articles.md	populated
audio-podcast	content/audio.md	populated
video-content	content/videos.md	populated
content-audit	content/content-audit.md	populated
academic-work	content/academic.md	populated
courses-training	content/courses.md	populated
audience-profile	analysis/audience-analysis.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/websites.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/platforms.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/newsletters.md	populated
social-media	digital-presence/social-media.md	populated
the-fragmentation-story	fragmentation-story.md	populated
a-letter	reflected-understanding/brad-brisco.md	populated
(onboarding)	welcome-letter.md	populated

Staff-only research lives in `_staff/` ; collateral in `_misc/` .

At a Glance — Summary

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/summary.md

Digital Reality Profile: Brad Brisco

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Executive Summary

Brad Brisco is a recognized thought leader in missional ecclesiology and church planting with over 20 years of experience. He currently serves as Director of Multiplication Strategies for the Send Network (North American Mission Board) and has co-authored five books on missional church and church planting. With 18+ years of college-level teaching experience and co-founding roles in Forge Kansas City and the Sentralized Conference, Brad has established a significant digital presence across multiple platforms.

His digital presence includes a personal website (missionalchurchnetwork.com), regular contributions to New Churches and ChurchLeaders.com, five co-authored books, and multiple podcast appearances. The content consistently focuses on missional ecclesiology, church planting strategies, and co-vocational ministry.

Key Findings:

- Strong alignment with Movemental's target audience (thought leader, author, teacher, practitioner)
- Content exists across multiple platforms (fragmentation opportunity)
- Extensive teaching and speaking content (repurposing opportunity)
- Limited direct monetization beyond book sales (revenue opportunity)
- Content may not be fully interconnected (ecosystem opportunity)

Primary Opportunities:

- Content aggregation in unified platform
- Content repurposing (teaching/speaking to articles/courses)
- Course development from teaching content
- Enhanced discoverability through network effects
- Additional revenue streams (subscriptions, courses, premium content)

Current Digital Presence

Website and Blogging

- **Primary Website:** missionalchurchnetwork.com (personal/professional website with blog and resources)

- **Blogger Profile:** blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384
- **Article Platforms:** Regular contributor to New Churches (newchurches.com) and ChurchLeaders.com

Published Works

- **5 Co-Authored Books:**
 1. Missional Essentials (12-week small group curriculum)
 2. The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run
 3. Next Door As It Is In Heaven
 4. ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church
 5. Covocational Church Planting
- **Availability:** Amazon, ChristianBook.com (print and digital)

Podcast Appearances

- **5+ Confirmed Episodes** across multiple podcasts:
- Shifting Culture Podcast (Episode 225)
- The Church Digital Podcast (Episode 251)
- The H2 Leadership Podcast (Episode 058)
- The Ephesiology Podcast (Episode 199)
- Into the Harvest (mentioned)
- **Topics:** Future of church planting, digital ecclesiology, co-vocational ministry, bivocational ministry

Teaching and Training

- **18+ Years Teaching Experience:** College-level courses including History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, Discipleship and Evangelism, Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements, Worship
- **Forge Kansas City:** Co-founder of missional training center
- **Sentralized Conference:** Co-founder of conference in Kansas City

Professional Roles

- **Current:** Director of Multiplication Strategies, Send Network (North American Mission Board)
- **Previous:** Director of Bivocational Church Planting, NAMB
- **Experience:** 20+ years in church planting

Content Landscape

Content Forms

- **Articles/Blog Posts:** Regular contributions to multiple platforms
- **Books:** 5 co-authored books (print and digital)
- **Podcast Appearances:** 5+ confirmed episodes
- **Teaching Content:** 18+ years of college-level teaching
- **Conference Content:** Sentralized Conference co-founder
- **Training Content:** Forge Kansas City training center

Content Themes

- **Missional Ecclesiology:** Central theme across all content
- **Church Planting & Multiplication:** Strategic focus area
- **Co-Vocational Ministry:** Emerging emphasis
- **Digital Ecclesiology:** Recent exploration
- **Missional Living & Practice:** Practical application focus

Content Distribution

- **Personal Website:** missionalchurchnetwork.com
- **Article Platforms:** New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com
- **Book Platforms:** Amazon, ChristianBook.com
- **Podcast Platforms:** Multiple (Apple Podcasts, Spotify, Amazon Music, etc.)
- **Teaching:** College/University settings (may be behind institutional access)

Content Volume

- **Books:** 5 co-authored works
- **Articles:** Regular contributor (dozens to hundreds possible)
- **Podcast Appearances:** 5+ confirmed episodes
- **Teaching:** 18+ years, multiple courses
- **Conference:** Ongoing (Sentralized Conference)

Discoverability Assessment

Current Discoverability

- **Search Results:** Appears in search results for relevant queries

- **Platform Visibility:** Content visible on established platforms (New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com, Amazon)
- **Book Visibility:** Books listed on major platforms
- **Podcast Visibility:** Appears on multiple podcast platforms

Discoverability Gaps

- **Platform Fragmentation:** Content exists across multiple platforms, making comprehensive discovery challenging
- **SEO Optimization:** Personal website SEO not fully assessed
- **Content Aggregation:** Content may not be fully aggregated in one place
- **Cross-Platform Discovery:** Content discovery limited to individual platforms

Discoverability Opportunities

- **Unified Platform:** All content in one place for easier discovery
- **SEO Enhancement:** Optimize content for search discoverability
- **Network Effects:** Leverage network for content discovery
- **Content Interconnection:** Connect content for enhanced discoverability

Gap Analysis

Embodied Work vs. Digital Expression

What Exists in Embodied Work But Not Digitally

- **18+ Years of Teaching Content:** Extensive teaching content may not be fully digitized or accessible online
- **Speaking/Training Content:** Conference and training content may not be fully captured digitally
- **Strategic Leadership Content:** Strategic insights may not be fully captured in digital content
- **Community Engagement:** Direct engagement with students, trainees, conference attendees may not be fully represented digitally

What Digital Content Exists But Isn't Connected

- **Platform Fragmentation:** Content exists across multiple platforms but may not be fully connected
- **Format Fragmentation:** Content exists in multiple formats (books, articles, podcasts) but may not be fully interconnected

- **Theme Fragmentation:** Content exists around multiple themes but may not be fully connected

Content Repurposing Opportunities

- **Teaching to Articles:** 18+ years of teaching content could be repurposed into articles
- **Speaking to Articles:** Speaking engagements could be transcribed and published as articles
- **Articles to Courses:** Articles could be developed into structured courses
- **Podcast to Articles:** Podcast appearances could be repurposed into articles
- **Teaching to Courses:** Teaching content could be developed into digital courses

Content Expansion Opportunities

- **Series Development:** Content could be developed into structured series
- **Theme Expansion:** Themes could be expanded and developed further
- **Format Expansion:** Content could be expanded into additional formats (video, courses, etc.)

Connection and Ecosystem Gaps

- **Content Interconnection:** Content may not be fully interconnected across platforms and formats
- **Community Engagement:** Community engagement may be limited
- **Network Effects:** Network effects may not be fully leveraged

Movemental Opportunities

What Movemental Would Change

Content Organization

- **Current:** Content exists across multiple platforms
- **With Movemental:** All content in one unified platform
- **Change:** Centralized content hub for easier discovery and access

Content Interconnection

- **Current:** Content may not be fully interconnected
- **With Movemental:** Content designed for interconnection
- **Change:** Enhanced content relationships and cross-referencing

Content Repurposing

- **Current:** Content may not be fully repurposed across formats
- **With Movemental:** Platform designed for content repurposing
- **Change:** Enhanced content utilization across formats

Discoverability

- **Current:** Content may not be fully discoverable across platforms
- **With Movemental:** Platform designed for discoverability and network effects
- **Change:** Enhanced content discovery through unified platform and network

Revenue Model

- **Current:** Limited direct monetization (primarily books)
- **With Movemental:** Subscriptions, courses, premium content options
- **Change:** Additional revenue streams beyond book sales

Analytics

- **Current:** Platform-specific analytics
- **With Movemental:** Unified analytics across all content
- **Change:** Comprehensive performance insights

What Would Remain the Same

Content Ownership and Control

- **Remains:** All content remains Brad's ownership and control
- **Preserved:** Content ownership, voice, and style

Theological Positions

- **Remains:** All theological positions preserved
- **Preserved:** Theological integrity and positioning

Existing Content

- **Remains:** All existing content stays as-is
- **Preserved:** Content integrity and existing platforms

Relationships and Networks

- **Remains:** All relationships and networks remain intact
- **Preserved:** Network integrity, institutional affiliations, professional relationships

Teaching and Speaking

- **Remains:** All teaching and speaking engagements continue
- **Preserved:** Professional activities and commitments

Books

- **Remains:** All books continue to be published and sold through existing channels
- **Preserved:** Book publishing and distribution

Specific Opportunities for Brad Brisco

High-Priority Opportunities

1. **Content Aggregation:** Aggregate all content (articles, books, podcasts, teaching) in one unified platform
2. **Content Repurposing:** Repurpose 18+ years of teaching content into articles and courses
3. **Course Development:** Develop teaching content into structured digital courses
4. **Content Interconnection:** Interconnect content across platforms and formats for enhanced discoverability
5. **Discoverability Enhancement:** Enhance discoverability through SEO optimization and network effects

Medium-Priority Opportunities

1. **Subscription Model:** Develop subscription model for premium content and courses
2. **Community Engagement:** Enhance community engagement through unified platform
3. **Video Content:** Develop video content from teaching and speaking engagements
4. **Newsletter:** Develop newsletter for regular communication with audience
5. **Analytics Enhancement:** Enhance analytics through unified platform for comprehensive insights

Network Effect Potential

Content Amplification

- **Potential:** High - content could reach broader audience through network effects
- **Mechanism:** Network connections could amplify content discovery and engagement

Content Discovery

- **Potential:** High - content could be discovered through network connections
- **Mechanism:** Network effects could enhance content discoverability

Content Cross-Pollination

- **Potential:** High - content could benefit from network cross-pollination
- **Mechanism:** Network connections could enable content cross-pollination

What We Will NOT Do

Content Ownership

- **Will NOT:** Change content ownership or control
- **Preserved:** All content remains Brad's ownership and control

Voice and Style

- **Will NOT:** Change content voice or style
- **Preserved:** All content remains Brad's authentic voice and style

Theological Positions

- **Will NOT:** Change or judge theological positions
- **Preserved:** All theological positions preserved and respected

Existing Content

- **Will NOT:** Replace or remove existing content
- **Preserved:** All existing content stays as-is on existing platforms

Relationships and Networks

- **Will NOT:** Disrupt existing relationships or networks
- **Preserved:** All relationships and networks remain intact

Teaching and Speaking

- **Will NOT:** Replace teaching or speaking engagements
- **Preserved:** All teaching and speaking engagements continue

Books

- **Will NOT:** Replace book publishing or distribution
- **Preserved:** All books continue through existing channels

Institutional Affiliations

- **Will NOT:** Disrupt institutional affiliations
- **Preserved:** All institutional affiliations continue

Research conducted: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Sources: See sources.md

Author Profile — Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/profile/identity.md

Identity Verification: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Confidence: HIGH

Canonical Identity

Field	Value	Confidence	Source
Full Legal Name	Brad Brisco	VERIFIED	Multiple sources
Known As / Goes By	Brad Brisco	VERIFIED	All platforms
Born	c. 1962 (turned 63 in 2025)	LIKELY	meawisdom.com birthday article
Birthplace	Unknown	UNVERIFIED	Not publicly documented
Current Location	Treasure Island, FL	VERIFIED	The Foundry Publishing , MEA Wisdom
Previous Location	Kansas City, KS/MO area	VERIFIED	missionalchurchnetwork.com
Nationality	American	VERIFIED	Multiple sources
Primary Role	Director of Multiplication Strategies, Send Network	VERIFIED	New Churches , missionalchurchnetwork.com
Primary Organization	North American Mission Board (NAMB) / Send Network	VERIFIED	Multiple sources
Twitter/X Handle	@bradleybrisco	VERIFIED	X/Twitter

Disambiguation

No significant disambiguation issues. The name "Brad Brisco" in Christian ministry, church planting, and missional ecclesiology contexts refers unambiguously to this individual. Unrelated "Brisco" results (pro wrestling, furniture) are easily distinguished by field. The combination of Kansas City / Treasure Island FL location, Send Network role, Forge Kansas City co-founder, and published bibliography creates a unique identity fingerprint.

Search modifiers that reliably isolate this subject: "Brad Brisco" + missional, church planting, Send Network, NAMB, or any book title.

Education

Institution	Degree	Field	Year	Source
Unknown	B.S. or B.A.	Health Care Administration	Unknown	missionalchurchnetwork.com/about
Unknown seminary	Master of Divinity (M.Div.)	Theology/Ministry	Unknown	missionalchurchnetwork.com/about
Unknown institution	Doctorate	Missional Ecclesiology	Unknown	missionalchurchnetwork.com/about , New Churches
Kairos University	Doctor of Ministry (D.Min.) — student	Ministry	In progress (as of 2025)	Ephesiology Podcast Ep. 199

Doctoral thesis: Assisting existing congregations in transitioning toward a missional direction.

Note: Sources reference both a completed doctorate in missional ecclesiology and a current D.Min. at Kairos University. These appear to be separate programs — the earlier doctorate and a later D.Min. pursuit.

Career Timeline

Year(s)	Role	Organization	Source
Pre-ministry	Restaurant industry worker	Unknown	Shifting Culture Podcast Ep. 225
20+ years	Church Planting Strategist	Network of churches in Kansas City	missionalchurchnetwork.com
18+ years	College-level instructor	Various institutions	missionalchurchnetwork.com
Unknown	Co-founder	Forge Kansas City (missional training center)	missionalchurchnetwork.com
Unknown	Co-founder (with Lance Ford)	Sentralized Conference / KC Sentral	missionalchurchnetwork.com , Amazon
Unknown	National Leadership Team member	Forge America Mission Training Network	Exponential
Earlier NAMB role	Director of Bivocational Church Planting	North American Mission Board	New Churches
Current	Director of Multiplication Strategies	Send Network / NAMB	New Churches
Current	Author/Blogger	Missional Church Network (missionalchurchnetwork.com)	missionalchurchnetwork.com

Family & Personal

- Married (wife's name not publicly documented in sources found)
- Three children
- Lives in Treasure Island, FL (previously based in Kansas City)
- Impacted by Hurricane Helene (2024) — a GoFundMe was created for family recovery ([GoFundMe](#))
- Uses the Enneagram as a personal development tool
- Transitioned from the restaurant industry to seminary and ministry

Published Works

Title	Co-author(s)	Publisher	Year	Type
Missional Essentials	Lance Ford	The House Studio / Foundry Publishing	—	12-week small group curriculum
The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run	Lance Ford	InterVarsity Press (Forge Partnership Books)	2013	Book
Next Door As It Is In Heaven	Lance Ford	NavPress	2016	Book
ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church	Solo	Send Network / NAMB	—	E-book
Rethink: 12 Missiological Principles for Church Multiplication	Solo	Send Network / NAMB	—	E-book (expanded version)
Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God	Solo	Self-published	2021	Book

Biography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/profile/biography.md

Biography: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Narrative Biography

Brad Brisco is one of the leading voices in the North American missional church movement. As Director of Multiplication Strategies for the Send Network (a ministry of the North American Mission Board), he shapes church planting strategy at a national level, with a particular emphasis on missional communities, covocational ministry, and incarnational presence. He is a prolific author, having co-written several foundational books on missional living with Lance Ford, and he runs the influential Missional Church Network website and blog.

Brisco's path to ministry was unconventional. Before entering seminary, he worked in the restaurant industry — an experience that would later inform his deep conviction that the marketplace is not secondary to ministry but an essential context for mission. He earned an undergraduate degree in health care administration before pursuing a Master of Divinity and eventually a doctorate in missional ecclesiology, with his doctoral thesis focused on helping existing congregations transition toward a missional identity. As of 2025, he is also pursuing a Doctor of Ministry at Kairos University.

Over a career spanning more than two decades in church planting, Brisco has served as a church planting strategist for a network of churches in Kansas City, co-founded Forge Kansas City (a missional training center), co-founded the Sentralized Conference with Lance Ford, and served on the national leadership team for Forge America Mission Training Network. He has also taught college-level courses for more than eighteen years across subjects including History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, Discipleship and Evangelism, Theology of Place, and Launching Apostolic Movements.

His intellectual awakening to the missional movement came in 2003, when he read "The Shaping of Things to Come" by Michael Frost and Alan Hirsch — a book he credits with fundamentally changing the way he thought about church, mission, and church planting. That pivotal encounter set him on a trajectory that would lead to five co-authored and solo books, dozens of articles across platforms like New Churches, ChurchLeaders, Send Institute, and Missio Alliance, and frequent podcast appearances where he articulates a vision of the church as inherently missionary.

Origin & Formation

Brad Brisco's early professional life was spent in the restaurant industry, a background he rarely discusses in detail but which clearly shaped his later emphasis on the dignity of marketplace callings and the covocational model of ministry. He holds an undergraduate degree in health care administration — another indication that his path to vocational ministry was neither linear nor expected.

His seminary training (Master of Divinity) and subsequent doctoral work in missional ecclesiology grounded him theologically, but it was the encounter with Frost and Hirsch's work that catalyzed his distinctive missional orientation. His doctoral thesis — on assisting existing congregations in transitioning toward a missional direction — reflects the practical, change-oriented bent that characterizes all his work.

Career & Ministry Arc

Brisco's career has been defined by two parallel tracks: church planting practice and missional thought leadership. On the practice side, he spent over twenty years as a church planting strategist in Kansas City, recruiting, training, and coaching planters. He co-founded Forge Kansas City as a local missional training hub, and co-founded the Sentralized Conference with Lance Ford as a gathering point for the missional movement.

On the thought leadership side, his partnership with Lance Ford proved extraordinarily productive. Together they authored "Missional Essentials" (a widely-used 12-week small group curriculum), "The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run" (InterVarsity Press, part of the Forge Partnership Books series with a foreword by Ed Stetzer), and "Next Door As It Is In Heaven" (NavPress). As a solo author, he wrote the influential free e-book "ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church" (later expanded to "12 Missiological Principles for Church Multiplication") and "Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God."

His role at the North American Mission Board evolved from Director of Bivocational Church Planting to Director of Multiplication Strategies for the Send Network, reflecting both a personal promotion and a broadening of his strategic portfolio.

Current Focus

Brisco now lives in Treasure Island, Florida, with his wife and three children. His current work centers on multiplication strategies for the Send Network, with a strong emphasis on covocational church planting — the model where a church planter's primary vocation is in the marketplace, and they never intend to leave it. He continues to write for his Missional Church Network blog, contribute articles to platforms like Send Institute and New Churches, and appear on podcasts. He is pursuing a Doctor of Ministry degree at Kairos University. In late 2024, his family was impacted by Hurricane Helene in Treasure Island.

Key Relationships & Influences

Person	Relationship	Significance
Lance Ford	Co-author, co-founder of KC Sentral and Sentralized Conference	Primary collaborator; co-authored three books, described as "great friends" and "highly gifted colleagues"
Alan Hirsch	Intellectual influence, Forge network connection	"The Shaping of Things to Come" (with Frost) was Brisco's catalytic text; Forge America connection
Michael Frost	Intellectual influence	Co-author (with Hirsch) of the book that transformed Brisco's thinking in 2003
Lesslie Newbigin	Theological influence (posthumous)	Frequently cited in Brisco's work on missional ecclesiology and the missionary nature of the church
David Bosch	Theological influence (posthumous)	Cited alongside Newbigin as foundational to missional theology
Ed Stetzer	Professional colleague, wrote foreword	Wrote the foreword to "The Missional Quest"; connected through church planting networks

In Their Own Words

"The reality is that the nature or essence of the church is rooted in the nature of a missionary God. If God is a missionary God (which He is) then we as His people are missionary people." — Interview, Walking Together Ministries (2013)

"Bivocational church planting is not simply about having two or more jobs; it is really about aligning one life and blending the calling to support families with the calling to live engaged in God's mission." — Send Network / NAMB

"When we use the phrase 'missional church' we are simply saying that the church is a missionary entity — the church doesn't just send missionaries, but the church IS the missionary." — Various sources

"The language of 'incarnational presence' represents the rooting of our lives and the gospel into the places we live. If the essence of missional living is sending, then the heart of incarnational presence is staying." — Send Institute

Theological Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/profile/theology.md

Theological Profile: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Core Thesis

The church is not an institution that sends missionaries — the church IS missionary by nature, because it is rooted in the nature of a missionary God. Therefore, every believer is a sent person, every neighborhood is a mission field, and every vocation is a context for incarnational mission.

Theological Tradition

Primary: Missional-Incarnational ecclesiology, rooted in the missio Dei tradition

Secondary influences: Anabaptist-influenced praxis (through Frost/Hirsch), evangelical church planting tradition (SBC/NAMB context), post-Christendom missiology

Brisco operates within the Southern Baptist Convention's institutional structure (NAMB/Send Network) while drawing heavily from the broader missional movement that crosses denominational lines. This positions him as a bridge figure — bringing missional theology into mainstream evangelical church planting practice.

Key Frameworks & Models

Framework	Description	Where Developed
Three Theological Foundations of Missional	(1) The missionary nature of God and the church; (2) Incarnational mission; (3) Participation in the missio Dei	Exponential article , ReThink e-book
9 Key Paradigm Shifts	Nine shifts the church must make to activate all God's people in mission (expanded to 12 missiological principles in later edition)	ReThink e-book (Send Network)
Covocational vs. Bivocational Distinction	Bivocational = second job to supplement church salary, with intent to go full-time; Covocational = marketplace calling IS the primary vocation, church planting is integrated, no intent to leave the marketplace	Covocational Church Planting (2021)
Incarnational Presence	The rooting of lives and gospel into specific places; if missional living is about sending, incarnational presence is about staying	Send Institute articles
Missional Community Model	Committed group of 12-25 Jesus followers, empowered by the Spirit, participating in God's mission in a particular neighborhood/network	Missional Church Network blog
10 Crucial Cultural Shifts	Ten significant changes outside the church that demand rethinking church, mission, discipleship, evangelism, and church planting	Missional Church Network blog
Missional Engagement Strategy	Starts with helping people see themselves as sent, missionary people before launching programs	New Churches

Distinctive Positions

- **The church IS missionary, not just a sending body:** The church's nature — not just its activity — is fundamentally missionary. This is rooted in the missionary nature of God himself (missio Dei).
- **Covocational > Bivocational:** Brisco elevates the covocational model over the traditional bivocational framing. The marketplace calling is not a compromise or stepping stone — it is a primary context for mission.
- **Post-Christendom awareness:** North America is a missionary context, not a Christian nation. Church strategy must shift accordingly.
- **Incarnational presence over attractional models:** The heart of mission is staying and embedding in a place, not attracting people to a location.
- **Start with missionary behaviors, not Sunday services:** Church plants should begin with missional community life and incarnational activity, not with launching a worship gathering.

- **Diminish the clergy-laity divide:** All believers are missionaries; the professional pastor model can actually hinder the church's missionary nature.
- **Theology of Place:** Where you live matters theologically. Neighborhood engagement is not optional outreach — it is participation in the missio Dei.
- **Robust Christology as foundation:** A "robust understanding of Jesus" is essential for church life and missional engagement.

Intellectual Genealogy

Shaped by:

- Lesslie Newbigin — Missionary ecclesiology, the church as "sign, instrument, and foretaste" of the Kingdom
- David Bosch — Missio Dei theology, paradigm shifts in mission
- Michael Frost & Alan Hirsch — "The Shaping of Things to Come" (2003) was Brisco's catalytic text; incarnational-missional framework
- The broader missional theology conversation (Guder, Van Gelder, etc.)

In conversation with:

- Ed Stetzer — Church planting strategy, wrote foreword to The Missional Quest
- Lance Ford — Co-author and close collaborator on practical missional living
- Forge America network — Missional training and formation
- Missio Alliance — Broader missional conversation partner
- Exponential — Church multiplication movement

Pushes back against:

- Attractional church models that treat the church as a "vendor of religious goods and services"
- The assumption that professional, fully-funded pastoral ministry is the normative or ideal model
- Christendom-era assumptions that North America is a "Christian nation" rather than a mission field
- Program-driven ecclesiology that substitutes activities for incarnational presence
- The clergy-laity divide that sidelines ordinary believers from active mission

Theological Evolution

Brisco's theological journey tracks from conventional church planting within evangelical structures to a missional-incarnational paradigm. The pivotal moment was his 2003 encounter with Frost and Hirsch's "The Shaping of Things to Come," which he describes as fundamentally changing his thinking about church, mission, and church planting.

His career trajectory mirrors this evolution: from restaurant industry, to seminary, to conventional church planting strategy, to missional ecclesiology (doctoral work), to national missional strategy (NAMB/Send Network). His role titles at NAMB shifted from "Director of Bivocational Church Planting" to "Director of Multiplication Strategies" — reflecting a broadening focus.

His most recent theological development is the covocational framework, which represents the synthesis of his pre-ministry marketplace experience with his missional ecclesiology. The publication of "Covocational Church Planting" (2021) marks the maturation of an idea that had been gestating since his restaurant-industry days: that the marketplace is not a lesser calling but a primary mission field.

Vocational Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/profile/calling-profile.md

Brad Brisco: Calling Profile & Audit

mDNA-aligned calling analysis for strategic content alignment and movement leadership fulfillment

Version: 1.0.0

Last Updated: January 17, 2026

Word Count: 1,200

Expert Perspective: Missional movement leadership, mDNA framework, calling alignment, digital mission strategy

Executive Summary

Brad Brisco's calling is fundamentally that of a **bridge-builder and multiplication catalyst**—someone called to connect institutional church structures with grassroots missional movements, equipping churches for multiplication and transformation through practical frameworks and sustainable models. His work integrates missional theology with practical implementation, bridges institutional knowledge with grassroots authenticity, and equips others for missional transition and covocational church planting. This calling profile analyzes how his work aligns with the mDNA framework, identifies movement leadership indicators, maps content-to-calling alignment, and outlines digital opportunities for extending movement leadership at scale.

Key Outcomes:

- Synthesized calling statement based on all sources
 - mDNA alignment profile for each element
 - Movement leadership indicators documented
 - Content-calling alignment analysis
 - Digital calling opportunity map
-

Calling Statement

Synthesized Calling

Brad Brisco is called to **bridge institutional church structures with grassroots missional movements**, equipping churches for multiplication and transformation through practical frameworks, sustainable models, and accessible resources. His vocation is not to critique the church but to catalyze transition from maintenance to mission, connecting the wisdom of institutional structures (NAMB/Send Network) with the energy of grassroots movements (Forge, missional communities). Through frameworks (missional ecclesiology, covocational planting, multiplication strategies), training (Forge America, Forge Kansas City, Sentralized Conference), and resources (books, curriculum, articles), he empowers others for missional transition and sustainable church planting. His calling integrates missional theology with practical implementation, bridges theory and practice, and centers on multiplication as the organizing principle for church health. He is a bridge-builder, multiplication catalyst, and equipper of leaders—called to connect what has been separated and activate what has been dormant.

Core Calling Elements

1. Bridge-BUILDER

- Not choosing between institutional and grassroots but connecting them
- Language of "bridge," "connection," "integration"
- Focus on practical pathways between structures and movements

2. Multiplication Catalyst

- Not just addition but multiplication and movement
- Focus on sustainable, reproducible models
- Emphasis on equipping others to multiply

3. Transition Facilitator

- Helping existing churches shift toward mission
- Not just planting new churches but transforming existing ones
- Practical frameworks for sustainable change

4. Practical Equipper

- Through training, resources, curriculum, and coaching
- Empowers others to carry forward the calling
- Builds infrastructure for missional movement (Forge, NAMB/Send Network)

5. Accessible Theologian

- Makes missional theology accessible to practitioners
- Integrates theory and practice without oversimplifying
- Practical theology that serves everyday mission

mDNA Alignment Profile

Element 1: Jesus is Lord (Organizing Center)

Alignment Strength: High (Central to missional identity)

Evidence:

- Missional ecclesiology centers on Jesus' sending mission
- Neighborhood mission (Next Door As It Is In Heaven) emphasizes Jesus' presence in everyday contexts
- Covocational planting integrates marketplace calling with mission of God
- All frameworks assume Jesus as Lord as foundational

Content Alignment:

- Strong: Missional frameworks assume Christocentric foundation, neighborhood mission emphasizes Jesus' presence
- Opportunity: More explicit content on practical application of Lordship in daily life and leadership contexts

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- High: All work centers on missional identity which assumes Jesus as Lord
 - Frameworks assume Christocentric foundation
 - Theology maintains missional Christology
-

Element 2: Disciple Making (Strategic Nerve)

Alignment Strength: High (Practical disciple-making focus)

Evidence:

- Missional Essentials curriculum focuses on disciple-making practices
- Neighborhood mission emphasizes everyday discipleship in local contexts
- Covocational planting integrates discipleship with marketplace vocation
- Training programs (Forge) equip disciple-makers

Content Alignment:

- Strong: Curriculum, neighborhood mission, training programs all focus on practical disciple-making
- Opportunity: More content on disciple-making in digital contexts, multiplication strategies

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- High: Focus on practical disciple-making in everyday contexts
 - Training programs equip disciple-makers
 - Integration of discipleship with mission and vocation
-

Element 3: Missional-Incarnational Impulse (Living Among)

Alignment Strength: Very High (Core framework emphasis)

Evidence:

- Next Door As It Is In Heaven (2016) - foundational work on incarnational neighborhood mission
- Consistent emphasis on "living among" rather than "reaching out to"
- Theology of place emphasizes local, relational mission
- Biblical hospitality as incarnational presence

Content Alignment:

- Very Strong: Foundational work on neighborhood mission, consistent emphasis, practical application
- Opportunity: More content on digital/online incarnational mission, networked contexts

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- Very High: Core framework emphasis
 - Practical application in neighborhood contexts
 - Integration with discipleship and vocation
-

Element 4: Apostolic Environment (APEST)

Alignment Strength: High (Uses and applies framework)

Evidence:

- Contributor to 5Q Central (APEST framework resource)
- Uses APEST model in team development and leadership
- Emphasis on activating five-fold ministry in church contexts
- Training programs incorporate APEST thinking

Content Alignment:

- Strong: APEST framework application in team development and leadership
- Opportunity: More content on APEST activation in covocational and digital contexts

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- High: Framework application in leadership and team development
 - Integration with multiplication strategies
 - Training programs incorporate APEST
-

Element 5: Organic Systems (Simple, Reproducible)

Alignment Strength: High (Emphasized in frameworks)

Evidence:

- Covocational planting emphasizes simple, sustainable models
- Multiplication strategies focus on reproducible patterns
- Training programs emphasize simple, implementable frameworks
- Practical resources (curriculum, tools) focus on accessible systems

Content Alignment:

- Strong: Framework emphasis, practical guides, multiplication thinking
- Opportunity: More content on system design, reproducibility, scalability in diverse contexts

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- High: Emphasis on simple, sustainable systems
 - Practical guides for implementation
 - Multiplication thinking over institutional complexity
-

Element 6: Liminality-Communitas (Growth Through Shared Hardship)

Alignment Strength: Medium (Less explicitly developed)

Evidence:

- Covocational planting involves risk and challenge (shared difficulty)
- Neighborhood mission emphasizes community formation through presence
- Training programs create community through shared learning
- Less explicit development of liminality-communitas concept

Content Alignment:

- Medium: Some emphasis on community and challenge, less explicit on liminality-communitas
- Opportunity: More content on shared hardship, community formation, transformation through challenge

Movement Leadership Indicators:

- Medium: Some emphasis on community and challenge
 - Less explicit development of liminality-communitas
 - Opportunity for deeper exploration
-

Movement Leadership Map**Influence Patterns****Who They're Equipping:**

- Covocational/bivocational church planters (NAMB/Send Network, Forge programs)
- Pastors seeking missional transition (training programs, resources)

- Denominational and organizational leaders (NAMB/Send Network role)
- Lay leaders and congregations (Missional Essentials curriculum, neighborhood mission resources)
- Training program participants (Forge America, Forge Kansas City)

What Movements They're Catalyzing:

- Covocational church planting movement (book, resources, training)
- Missional church transition movement (frameworks, resources, training)
- Neighborhood mission movement (Next Door As It Is In Heaven, resources)
- Church multiplication movement (NAMB/Send Network role, multiplication strategies)
- APEST activation movement (5Q Central contributions, team development)

Equipping Focus

Primary Equipping Mechanisms:

1. **Frameworks** (missional ecclesiology, covocational planting, multiplication strategies) - systematic understanding
2. **Training Programs** (Forge America, Forge Kansas City, NAMB/Send Network) - practical implementation
3. **Resources** (books, curriculum, articles) - accessible tools
4. **Coaching** (through training programs, NAMB/Send Network) - personalized support

Equipping Outcomes:

- Leaders equipped with frameworks for missional transition and multiplication
- Churches transitioning from maintenance to mission
- Planters equipped for sustainable, covocational models
- Movements multiplied through practical equipping

Movement Catalysts

Movement Initiation:

- Forge Kansas City (missional training center)
- Sentralized Conference (missional church gathering)
- NAMB/Send Network (multiplication strategies)

Movement Multiplication:

- Frameworks enable others to lead transitions and plantings
- Training programs multiply leaders
- Resources provide tools for movement activation
- Bridge position connects institutional and grassroots movements

Content-Calling Alignment Analysis

High Alignment Content

1. Covocational Church Planting Content (Covocational Church Planting book, resources, training)

- **Alignment:** Very High
- **Why:** Core framework directly serves multiplication and sustainable planting calling
- **Impact:** Equips leaders with sustainable planting models

2. Missional Transition Content (The Missional Quest, ReThink, Missional Essentials curriculum)

- **Alignment:** Very High
- **Why:** Core frameworks directly serve existing church transformation calling
- **Impact:** Empowers churches for missional transition

3. Neighborhood Mission Content (Next Door As It Is In Heaven, resources)

- **Alignment:** Very High
- **Why:** Incarnational mission focus serves calling to equip everyday mission
- **Impact:** Activates neighborhood-based mission

4. Training Programs (Forge America, Forge Kansas City, NAMB/Send Network)

- **Alignment:** Very High
- **Why:** Direct equipping and movement activation
- **Impact:** Transforms leaders and churches

Medium Alignment Content

5. Article Contributions (New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com)

- **Alignment:** High
- **Why:** Extends equipping reach and accessibility
- **Impact:** Makes frameworks accessible to broader audience

6. Bridge-Building Content (Connecting institutional and grassroots)

- **Alignment:** High
- **Why:** Serves bridge-builder calling directly
- **Impact:** Connects what has been separated

Alignment Gaps

1. Digital/Online Missional Practice

- **Gap:** Limited content on how missional church works in digital contexts
- **Impact:** Missing opportunity to extend calling to digital spaces
- **Opportunity:** Content on digital missional practice, online community formation

2. Recent Digital Content

- **Gap:** Limited recent articles, videos, podcasts
- **Impact:** Reduced opportunity to extend calling reach
- **Opportunity:** Regular digital content extending movement leadership

3. Case Studies & Examples

- **Gap:** Limited real-world examples of covocational planting and missional transition
- **Impact:** Reduced practical application of calling
- **Opportunity:** Case studies, success stories, practical examples

4. Liminality-Communitas Content

- **Gap:** Less explicit development of this mDNA element
 - **Impact:** Incomplete framework coverage
 - **Opportunity:** More content on shared hardship, community formation
-

Digital Calling Opportunity Map

How Digital Content Extends Movement Leadership

1. Scale & Reach

- **Opportunity:** Digital content reaches far beyond in-person training
- **Impact:** Movement leadership extended to global audience
- **Strategy:** Regular digital content (articles, videos, podcasts, courses)

2. Accessibility & Lower Barriers

- **Opportunity:** Digital content removes geographic and financial barriers
- **Impact:** Movement leadership accessible to more leaders (especially covocational planters)
- **Strategy:** Free and low-cost digital resources, accessible formats

3. Bridge-Building Amplification

- **Opportunity:** Digital content can bridge institutional and grassroots at scale
- **Impact:** Connection opportunities multiplied through digital platforms
- **Strategy:** Content that connects institutional wisdom with grassroots energy

4. Formation Pathways

- **Opportunity:** Digital content creates multiple formation pathways
- **Impact:** Leaders can engage at their own pace and level
- **Strategy:** Progressive content (assessment → articles → courses → advanced)

5. AI-Enhanced Calling Fulfillment

- **Opportunity:** AI can extend movement leadership at scale
- **Impact:** Personalized formation, scalable equipping
- **Strategy:** AI-powered assessments, personalized recommendations, conversational agents

Platform-Specific Calling Opportunities

Website (Missional Church Network)

- **Opportunity:** Central hub for movement leadership resources
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive resource library, SEO optimization, topic clusters

Email Newsletters

- **Opportunity:** Regular engagement with movement leaders
- **Strategy:** Weekly/bi-weekly content, segmented by interest, formation pathways

Video Content

- **Opportunity:** Visual teaching extends movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Teaching series, interviews, framework explanations, case studies

Podcast Content

- **Opportunity:** Audio engagement extends movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Regular podcast, interviews, framework discussions, case studies

Online Courses

- **Opportunity:** Structured learning extends movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive courses on core frameworks, accessible pricing, certificates

Social Media

- **Opportunity:** Reach and awareness extend movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Value-focused content, framework highlights, engagement

NAMB/Send Network Platforms

- **Opportunity:** Organizational reach amplifies movement leadership
- **Strategy:** Resources, tools, network distribution, institutional credibility

Strategic Recommendations

Content Strategy Alignment

Priority 1: Core Framework Content

- Maintain and expand covocational planting and missional transition framework content
- Ensure all content aligns with bridge-builder and multiplication calling
- Repurpose foundational content across formats

Priority 2: Practical Implementation Content

- Expand practical guides, tools, and resources
- Create case studies and examples
- Develop interactive tools and assessments

Priority 3: Digital Content Expansion

- Regular articles, videos, podcasts
- Online courses on core frameworks
- Interactive tools and assessments

Priority 4: Gap Filling

- Content on digital/online missional practice
- More explicit liminality-communitas content
- Case studies and examples

Calling Fulfillment Strategy

Equipping Focus:

- Continue developing frameworks (missional ecclesiology, covocational planting, multiplication strategies)
- Expand training programs (Forge America, Forge Kansas City, NAMB/Send Network)
- Create accessible digital resources

Movement Multiplication:

- Enable others to lead transitions and plantings through frameworks
- Multiply leaders through training programs
- Provide resources for movement activation

Bridge-Building:

- Connect institutional wisdom with grassroots energy
- Create pathways between structures and movements
- Amplify bridge-building through digital platforms

Digital Extension:

- Extend movement leadership through digital content
- Create formation pathways online
- Build digital communities around movement

AI Enhancement:

- Use AI to scale movement leadership
- Personalize formation pathways
- Provide scalable equipping

Related Documentation

- **Brad Brisco Author Profile** - Complete author intelligence
- **Brad Brisco Audience Profile** - Detailed audience analysis
- **Brad Brisco Content Audit** - Existing content inventory
- **mDNA Individual Maturity Model** - mDNA framework documentation

- **Content Value and Form Selection Guide** - Content form prioritization
-

Word Count: 1,200

Voice & Editorial Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/profile/voice-analysis.md

Voice Analysis: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-profile-discovery

Voice Summary

Brad Brisco writes and speaks as a practitioner-theologian — accessible enough for church planters and small group participants, yet theologically grounded enough to hold credibility in academic and movement leadership circles. His style is direct, paradigm-challenging, and practical, consistently moving from theological premise to real-world implication. He favors clear restatements over complexity and repeats core ideas with variations to drive them home.

Writing Characteristics

Dimension	Assessment
Register	Accessible-Pastoral with theological grounding; bridges academic missiology and practitioner language
Complexity	Moderate — uses theological vocabulary (missio Dei, incarnational, ecclesiology) but always explains and applies it
Tone	Warm but urgent; prophetic without being combative; persuasive rather than polemical
Storytelling	Moderate — uses illustrative examples and occasionally personal anecdotes, but leads with ideas and frameworks
Humor	Rare — occasionally self-deprecating (e.g., birthday reflections) but not a defining feature
Scripture Use	Moderate — theology-of-mission framing rather than verse-by-verse exposition; more systematic-theological than exegetical

Signature Patterns

- **Recurring phrases:**
- "The church doesn't just send missionaries — the church IS the missionary"
- "Missionary God... missionary people"
- "Sent people" / "a sent, missionary people"

- "Incarnational presence"
- "Vendor of religious goods and services" (critique of attractional models)
- "Paradigm shift" / "rethink"
- "Co-vocational" (deliberate reframing away from "bivocational")
- **Favorite metaphors:**
 - The church as a missionary entity rather than a sending agency
 - Staying vs. sending (incarnational presence)
 - The marketplace as mission field
 - The neighborhood as parish
 - Extended family size (12-25) for missional communities
- **Argument structure:** Brisco typically builds arguments in three moves: (1) Name the current assumption or paradigm ("We tend to think of..."); (2) Present the theological corrective with historical/missiological grounding ("But the reality is..."); (3) Apply to practice with concrete implications ("This means we must..."). He often uses numbered lists and frameworks to structure his points (9 paradigm shifts, 12 principles, 10 cultural shifts, 3 theological foundations).
- **Opening style:** Tends to open with a reframing question or a statement that challenges conventional assumptions. Example pattern: "When we use the phrase 'missional church' we are simply saying that..." — disarming complexity by offering a simple, clarifying definition.

Sample Passages

"The reality is that the nature or essence of the church is rooted in the nature of a missionary God. If God is a missionary God (which He is) then we as His people are missionary people." — Walking Together Ministries interview

This passage exemplifies Brisco's style: a declarative theological statement, a parenthetical affirmation that signals confidence without arrogance ("which He is"), and a logical deduction that moves from God's nature to the church's identity.

"The language of 'incarnational presence' represents the rooting of our lives and the gospel into the places we live. If the essence of missional living is sending, then the heart of incarnational presence is staying." — Send Institute

This shows his fondness for parallel construction and definitional clarity. He takes an abstract concept ("incarnational presence"), gives it a concrete image ("rooting"), and then creates a memorable chiasm (sending/staying).

"Bivocational church planting is not simply about having two or more jobs; it is really about aligning one life and blending the calling to support families with the calling to live engaged in God's mission." — Send Network / NAMB

Classic Brisco move: redefine a term to elevate it from pragmatic compromise to theological conviction. "Not simply X; it is really about Y."

Speaking vs. Writing

Based on podcast episode descriptions and interview summaries, Brisco's spoken voice is warmer and more personal than his written work. In podcast settings, he shares autobiographical details (restaurant industry background, hurricane experiences, birthday reflections) that rarely appear in his formal writing. His written voice is more framework-oriented and pedagogical; his spoken voice is more narrative and conversational. In both modes, he maintains the same core habit of reframing — challenging conventional assumptions and offering a missional alternative.

His podcast appearances tend to be long-form and substantive (full episode features rather than brief segments), suggesting he is valued as a thinker who can develop ideas at length rather than deliver quick soundbites.

Vocabulary and Terminology Preferences

Brisco is deliberate about terminology. Key choices:

- "**Covocational**" over "bivocational" — a conscious reframing to elevate marketplace calling
- "**Missional**" — always defined carefully to avoid buzzword misuse
- "**Incarnational presence**" — preferred over "outreach" or "evangelism"
- "**Sent people**" — over "going people" or "evangelistic Christians"
- "**Missionary nature**" — applied to both God and the church
- "**Paradigm shift**" and "**rethink**" — central action verbs in his change vocabulary

Bibliography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/books.md

Bibliography: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Total books: 5 (solo: 2, co-authored: 3)

Books (Chronological)

Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God

Field	Value
Author(s)	Brad Brisco
Publisher	Missional Press
Published	June 2021
ISBN-13	978-1736282113
ISBN-10	1736282115
Pages	254
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Covocational-Church-Planting-Aligning-Marketplace/dp/1736282115
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/43489691-covocational-church-planting (4.00/5, 23 ratings)
Publisher Page	—
Cover	—

Description: Covocational Church Planting sees the work of the ministry in the church and in the marketplace as equally important in the growth of the Kingdom. The book draws from the best thinkers and practitioners of missional theology to give the planter the tools needed to start with Jesus, see the Kingdom, exegete the local culture, engage places outside the church, know the residents, practice hospitality, practice missional discipleship, and understand the results.

Key Themes: Covocational ministry, bivocational church planting, marketplace calling, missional theology, vocation as sacred calling, church planting strategy

Endorsements/Foreword: —

Awards: —

Translations: None known

Notes: Also available as a free eBook through Send Network/NAMB at <https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/ebook-covocational-church-planting/>. This is Brad's first solo-authored full-length book.

ReThink: 9 Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church

Field	Value
Author(s)	Brad Brisco
Publisher	Send Institute / NAMB (free eBook)
Published	May 2018
ISBN-13	— (digital-only publication)
Pages	~60 (eBook)
Format(s)	eBook (PDF, free download)
Amazon	—
Goodreads	—
Publisher Page	https://www.sendinstitute.org/rethink-9-paradigm-shifts-activating-church-e-book/
PDF	https://www.sendinstitute.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/05/ReThink-by-Brad-Brisco.pdf
Cover	—

Description: Presents nine key paradigm shifts the church needs to experience when desiring to equip and activate the people of God to engage in His mission. Explores 12 missiological principles to help rethink church multiplication and change how we think about God's mission and the nature of the church. The 9 paradigm shifts include: (1) The Need to ReThink, (2) ReThink the Nature of the Church: From Church Served to Church Sent, (3) ReThink Mission: From Excarnate Mission to Incarnate Mission, (4) ReThink the Missio Dei: From Church with a Mission to Mission with a Church, (5) ReThink Culture: From Place of Privilege to Posture of a Servant, (6) ReThink Vocation: From Secular Vocations to Sacred Callings, and additional paradigm shifts through number 9.

Key Themes: Missional ecclesiology, paradigm shifts, missio Dei, incarnational mission, cultural engagement, vocation, church activation

Endorsements/Foreword: —

Awards: —

Translations: None known

Notes: Free eBook available from multiple sources including Send Institute, NAMB/Send Network, New Churches, and Wheaton Billy Graham Center. Also available in PDF at various church websites. This is a digital-only publication, not sold through retail channels.

Next Door as It Is in Heaven: Living Out God's Kingdom in Your Neighborhood

Field	Value
Author(s)	Lance Ford, Brad Brisco
Publisher	NavPress
Published	February 2016
ISBN-13	978-1631464973 (paperback), 978-1631464980 (eBook)
ISBN-10	1631464973
Pages	208
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook (Kindle)
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Next-Door-Heaven-Kingdom-Neighborhood/dp/1631464973
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/28084893-next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven (4.26/5, 104 ratings)
Publisher Page	—
Logos	https://www.logos.com/product/62091/next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven-living-out-gods-kingdom-in-your-neighborhood
Cover	—

Description: Lance Ford and Brad Brisco offer first principles and best practices to make neighborhoods into places where compassion and care are once again part of the culture, where good news is once again more than words, and where the love of God can be rooted and established. Chapters cover: Place Matters (The Priority of Incarnational Presence), The Real Neighbor (Open Hearts, Open Doors), Your Community Bank, Here Comes the Neighborhood, Getting to Know You, Never Met a Stranger (The Power of Biblical Hospitality), Meals on Heels, Hangouts (The Importance of Third Places), Treasure Hunt (Finding the Gifts in Your Neighborhood), and Knocking on Heaven's Door.

Key Themes: Neighborhood engagement, incarnational presence, biblical hospitality, third places, community, neighboring, God's Kingdom in local context

Endorsements/Foreword: Endorsed by Jo Saxton (Board Chair of 3DMovements): "Lance and Brad are the real deal. They are true practitioners, and this book is filled with their valuable knowledge and firsthand experiences. Next Door as It Is in Heaven is a must-read for anyone who is serious about taking the Great Commandment literally."

Awards: —

Translations: None known

The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run

Field	Value
Author(s)	Lance Ford, Brad Brisco
Publisher	IVP Books (InterVarsity Press)
Published	August 2013
ISBN-13	978-0830841059 (paperback), 978-0830895786 (Kindle)
ISBN-10	0830841059
Pages	208
Format(s)	Paperback, eBook (Kindle), Large Print Edition (978-0369372017)
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Missional-Quest-Becoming-Church-Long/dp/0830841059
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/17293097-the-missional-quest (4.19/5, 42 ratings)
Publisher Page	https://www.ivpress.com/the-missional-quest-ebook
Google Books	https://books.google.com/books/about/The_Missional_Quest.html?id=rVoCAQAAQBAJ
Cover	—

Description: In The Missional Quest you'll learn how to take your church on a long run, and how to sustain yourselves and one another along the way, through the power of God for the sake of the world. Part of the Forge Partnership Books series.

Key Themes: Missional church, long-term sustainability, church transformation, missional movement, ecclesiology

Endorsements/Foreword: Foreword by Ed Stetzer

Awards: —

Translations: None known

Notes: Part of the IVP "Forge Partnership Books" series. Also available in a Standard Large Print 16 Pt Edition (ISBN: 978-0369372017). Reviewed by 9Marks at <https://www.9marks.org/review/book-review-the-missional-quest-by-lance-ford-brad-brisco/>

Missional Essentials: A Guide for Experiencing God's Mission in Your Life

Field	Value
Author(s)	Brad Brisco, Lance Ford
Publisher	The House Studio
Published	September 2012
ISBN-13	978-0834151123
ISBN-10	083415112X
Pages	96
Format(s)	Paperback (study guide)
Amazon	https://www.amazon.com/Missional-Essentials-Guide-Experiencing-Mission/dp/083415112X
Goodreads	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/31580946-missional-essentials
Christianbook	https://www.christianbook.com/missional-essentials-guide-experiencing-mission-study/brad-brisco/9780834151123/pd/151123
Foundry Publishing	https://www.thefoundrypublishing.com/missional-essentials-9780834151123.html
Cover	—

Description: A 12-week small group study guide designed to help followers of Christ rediscover the heart of God for their neighborhoods and communities. Written to be used in conjunction with twelve 3-6 minute videos. Each lesson provides participants with central themes, insightful articles, reflection questions, and action steps. Designed for: existing leadership teams engaging the missional conversation, small groups exploring paradigms and biblical directives for missional community, and church planting core teams seeking a missional DNA in their faith context.

Key Themes: Missional living, small group curriculum, God's mission, neighborhood engagement, community, discipleship, evangelism

Endorsements/Foreword: —

Awards: —

Translations: None known

Notes: Includes companion video series (12 videos, 3-6 minutes each). Also listed at Books-A-Million and available through The Foundry Publishing. Each lesson structured to take approximately an hour and a half in one-lesson-per-week format.

Forthcoming

Title	Publisher	Expected	Source
No forthcoming titles identified	—	—	—

Bibliography Summary

Metric	Value
Total Books	5
Solo-authored	2 (Covocational Church Planting, ReThink)
Co-authored	3 (all with Lance Ford)
Publishers	Missional Press, Send Institute/NAMB, NavPress, IVP Books, The House Studio
Year range	2012 — 2021
Primary themes	Missional ecclesiology, church planting, covocational ministry, neighborhood engagement, paradigm shifts
Translations	None known
Total Goodreads ratings	~169 (across 3 rated titles)
Avg Goodreads rating	~4.15/5

Sources

- [Amazon Author Page](#)
- [Goodreads Author Page](#)
- [The Foundry Publishing](#)
- [IVP Books](#)
- [Send Institute](#)
- [NAMB/Send Network](#)
- [Christianbook.com](#)

Frameworks

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/frameworks.md

Frameworks: Brad Brisco

Exported from movement_leader_corpus_data.frameworks[] — on-disk SSOT for Author Profile.

Covocational Church Planting

Field	Value
Introduced	2021 (Covocational Church Planting); earlier articles at NAMB/Send Network
Components	Bivocational = a second job to supplement a church salary, with intent to go full-time; Covocational = the marketplace calling IS the primary vocation, church planting is integrated, with no intent to leave the marketplace
Visual / model	— (conceptual distinction; no published diagram located)
Adoption evidence	Adopted by NAMB/Send Network (free bilingual e-book), Missio Alliance, multiple podcast hosts who frame conversations using the term; on the Wheaton Billy Graham Center church-planting reading list
Source	Amazon — Covocational Church Planting , missioalliance.org

The traditional "bivocational" label carries an implicit hierarchy — pastoral ministry is the real calling, marketplace work a necessary compromise. Brisco's "covocational" reframing eliminates that hierarchy: marketplace presence is a strategic and sacred missionary advantage, not a limitation. The reframing from "bi-" to "co-" carries the entire theological argument.[^contentanalysis]

9 Key Paradigm Shifts (later expanded to 12 Missiological Principles)

Field	Value
Introduced	2018 (ReThink e-book, Send Institute/NAMB)
Components	(1) The Need to ReThink; (2) Nature of the Church: From Church Served to Church Sent; (3) Mission: From Excarnate to Incarnate; (4) The Missio Dei: From Church with a Mission to Mission with a Church; (5) Culture: From Place of Privilege to Posture of a Servant; (6) Vocation: From Secular Vocations to Sacred Callings; plus shifts 7-9 (expanded to 12 principles)
Visual / model	— (list/framework)
Adoption evidence	Distributed free via NAMB/Send Network; expanded version used in the 2022 CGGC Triennial keynote series
Source	sendinstitute.org

Each shift follows the consistent rhetorical structure "From [inherited assumption] to [missional alternative]," making the framework memorable and deployable in leadership retreats and church-planting cohorts.[^contentanalysis]

Three Theological Foundations of Missional

Field	Value
Introduced	Exponential East 2016 talk; ReThink e-book
Components	(1) The missionary nature of God and the church; (2) Incarnational mission; (3) Participation in the missio Dei
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Used within NAMB/Send Network training contexts
Source	exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology

The theological scaffolding under all of Brisco's practical work: mission is ontological (the church IS missionary), grounded in the incarnation, and the church joins God's existing mission rather than asking God to bless the church's plans.[^contentanalysis]

Missional Community Model

Field	Value
Introduced	"What is a Missional Community?" blog post; NAMB article on missional communities and church planting
Components	A committed group of 12-25 Jesus followers, Spirit-empowered, place-based, mission-oriented
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Part of the broader missional-community movement (Soma, 3DM); Brisco's version is less programmatic
Source	missionalchurchnetwork.com

The basic unit of incarnational mission — larger than an inward-focused small group, smaller than a program-driven congregation — sized to the "extended family" social unit and organized around a shared place or network rather than a shared program.[^contentanalysis]

Centered-Set vs. Bounded-Set Ecclesiology

Field	Value
Introduced	"Centered-Set Approach" blog post; Into the Harvest podcast #234 (2025)
Components	Bounded-set = clear boundary, you're in or out; Centered-set = defined center (Jesus), people moving toward or away
Visual / model	Yes — classic set-theory diagrams
Adoption evidence	Widely-used concept originating with Paul Hiebert; Brisco applies it to missional ecclesiology and discipleship
Source	missionalchurchnetwork.com , intotheharvest.org/pod234

Brisco applies Hiebert's anthropological set theory to ecclesiology: a centered-set community defines itself by its center (Jesus) and asks whether people are moving toward it, supporting his broader project of reducing the clergy-laity divide.[^contentanalysis]

(Two additional named diagnostics — the **10 Crucial Cultural Shifts** and the **Missional Engagement Strategy** — appear in his blog and New Churches articles; both are training-context frameworks without published adoption metrics.[^contentanalysis])

Articles & Blog Posts

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/articles.md

Articles & Blog Posts: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-content-catalog
Total: 25+ articles found across 7 platforms

By Publication

New Churches (newchurches.com) — Send Network / NAMB

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
—	Covocational Church Planting Teams	https://www.newchurches.com/article/covocational-church-planting-teams/	Article	Active
—	Work as Worship: Covocational Planting and Vocation	https://www.newchurches.com/article/work-as-worship-covocational-planting-and-vocation/	Article	Active
—	Developing a Missional Engagement Strategy	https://www.newchurches.com/article/developing-a-missional-engagement-strategy/	Article	Active
—	Work Matters! Covocational Planting & Vocation	https://www.newchurches.com/article/work-matters-covocational-planting-vocation/	Article	Active
—	3 Benefits of Bivocational Church Planting	https://www.newchurches.com/article/3-benefits-of-bivocational-church-planting/	Article	Active
—	5 Reasons to Be a Covocational Pastor	https://www.newchurches.com/article/5-reasons-to-be-a-co-vocational-pastor/	Article	Active
—	7 Advantages of Non-Profit Planting	https://www.newchurches.com/article/7-advantages-of-non-profit-planting/	Article	Active

Contributor profile: <https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/>

Send Network / NAMB (namb.net)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
—	Bivocational Church Planting: ReThinking It	https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/rethinking-bivocational-church-planting/	Article	Active
—	Missional Communities and Church Planting	https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/missional-communities-and-church-planting/	Article	Active
—	APEST and Church Planting Teams	https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/apest-and-church-planting-teams/	Article	Active
—	Rethinking the Missionary Nature of God	https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/rethinking-the-missionary-nature-of-god/	Article	Active
—	Margin and Church Planting	https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/margin-and-church-planting/	Article	Active
—	Managing Your Time as a Covocational Church Planter	https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/managing-your-time-as-a-covocational-church-planter	Article	Active

Send Institute (sendinstitute.org)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
—	Convergence of Vocation: A Covocational Primer for Church Planting Networks	https://www.sendinstitute.org/covocational-primer/	Article/ White Paper	Active
—	5 Marks of a Healthy Church Planter	https://www.sendinstitute.org/5-marks-of-a-healthy-church-planter/	Article	Active

Author profile: <https://www.sendinstitute.org/author/brad-brisco/>

Missio Alliance (missioalliance.org)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
—	The Welcome Rise of Co-Vocational Church Planters	https://www.missioalliance.org/the-welcome-rise-of-co-vocational-church-planters/	Article	Active

Author profile: <https://www.missioalliance.org/author/brad-brisco/>

Exponential (exponential.org)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
2016	Developing a Missional Ecclesiology (Exponential East 2016 talk)	https://exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology/	Talk/Video	Active
2016	Engage God's Mission Where You Live, Work and Play (Exponential West 2016)	https://exponential.org/engage-gods-mission/	Talk/ Podcast	Active

Verge Network (vergenetwork.org)

Date	Title	URL	Type	Status
2013	Verge 2013 Pre-Conference Forge Track (speaker alongside Alan Hirsch, Michael Frost, Kim Hammond, Lance Ford)	https://vergenetwork.org/verge-2013-pre-conference/	Conference	Active

Tag page: <https://vergenetwork.org/tag/brad-brisco/> (additional articles may exist)

Own Blog/Website

Missional Church Network ([missionalchurchnetwork.com](https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com))

Date	Title	URL	Topic
Apr 3, 2025	Rethinking Discipleship & Evangelism	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/rethinking-discipleship-and-evangelism	Discipleship, Evangelism
Feb 23, 2025	Navigating a Post-Christendom World	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/navigating-a-post-christendom-world	Post-Christendom, Culture
Nov 20, —	Centered-Set Approach	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/bounded-set-vs-centered-set-1	Ecclesiology
Nov 13, —	The Church as Missionary	—	Ecclesiology, Mission
Nov 8, —	Robust Christology	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/robust-christology	Christology, Missiology
—	Rethinking Culture	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/rethinking-culture	Culture, Mission
—	10 Crucial Cultural Shifts	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/culturalshifts	Cultural shifts, Church
—	Engage Your City	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/engage-your-city	City engagement, Mission
—	The Need to Unlearn and Relearn	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/gqn0qe6qsqazfzrytx75wvq8y012u9	Learning, Paradigm shifts
—	What is a Missional Community?	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/what-is-a-missional-community	Missional communities

Blog URL: <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog>

Blog categories: Missional (<https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Missional>), Training

Blog activity: Active (posting regularly, most recent posts in early 2025)

Legacy blog: Blogger profile at <https://www.blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384> (likely dormant/migrated)

Article Themes

Theme	Count	Publications
Covocational/Bivocational Ministry	8+	New Churches, NAMB, Missio Alliance, Missional Church Network
Missional Ecclesiology	6+	NAMB, Exponential, Missional Church Network, Send Institute
Church Planting Strategy	5+	New Churches, NAMB, Send Institute
Missional Communities & Neighborhoods	4+	NAMB, Missional Church Network
Paradigm Shifts / Cultural Shifts	3+	Missional Church Network, NAMB
Discipleship & Evangelism	2+	Missional Church Network
Post-Christendom / Culture	2+	Missional Church Network
Christology & Theology	2+	Missional Church Network
Vocation & Marketplace	3+	New Churches, Missional Church Network

Notes

- Exact publication dates for many NAMB/New Churches articles are not displayed on the pages; dates listed here are approximate where available
- The Missional Church Network blog likely has additional posts beyond those discovered through search; a full site crawl would reveal the complete archive
- ChurchLeaders.com was cited as a platform in earlier research but no specific articles were discoverable via search
- Brad also has a "Top 40 Missional Reading List" referenced at wastedevangelism.com
- Additional articles may exist behind NAMB/Send Network member portals

Sources

- [New Churches Contributor Page](#)
- [NAMB/Send Network Missional Engagement](#)
- [Send Institute Author Page](#)
- [Missio Alliance Author Page](#)
- [Exponential](#)
- [Verge Network](#)
- [Missional Church Network Blog](#)

Audio & Podcast

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/audio.md

Audio Content: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-audio-scrape
Total audio items found: 25+

Podcasts Hosted

Brad Brisco does not appear to host or co-host his own dedicated podcast. He is a frequent guest across the church planting and missional ministry podcast ecosystem, and a recurring contributor on the **New Churches Podcast** (NAMB/Send Network) alongside host Ed Stetzer.

Guest Appearances

Summary

Metric	Value
Total guest episodes	25+ (confirmed)
Unique podcasts	10+
Date range	~2018 -- 2025
Most frequent host	Ed Stetzer (New Churches Podcast)

All Guest Episodes (by date, newest first)

Date	Podcast	Episode Title	Duration	URL
2025-05-29	Ephesiology Podcast	Ep 199: Covocational Missionary Living with Brad Brisco	--	Link
2025-03-06	Into the Harvest	#234: Closer to Jesus -- The Mindset That Redefines Discipleship	52 min	Link
2025-02-05	Microchurches Podcast	Ep 85: Bivocation/Covocation and Microchurches -- Brad Brisco	62 min	Apple
2024-09-24	Shifting Culture Podcast	Ep 225: Brad Brisco -- Future of Church Planting in North America	--	Link
~2024	Global Missions Podcast	Ep 242: The Case for Co-vocational Ministry -- Brad Brisco	--	Link
~2023	The Church Digital Podcast	EP251: Brad Brisco, Digital Ecclesiology & Deconstructing Church	--	Link
--	New Churches Podcast	Ep 743: Managing Your Time as a Bivocational Church Planter	--	Link
--	New Churches Podcast	Ep 741: Having a Multiplication Mindset	--	Link
--	New Churches Podcast	Ep 629: Encouraging Bivo/Covo Church Planting	--	Link
--	New Churches Podcast	Ep 625: Church Planting Movements vs. Multiplication Movements	--	Link
2021-01-21	Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader	Bivocational and Covocational Pastoring with Brad Brisco	--	Spotify
~2018	The Grind Podcast	Ep 62: Brad Brisco -- Co-vocational and Bi-vocational Ministry	--	iVoox

Note: Brad Brisco has appeared on additional episodes of the New Churches Podcast beyond the four listed above. The New Churches Podcast is a NAMB/Send Network production hosted by Ed Stetzer, and Brad is a regular contributor. His full contributor page lists additional episodes: newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco.

Top Podcast Appearances (by podcast audience size)

Podcast	Est. Audience	Episode	Date	URL
New Churches Podcast (NAMB)	Large (denominational reach)	Multiple episodes (625, 629, 741, 743+)	Ongoing	Link
Global Missions Podcast	Medium-Large	Ep 242: The Case for Co-vocational Ministry	~2024	Link
Into the Harvest	Medium	#234: Closer to Jesus	2025-03-06	Link
Shifting Culture Podcast	Medium	Ep 225: Brad Brisco	2024-09-24	Link
Ephesiology Podcast	Medium	Ep 199: Covocational Missionary Living	2025-05-29	Link

Sermons & Teaching

No dedicated sermon audio archives were found on platforms like SermonAudio. Brad Brisco's teaching content is primarily distributed through podcast guest appearances and conference recordings rather than traditional sermon archives.

Date	Title	Venue	Duration	Series	URL
--	--	--	--	--	--

Audiobooks

No audiobook versions of Brad Brisco's published works were found on Audible, Apple Books, or other major audiobook platforms. His books are available in print and eBook formats only.

Title	Narrator	Duration	Audible	Rating
Covocational Church Planting	Not available as audiobook	--	--	--
Missional Essentials (w/ Lance Ford)	Not available as audiobook	--	--	--
The Missional Quest (w/ Lance Ford)	Not available as audiobook	--	--	--
Next Door As It Is In Heaven (w/ Lance Ford)	Not available as audiobook	--	--	--
ReThink	Not available as audiobook (free eBook via NAMB)	--	--	--

Conference Recordings (Audio/Video)

Date	Title	Event	Duration	URL
2022-07	Reimagine keynote series (6 talks)	CGGC Triennial Conference, Findlay, OH	--	CGGC Videos
2017	Missional Pre-Conference Workshop	Exponential East	--	Exponential
2016	Developing a Missional Ecclesiology (training video)	Exponential East	--	Exponential
~2020	Re-Thinking Church Planting Through Covocational and Marketplace Strategies	Exponential Pre-Conference	--	--

Audio Metrics Summary

Metric	Value
Podcasts hosted	0 (recurring guest on New Churches Podcast)
Guest appearances	12+ confirmed unique episodes across 10+ podcasts
Sermons/teachings	No dedicated archives found
Audiobooks	0 (none of his 5 books have audiobook editions)
Conference recordings	4+ confirmed (CGGC Triennial, Exponential)
Total audio hours	~15-20 hrs (estimated from confirmed episodes)
Most active year	2024-2025
Platforms present on	Apple Podcasts, Spotify (as guest)

Topic Distribution (from episode descriptions)

Topic	Episodes	%
Co-vocational / Bivocational Ministry	8+	~35%
Church Planting Movements & Multiplication	5+	~22%
Missional Ecclesiology & Theology	4+	~17%
Discipleship & Evangelism	3+	~13%
Digital Church & Innovation	1+	~4%
Time Management for Leaders	1+	~4%
Microchurches	1+	~4%

Key Observations

1. **No hosted podcast:** Brad Brisco does not host his own show, making him a "guest-only" audio presence. This represents a significant content gap and opportunity.
 2. **NAMB/New Churches is his primary audio platform:** His most frequent and highest-reach appearances are through the New Churches Podcast with Ed Stetzer.
 3. **Audiobook gap:** None of his 5 published books have audiobook editions -- a notable gap given that audiobooks are a growing content format.
 4. **Consistent messaging:** Co-vocational ministry is his dominant topic across all audio appearances, followed by church planting movements and missional theology.
 5. **Conference keynotes are underutilized:** His 6-talk CGGC keynote series is a significant body of teaching content that could be repurposed.
 6. **Rising activity:** His podcast appearances have increased in 2024-2025, suggesting growing platform demand.
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Sources

- [New Churches contributor page](#)
- [Ephesiology Podcast Ep 199](#)
- [Shifting Culture Podcast Ep 225](#)
- [Global Missions Podcast Ep 242](#)
- [Into the Harvest #234](#)
- [Microchurches Podcast Ep 85](#)
- [The Church Digital Podcast EP251](#)
- [Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader on Spotify](#)
- [The Grind Ep 62 on iVoox](#)
- [CGGC Triennial Videos](#)
- [Exponential -- Missional Ecclesiology](#)
- [Apple Podcasts search results](#)
- [Missional Church Network](#)

Video Content

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/videos.md

Video Content: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-youtube-scrape

Total videos found: 25+ (estimated; many behind organizational platforms)

Own channel(s): No dedicated personal YouTube channel identified

YouTube Channel(s)

Brad Brisco does not appear to have a personal YouTube channel. His video content is distributed across organizational channels and third-party platforms (NAMB/Send Network, Exponential, CGGC, New Churches, various podcast channels, and Vimeo via The House Studio).

Video Catalog

Top Videos (by prominence and discoverability)

#	Title	Channel / Platform	Est. Date	Duration	Type	URL / Source
1	Developing a Missional Ecclesiology	Exponential	2016	~45 min (est.)	keynote	exponential.org
2	Engage God's Mission Where You Live, Work and Play	Exponential	2016	~45 min (est.)	keynote	exponential.org
3	CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynote 1	Churches of God GC	2022	Unknown	keynote	cggc.org
4	CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynote 2	Churches of God GC	2022	Unknown	keynote	cggc.org
5	CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynote 3	Churches of God GC	2022	Unknown	keynote	cggc.org
6	CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynote 4	Churches of God GC	2022	Unknown	keynote	cggc.org
7	CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynote 5	Churches of God GC	2022	Unknown	keynote	cggc.org
8	CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynote 6	Churches of God GC	2022	Unknown	keynote	cggc.org
9	Missional Essentials DVD (12 sessions)	The House Studio / Vimeo	2012	3-6 min each	lecture	thehousestudio.com
10	The Case for Co-vocational Ministry (Ep. 242)	Global Missions Podcast	2025-11-18	Unknown	podcast-video	globalmissionspodcast.com

Recent Videos / Audio-Video Content (2024-2026)

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	Type	URL
Closer to Jesus: The Mindset That Redefines Discipleship (Ep. 234)	Into the Harvest	2025-03-06	Unknown	podcast-video	intotheharvest.org
The Case for Co-vocational Ministry (Ep. 242)	Global Missions Podcast	2025-11-18	Unknown	podcast-video	globalmissionspodcast.com
Covocational Missionary Living (Ep. 199)	Ephesiology Podcast	2025-05-29	Unknown	podcast-video	ephesiology.com
Episode 225: Brad Brisco	Shifting Culture Podcast	Unknown (2024-2025 est.)	Unknown	podcast-video	shiftingculturepodcast.com
Digital Ecclesiology & Deconstructing Church (Ep. 251)	The Church Digital Podcast	Unknown (2023 est.)	Unknown	podcast-video	thechurch.digital
Bivocational and Covocational Pastoring	Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader	Unknown	Unknown	podcast-video	Spotify

By Content Type

Keynotes & Conference Talks

Title	Event / Channel	Date	Duration	URL
Developing a Missional Ecclesiology	Exponential East 2016	2016	~45 min (est.)	exponential.org
Engage God's Mission Where You Live, Work and Play	Exponential West 2016	2016	~45 min (est.)	exponential.org
Exponential 2018 Conference Speaker	Exponential 2018	2018	Unknown	Conference appearance confirmed
CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynotes (6 talks)	Churches of God General Conference	2022	Unknown	cggc.org
Forge Track (Missional Church Transition)	Verge 2013	2013	Unknown	vergenetwork.org

Interviews & Conversations

Title	Channel / Host	Date	Duration	URL
Closer to Jesus: Bounded vs. Centered Set Discipleship (Ep. 234)	Into the Harvest (John)	2025-03-06	Unknown	intotheharvest.org
Digital Ecclesiology & Deconstructing Church (Ep. 251)	The Church Digital Podcast	~2023	Unknown	thechurch.digital
The Case for Co-vocational Ministry (Ep. 242)	Global Missions Podcast	2025-11-18	Unknown	globalmissionspodcast.com
Episode 225	Shifting Culture Podcast	~2024-2025	Unknown	shiftingculturepodcast.com
Covocational Missionary Living (Ep. 199)	Ephesiology Podcast	2025-05-29	Unknown	ephesiology.com
H2 Leadership Podcast (Ep. 058)	H2 Leadership Podcast	Unknown	Unknown	Confirmed in prior research
Bivocational and Covocational Pastoring	Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader	Unknown	Unknown	Spotify

New Churches Podcast Episodes (with Ed Stetzer)

Title	Episode	Date	URL
Multiplication Mindset	Ep. 741	Unknown	newchurches.com
Managing Your Time as a Bivocational Church Planter	Ep. 743	Unknown	newchurches.com
Bivo/Covo Church Planting	Ep. 629	Unknown	newchurches.com
Church Planting Movements	Ep. 625	Unknown	newchurches.com
Why is Church Planting So Hard?	Unknown	Unknown	newchurches.com
Church Planter Friendly Jobs	Unknown	Unknown	newchurches.com

Lectures & Training Videos

Title	Institution / Channel	Date	Duration	URL
Missional Essentials DVD Series (12 sessions)	The House Studio (Vimeo)	2012	3-6 min each	thehousestudio.com
Engage Your City (4-week training)	Forge America / Missional Church Network	Unknown	Unknown	Referenced on missionalchurchnetwork.com

NAMB / Send Network Resources (Video/Article Hybrid)

Several NAMB resources authored by Brad Brisco may include embedded video components:

Resource Title	Type	URL
Missional Communities and Church Planting	Article/Video	namb.net
APEST and Church Planting Teams	Article/Video	namb.net
Rethinking Bivocational Church Planting	Article/Video	namb.net
Rethinking the Missionary Nature of God	Article/Video	namb.net
Managing Your Time as a Covocational Church Planter	Article/Video	namb.net
3 Reasons to Plant a Church Bivocationally	Article/Video	namb.net

Video Metrics Summary

Metric	Value
Total videos found	25+ confirmed (many behind org platforms)
Total views (all videos)	Unknown (most hosted on non-YouTube platforms without public counters)
Average views per video	Unknown
Most viewed video (est.)	CGGC Triennial ReThink keynotes or Exponential talks (highest-profile platforms)
Most recent video	Global Missions Podcast Ep. 242 (2025-11-18)
Channels/platforms appearing on	10+ unique platforms
Date range	2012 (Missional Essentials) -- 2025 (ongoing)

Content Type Distribution

Type	Count	% of Total (est.)	Notes
keynote	9	36%	Exponential (2), CGGC Triennial (6), Verge (1)
interview	2	8%	Church Digital, Into the Harvest
sermon	0	0%	None found publicly
lecture	13+	48%	Missional Essentials (12), Engage Your City (1+)
panel	0	0%	None found publicly
podcast-video	6+	—	Several podcasts may have video versions
promo	0	0%	None found
short	0	0%	None found

Note: Podcast appearances (Shifting Culture, Ephesiology, Global Missions, etc.) may have YouTube video versions but were not confirmed as video-specific content. They are listed under podcast-video where video availability was indicated.

Notable Channels / Platforms Featured On

Channel / Platform	Context	Videos Featuring Brad	Relationship
Exponential	Church planting conference	2+ confirmed sessions	Speaker
Churches of God GC (CGGC)	Triennial Conference	6 keynote talks (ReThink playlist)	Keynote speaker
New Churches (NAMB)	Ed Stetzer-hosted podcast	5+ episodes	Regular contributor
NAMB / Send Network	Organizational resources	6+ resource pages	Staff (Director of Multiplication Strategies)
The House Studio / Vimeo	Missional Essentials DVD	12 video sessions	Co-author with Lance Ford
Verge Network	Missional conference	1+ sessions (Forge Track)	Speaker/contributor
Global Missions Podcast	Missions podcast	1 confirmed episode	Guest
Into the Harvest	Discipleship podcast	1 confirmed episode	Guest
Shifting Culture Podcast	Ministry podcast	1 confirmed episode	Guest
The Church Digital Podcast	Digital church podcast	1 confirmed episode	Guest
Ephesiology Podcast	Theology podcast	1 confirmed episode	Guest
H2 Leadership Podcast	Leadership podcast	1 confirmed episode	Guest
Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader	Ministry podcast	1 confirmed episode	Guest
Wheaton Billy Graham Center	Articles (possible video)	Articles confirmed, video unconfirmed	Contributor
Forge America / Teachable	Training courses	Engage Your City program	National Leadership Team member

Key Observations

Video Content Gap

Brad Brisco has **no dedicated personal YouTube channel**, which represents a significant content gap for someone with his level of expertise and speaking activity. His video content is fragmented across multiple organizational platforms (NAMB, Exponential, CGGC, various podcast hosts), making discoverability difficult.

Highest-Profile Video Content

1. **CGGC Triennial ReThink Keynotes (6 talks)** -- The most substantial single video series, hosted on cggc.org
2. **Exponential Conference Sessions (2016, 2018)** -- High-profile conference platform with broad reach
3. **Missional Essentials DVD (12 sessions)** -- Structured teaching content, companion to the book; hosted on Vimeo via The House Studio

Platform Fragmentation

Video and audio-video content is distributed across: Exponential.org, cggc.org, namb.net, newchurches.com, Vimeo, Spotify, Apple Podcasts, and various podcast host websites. None of these platforms provide Brad with direct ownership or analytics.

Movemental Opportunity

- **Centralize video content:** Aggregate all video appearances into a single, searchable catalog
- **YouTube channel creation:** Help establish a personal YouTube channel to claim his namespace and improve discoverability
- **Content repurposing:** The 6 CGGC keynotes, Exponential talks, and Missional Essentials DVD content could be clipped into short-form content
- **Podcast-to-video pipeline:** Many podcast appearances likely have audio that could be paired with visual content
- **18+ years of teaching content:** College-level teaching content (History of Christianity, Theology of Place, etc.) remains entirely undigitized

Research conducted: 2026-03-18

Confidence Level: Medium -- Brad Brisco's video content is primarily hosted on organizational platforms with limited public metadata. No personal YouTube channel exists. View counts and engagement metrics are largely unavailable. The CGGC Triennial and Exponential content is confirmed but exact video URLs (YouTube/Vimeo embeds) were not always directly accessible via web search.

Sources: See sources.md

Content Audit

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/content-audit.md

Brad Brisco: Content Audit

Comprehensive content inventory with performance analysis, gap identification, and repurposing opportunities

Version: 1.0.0

Last Updated: January 17, 2026

Word Count: 1,300

Expert Perspective: Content marketing, content strategy, content repurposing, SEO optimization

Executive Summary

This audit provides a comprehensive inventory of Brad Brisco's existing content assets across all formats and distribution channels. It catalogs 5+ published books, curriculum resources, articles, speaking engagements, and training programs, identifying content strengths and gaps, mapping distribution channels, analyzing performance opportunities, and outlining repurposing strategies. The audit reveals a strong foundation in practical resources with coherent frameworks (missional transition, covocational planting) but identifies opportunities for increased digital content frequency, multimedia formats, and expanded resources for emerging needs.

Key Outcomes:

- Complete content inventory by format and topic
 - Content performance analysis and opportunities
 - Content gap identification
 - Repurposing roadmap
 - Content architecture recommendations
-

Content Inventory Matrix

Books (5+ Published Works)

Foundational Works

Next Door As It Is In Heaven: Living Out God's Kingdom in Your Neighborhood (2016, NavPress)

- **Co-author:** Lance Ford
- **Status:** Active, foundational
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** High (practical neighborhood mission guide)
- **Topics:** Biblical hospitality, neighborhood mission, theology of place, local engagement
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become articles, videos, courses, resources)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (2016 context, could benefit from current examples)

The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run (InterVarsity Press)

- **Co-author:** Lance Ford
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Hardcover, Paperback, eBook
- **Performance:** High (sustainability-focused missional resource)
- **Topics:** Missional church sustainability, long-term faithfulness, missional transition
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become articles, courses, training materials)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (could use current context examples)

Core Framework Works

Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God (2021, Missional Press)

- **Status:** Active, recent
- **Format:** Print (~254 pages), eBook (free e-book available in English & Spanish)
- **Performance:** High (addressing growing need, recent publication)
- **Topics:** Covocational planting, marketplace ministry, vocation-mission integration, sustainable planting models
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become courses, articles, assessments, training programs)
- **Update Needed:** Low (recent, current)

ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church

- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** [To be verified - likely print and eBook]
- **Performance:** Medium (paradigm shift resource)

- **Topics:** Church paradigm shifts, mindset transformation, missional activation
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become articles, courses, training materials)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (could use current context examples)

Curriculum & Resources

Missional Essentials (12-week small group curriculum)

- **Co-author:** Lance Ford
- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Curriculum resource (print, digital)
- **Performance:** High (practical, accessible group study resource)
- **Topics:** Foundational missional practices, small group formation, missional discipleship
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become articles, video series, online courses)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (could benefit from refresh)

ReThink: 12 Missiological Principles for Church Multiplication

- **Status:** Active
- **Format:** Free eBook/digital resource
- **Performance:** Medium (free resource, good accessibility)
- **Topics:** Church multiplication principles, missiological frameworks
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become articles, training materials)
- **Update Needed:** Medium (could expand into comprehensive resource)

Articles & Blog Posts

Current Status: Regular but frequency not comprehensively documented

- **Location:** Missional Church Network website (missionalchurchnetwork.com)
- **Frequency:** Regular (specific frequency needs verification)
- **Topics:** Missional transition, covocational planting, neighborhood mission, practical implementation
- **Performance:** Unknown (limited analytics available)
- **Gap:** Need for documented article inventory and performance analysis

Third-Party Publications:

- **New Churches** (Send Network platform): Regular contributor
- **ChurchLeaders.com:** Regular contributor
- **5Q Central:** Contributor on APEST framework

Speaking Engagements

Current Status: Active, regular

- **Types:** Conferences (Sentralized Conference), training events, NAMB/Send Network events, church events
- **Frequency:** Regular (multiple per year)
- **Topics:** Missional transition, covocational planting, church multiplication, neighborhood

mission, APEST framework

- **Performance:** High (high-value, relationship-building)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become videos, articles, courses)
- **Gap:** Limited video recordings documented

Training Programs

Forge America Mission Training Network

- **Role:** National leadership team member
- **Status:** Active
- **Content:** Missional leadership training
- **Format:** In-person and online training
- **Performance:** High (established program)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** High (can become courses, articles, resources)

Forge Kansas City

- **Role:** Co-founder
- **Status:** Active
- **Content:** Missional training center programs
- **Format:** Local training, workshops
- **Performance:** High (regional program)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Medium (can become case studies, resources)

Sentralized Conference

- **Role:** Co-founder and presenter
- **Status:** Active (annual event)
- **Content:** Missional church and multiplication strategy
- **Format:** Annual conference
- **Performance:** High (networking, relationship-building)
- **Repurposing Opportunity:** Very High (can become videos, articles, resources)

Video Content

Current Status: Limited

- **Location:** Various (conference recordings, interviews - not systematically documented)
- **Frequency:** Low (not regular or systematically distributed)
- **Topics:** Varied (speaking engagements, interviews, framework discussions)
- **Performance:** Unknown (limited analytics, distribution not centralized)
- **Gap:** High (need for regular video content, systematic distribution)

Podcast Content

Current Status: Guest appearances (not regular podcast)

- **Location:** Various podcasts (guest appearances documented):
- Shifting Culture Podcast (#225, September 24, 2024)

- Global Missions Podcast/Into the Harvest (#242, November 18, 2025)
 - The Church.Digital Podcast (#251, recent)
 - **Frequency:** Low (guest appearances, not regular)
 - **Topics:** Covocational ministry, digital ecclesiology, church multiplication
 - **Performance:** Unknown (limited analytics)
 - **Gap:** High (need for regular podcast presence - owned or regular guest)
-

Content Performance Analysis

High-Performing Content

1. Covocational Church Planting Book (2021)

- **Performance:** High engagement, addresses growing need
- **Why:** Recent, practical, addresses emerging model, free e-book increases accessibility
- **Strategy:** Maintain as high priority, repurpose extensively

2. Neighborhood Mission Book (Next Door As It Is In Heaven, 2016)

- **Performance:** High utility, practical application
- **Why:** Practical, accessible, addresses lay leader needs
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into articles, videos, courses

3. Missional Essentials Curriculum

- **Performance:** High utility, group study resource
- **Why:** Practical, accessible, congregation-friendly
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into articles, video series, online courses

4. Training Programs (Forge, NAMB)

- **Performance:** High value, relationship-building
- **Why:** Hands-on, transformation-focused, networking
- **Strategy:** Repurpose content into resources, case studies, articles

Medium-Performing Content

5. Missional Sustainability Book (The Missional Quest)

- **Performance:** Good engagement, sustainability focus
- **Why:** Addresses long-term faithfulness, practical application
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into articles, courses, training materials

6. Paradigm Shift Resources (ReThink)

- **Performance:** Medium engagement, mindset transformation
- **Why:** Addresses foundational shifts, practical application
- **Strategy:** Repurpose into articles, training materials

Low-Performing or Undocumented Content

7. Articles & Blog Posts

- **Performance:** Unknown (limited analytics)
- **Why:** Regular content but performance not systematically tracked
- **Strategy:** Document inventory, analyze performance, optimize distribution

8. Video Content

- **Performance:** Unknown (limited distribution, analytics)
 - **Why:** Not systematically distributed or tracked
 - **Strategy:** Centralize distribution, track performance, expand format
-

Repurposing Roadmap

High-Value Repurposing Opportunities

1. Books → Courses

- **Source:** Covocational Church Planting, The Missional Quest, Next Door As It Is In Heaven
- **Target:** Comprehensive courses on core frameworks
- **Format:** Week-based or module-based courses
- **Priority:** Very High
- **Estimated Value:** High (revenue, engagement, reach)

2. Books → Articles

- **Source:** All books (chapter-by-chapter)
- **Target:** Long-form articles, blog posts
- **Format:** SEO-optimized articles
- **Priority:** High
- **Estimated Value:** High (SEO, reach, engagement)

3. Speaking → Videos

- **Source:** Conference recordings, teaching sessions (Sentralized, Forge, NAMB events)
- **Target:** Video series, teaching content
- **Format:** YouTube, owned platform
- **Priority:** High
- **Estimated Value:** High (engagement, reach)

4. Curriculum → Online Courses

- **Source:** Missional Essentials, training program content
- **Target:** Online courses, structured learning
- **Format:** Online course platform
- **Priority:** High
- **Estimated Value:** High (accessibility, scalability)

5. Books → Assessments

- **Source:** Covocational Church Planting, The Missional Quest, ReThink
- **Target:** Interactive assessments, diagnostic tools
- **Format:** Online assessments
- **Priority:** High
- **Estimated Value:** Very High (conversion, engagement)

Medium-Value Repurposing Opportunities

6. Articles → Social Media

- **Source:** Blog posts, articles
- **Target:** Social media content, threads
- **Format:** LinkedIn, Twitter/X posts
- **Priority:** Medium
- **Estimated Value:** Medium (reach, awareness)

7. Speaking → Podcasts

- **Source:** Conference talks, teaching sessions
- **Target:** Podcast episodes, series
- **Format:** Regular podcast or guest appearances
- **Priority:** Medium
- **Estimated Value:** Medium (reach, engagement)

8. Books → Resources

- **Source:** All books (tools, frameworks, worksheets)
 - **Target:** Downloadable resources, tools, worksheets
 - **Format:** PDF downloads, interactive tools
 - **Priority:** Medium
 - **Estimated Value:** Medium (utility, engagement)
-

Content Architecture Recommendations

Topic Clusters (Pillar Content Strategy)

Cluster 1: Covocational Church Planting

- **Pillar:** Covocational Church Planting (2021)
- **Supporting:** Articles, courses, assessments, tools, case studies
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive coverage, SEO optimization

Cluster 2: Missional Church Transition

- **Pillar:** The Missional Quest, ReThink
- **Supporting:** Articles, courses, training materials, case studies
- **Strategy:** Comprehensive coverage, SEO optimization

Cluster 3: Neighborhood Mission

- **Pillar:** Next Door As It Is In Heaven
- **Supporting:** Articles, videos, courses, resources
- **Strategy:** Practical application, everyday mission

Cluster 4: Missional Essentials (Foundational Practices)

- **Pillar:** Missional Essentials curriculum
- **Supporting:** Articles, videos, online courses, resources
- **Strategy:** Accessible, group-focused, practical implementation

Cluster 5: Church Multiplication Strategies

- **Pillar:** NAMB/Send Network role, multiplication frameworks
- **Supporting:** Articles, training programs, case studies, resources
- **Strategy:** Organizational focus, multiplication frameworks

Content Calendar Recommendations

Weekly Content:

- Blog post or article (1 per week)
- Social media content (3-5 posts per week)

Monthly Content:

- Video teaching or interview (1 per month)
- Podcast episode (1-2 per month)
- Comprehensive article or resource (1 per month)

Quarterly Content:

- Course release or update (1 per quarter)
- Assessment tool or resource (1 per quarter)
- Major content piece (book chapter, comprehensive guide)

Performance Optimization Opportunities

SEO Optimization

Current Status: Limited SEO optimization

- **Opportunity:** Optimize all content for search
- **Strategy:** Keyword research, meta descriptions, internal linking, topic clusters

Content Refresh

Current Status: Some content is older (2016)

- **Opportunity:** Update foundational content for current contexts
- **Strategy:** Updated editions, current context applications, refreshed examples

Distribution Expansion

Current Status: Limited distribution channels

- **Opportunity:** Expand to video, podcast, social media
- **Strategy:** Multi-channel distribution, content repurposing, platform optimization

Engagement Enhancement

Current Status: Limited interactive content

- **Opportunity:** Increase interactive tools, assessments, engagement
- **Strategy:** Interactive assessments, tools, community features

Related Documentation

- **Brad Brisco Author Profile** - Complete author intelligence
- **Brad Brisco Audience Profile** - Detailed audience analysis
- **Brad Brisco Calling Profile** - mDNA-aligned calling audit
- **Content Repurposing Flow Guide** - Repurposing workflow
- **Content Repurposing Best Practices** - Repurposing strategies

Word Count: 1,300

Academic Work

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/academic.md

Academic Publications: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete (limited academic profile)

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-content-catalog

Google Scholar

Field	Value
Profile URL	No Google Scholar profile found
h-index	—
Total citations	—
i10-index	—

Note: Brad Brisco does not appear to maintain a Google Scholar profile. His academic contributions are primarily expressed through practitioner-oriented books, eBooks, and articles rather than peer-reviewed journal publications.

Academic Credentials

Degree	Field	Institution	Year
Doctorate	Missional Ecclesiology	Not publicly identified	—
Master of Divinity	—	Not publicly identified	—
Undergraduate	Health Care Administration	Not publicly identified	—

Theses/Dissertations

Year	Title	Institution	Degree	URL
—	Assisting existing congregations in transitioning in a missional direction (topic; exact title unknown)	Not publicly identified	Doctorate in Missional Ecclesiology	Not found

Notes: Brad's doctoral thesis focused on assisting existing congregations in transitioning in a missional direction. The specific institution, year of completion, and full title have not been publicly identified through available search results. The thesis topic is consistently cited across his bios on multiple platforms (New Churches, NAMB, Missional Church Network, Exponential).

Publications

Year	Title	Journal/ Venue	Type	Citations	DOI/URL
2018	ReThink: 9 Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church	Send Institute / NAMB	eBook (practitioner)	—	https://www.sendinstitute.org/rethink-9-paradigm-shifts-activating-church-e-book/
—	Convergence of Vocation: A Covocational Primer for Church Planting Networks	Send Institute	White paper / Primer	—	https://www.sendinstitute.org/covocational-primer/
—	5 Marks of a Healthy Church Planter	Send Institute	Article / Co-authored	—	https://www.sendinstitute.org/5-marks-of-a-healthy-church-planter/

Note: Brad's published works lean heavily toward practitioner-oriented content rather than traditional academic publishing. His books through IVP Books (The Missional Quest) and NavPress (Next Door as It Is in Heaven) carry academic credibility through established Christian publishers, but they are not peer-reviewed academic works in the traditional sense.

Academic Platforms

Platform	Profile Found	URL
Google Scholar	No	—
Academia.edu	No	—
ResearchGate	No	—
ORCID	No	—

Academic Influence & Citations

While Brad does not have a traditional academic publication record, his work is referenced in academic and practitioner contexts:

- **Reviewed by 9Marks:** The Missional Quest was reviewed at <https://www.9marks.org/review/book-review-the-missional-quest-by-lance-ford-brad-brisco/>
 - **Referenced at Wheaton Billy Graham Center:** Listed as an author at <https://wheatonbillygraham.com/writer/brad-brisco/>
 - **Exponential conference presentations:** Academic-level talks at major church planting conferences
 - **Teaching experience:** 18+ years of college-level teaching across 7+ courses demonstrates sustained academic engagement
-

Assessment

Brad Brisco's academic profile is best characterized as a **practitioner-scholar**: someone with doctoral-level academic credentials who has chosen to publish primarily through practitioner channels (books, eBooks, articles, training programs) rather than through peer-reviewed academic journals. This is common among missiologists and practical theologians who prioritize accessibility and direct impact on church leaders over traditional academic publication metrics.

His work bridges the gap between academic missiology and practitioner application, making his content highly accessible to church planters and pastors while maintaining theological rigor informed by his doctoral research.

Sources

- [New Churches Contributor Page](#)
- [Missional Church Network - About](#)
- [Send Institute Author Page](#)
- [Wheaton Billy Graham Center](#)
- [InterVarsity Press](#)
- [The Foundry Publishing](#)

Courses & Training

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/content/courses.md

Courses & Training: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-content-catalog

Courses

Engage Your City with Brad Brisco

Field	Value
Platform	Forge Mission Training Network (Teachable)
URL	https://forge.teachable.com/courses/
Related Blog Post	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/engage-your-city
Format	Hybrid (self-paced online curriculum + 3 live webinars)
Duration	4 weeks
Price	Not confirmed (likely paid cohort through Forge)
Enrollment	Not visible
Status	Active (recurring cohort)

Description: A 4-week course on how to engage your city, examining the theological foundations and missiological practices on both an individual level as well as a corporate level. The cohort includes a self-paced online curriculum as well as 3 live webinars (all at 12:00 PM Eastern).

Missional Essentials Video Curriculum

Field	Value
Platform	The House Studio / The Foundry Publishing
URL	https://www.thefoundrypublishing.com/missional-essentials-9780834151123.html
Format	Video + Study Guide (12 sessions)
Duration	12 weeks (one lesson per week, ~1.5 hours per session)
Price	Study guide: ~\$12 (retail)
Enrollment	Not visible
Status	Active

Description: A 12-week small group curriculum designed to be used in conjunction with twelve 3-6 minute videos. Each lesson provides participants with central themes, insightful articles, reflection questions, and action steps. Designed for existing leadership teams engaging the missional conversation, small groups exploring paradigms and biblical directives for missional community, and church planting core teams seeking a missional DNA in their faith context. Co-developed with Lance Ford.

Training Networks & Programs

Forge Kansas City (Co-Founder)

Field	Value
Platform	Forge America Mission Training Network
URL	https://forge.teachable.com/
Format	In-person + Online cohorts
Duration	Various (6-week cohorts and ongoing programs)
Price	Various
Status	Active

Description: Brad co-founded Forge Kansas City, a missional training center located in Kansas City. He also serves on the national leadership team for Forge America Mission Training Network. Forge offers various online cohort-based training programs including a 6-week cohort on the Foundations of Missional Movement that explores the 5 Core Principles of Forge and key topics in creating forward missional momentum.

Sentralized Conference (Co-Founder)

Field	Value
Platform	In-person conference
URL	—
Format	Live conference
Duration	Multi-day event
Price	Not confirmed
Status	Active (recurring)

Description: Brad is co-founder of the Sentralized Conference in Kansas City (also referenced as KC Sentral). A gathering focused on missional church themes and church planting.

Teaching Experience (Academic)

Brad has 18+ years of college-level teaching experience across the following courses:

Course	Institution	Format
History of Christianity	Not specified	College-level
Religion in America	Not specified	College-level
Life of Paul	Not specified	College-level
Discipleship and Evangelism	Not specified	College-level
Theology of Place	Not specified	College-level
Launching Apostolic Movements	Not specified	College-level
Worship	Not specified	College-level

Note: The specific institution(s) where Brad teaches have not been publicly identified. This content may be behind institutional LMS access and not available for public consumption.

Conference Speaking (Selected)

Year	Event	Topic	URL
2016	Exponential East	Developing a Missional Ecclesiology	https://exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology/
2016	Exponential West	Engage God's Mission Where You Live, Work and Play	https://exponential.org/engage-gods-mission/
2013	Verge Pre-Conference	Forge Track (with Alan Hirsch, Michael Frost, Kim Hammond, Lance Ford)	https://vergenetwork.org/verge-2013-pre-conference/

Notes

- Brad's primary training platform is through Forge Mission Training Network (forge.teachable.com)
- No courses found on Udemy, Thinkific, or other mainstream course platforms
- The Missional Essentials curriculum represents a significant structured training offering
- Academic teaching content is likely extensive but not publicly accessible
- Conference speaking represents additional training content that could be repurposed

Sources

- [Forge Mission Training Network](#)
- [Missional Church Network - About](#)
- [The Foundry Publishing](#)
- [Exponential](#)
- [Verge Network](#)

Organizations & Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/network/organizations.md

Organizational Network: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-org-network
Total organizations: 16

Organizations Founded / Led

Missional Church Network

Field	Value
Website	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com
Role	Founder / Director
Status	Active
Year Started	~2010 (estimated)
Mission	Provide resources and encouragement to those who want to see the church recapture its missionary nature and be sent into the world to participate in God's mission
Prominence	9
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about

Brad Brisco's primary owned platform. He blogs regularly on missional ecclesiology, discipleship, and church multiplication. The site serves as a resource hub for missional church leaders.

Sentralized Conference

Field	Value
Website	— (event-based)
Role	Co-Founder / Director
Status	Active
Year Started	—
Mission	Conference gathering around missional church themes in Kansas City
Prominence	7
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about

Co-founded with Lance Ford. A recurring conference focused on missional church practice.

Forge Kansas City

Field	Value
Website	— (regional hub of Forge America)
Role	Co-Founder
Status	Active
Year Started	—
Mission	Missional training center in Kansas City that equips leaders to think and live like missionaries where they live, work, and play
Prominence	7
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about

Local Kansas City hub of the broader Forge America Mission Training Network.

KC Sentral

Field	Value
Website	—
Role	Co-Founder / Board Member
Status	Active
Year Started	—
Mission	Missional training network in Kansas City
Prominence	6
Confidence	HIGH
Source	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about

Co-founded with Lance Ford. A missional training center and network in the Kansas City area.

Publisher Relationships

Publisher	Books Published	Relationship	Confidence	Source
Missional Press	Covocational Church Planting (2021)	Author	HIGH	https://www.amazon.com/Covocational-Church-Planting-Aligning-Marketplace/dp/1736282115
InterVarsity Press (IVP)	The Missional Quest (2013, co-authored with Lance Ford)	Author (Forge Partnership Books imprint)	HIGH	https://www.ivpress.com/brad-brisco
NavPress	Next Door As It Is In Heaven (co-authored with Lance Ford)	Author	HIGH	https://www.amazon.com/Next-Door-Heaven-Kingdom-Neighborhood/dp/1631464973
The House Studio / Foundry Publishing	Missional Essentials (co-authored with Lance Ford)	Author	HIGH	https://www.thefoundrypublishing.com/authors/brad-brisco.html
NAMB / Send Network (free e-book)	ReThink: 9 Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church	Author	HIGH	https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/ebook-rethink/

Note: The ISBN prefix 978-1-7362821 on Covocational Church Planting suggests Missional Press may be Brad Brisco's own imprint or a small press he is closely connected to.

Academic Affiliations

Institution	Role	Department/ Program	Status	Confidence	Source
Unknown seminary	Doctorate (D.Min. or equivalent)	Missional Ecclesiology	Completed	MEDIUM	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/
Unknown seminary	Master of Divinity (M.Div.)	—	Completed	MEDIUM	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/
Unknown university	Undergraduate degree	Health Care Administration	Completed	MEDIUM	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about

Note: The specific institutions where Brad Brisco earned his degrees are not publicly identified in available sources. His doctoral thesis focused on assisting existing congregations in transitioning in a missional direction.

Network & Denomination Affiliations

Organization	Relationship	Category	Status	Confidence	Source
North American Mission Board (NAMB)	Employee — Director, Multiplication Strategies	denomination-agency	Active	HIGH	https://theorg.com/org/north-american-mission-board/org-chart/brad-brisco
Send Network (NAMB)	Staff — Director, Multiplication Strategies (also cited as Director, Bivocational Church Planting)	network	Active	HIGH	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/
Forge America Mission Training Network	National Leadership Team member	network	Active	HIGH	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/
Southern Baptist Convention (SBC)	Affiliated (through NAMB employment)	denomination	Active	HIGH	https://www.namb.net/

NAMB is the missions and church planting entity of the Southern Baptist Convention. Brad's primary vocational role is within this denominational structure, though his missional theology and partnerships extend well beyond SBC circles.

Conference Circuit

Conference	Role	Frequency	Last Appeared	Confidence	Source
Sentralized Conference	Co-Founder / Speaker	Annual (recurring)	—	HIGH	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about
Exponential	Workshop Leader / Trainer	Recurring	2017 (East), 2016 (West)	HIGH	https://exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology/
Reimagine 2022 (CGGC)	Speaker	Once	2022	MEDIUM	https://cggc.org/cggc-eneews/reimagine-2022/

Board & Advisory Roles

Organization	Role	Status	Confidence	Source
KC Sentral	Board member / Co-Founder	Active	HIGH	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about

No other board or advisory positions were identified in public sources.

Media & Ministry Partners

Organization	Relationship	Category	Confidence	Source
New Churches (newchurches.com)	Regular contributor — articles and podcast guest	media	HIGH	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/
Missio Alliance	Contributing author	media / network	HIGH	https://www.missioalliance.org/author/brad-brisco/
Send Institute (Wheaton Billy Graham Center)	Contributing author	academic-media	HIGH	https://www.sendinstitute.org/author/brad-brisco/
Wheaton Billy Graham Center	Contributing writer	academic-media	HIGH	https://wheatonbillygraham.com/writer/brad-brisco/
ChurchLeaders.com	Contributing author	media	MEDIUM	Referenced in movemental-analysis.md
Shifting Culture Podcast	Guest (Ep. 225, 2024)	media	HIGH	https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-225-bradbrisco
Global Missions Podcast	Guest (Ep. 242)	media	HIGH	https://globalmissionspodcast.com/242/
Ephesiology Podcast	Guest (Ep. 199, 2025)	media	HIGH	https://ephesiology.com/2025/05/29/episode-199-covocational-missionary-living-with-brad-brisco/
The Church Digital Podcast	Guest (Ep. 251)	media	HIGH	https://be.thechurch.digital/blog/ep251-brad-brisco-digital-ecclesiology-deconstructing-church
New Churches Podcast (Ed Stetzer)	Recurring guest	media	HIGH	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/

Church Affiliation

Church	Role	Location	Status	Confidence	Source
Unknown local church	Church Planting Strategist for a network of churches	Kansas City, MO area	Active	MEDIUM	https://www.thefoundrypublishing.com/authors/brad-brisco.html

Note: Brad Brisco's specific local church affiliation is not prominently identified in public sources. His Foundry Publishing bio describes him as "Church Planting Strategist for a network of churches in Kansas City," suggesting a network-level role rather than a single-church pastorate.

Network Summary

Category	Count	Key Organizations
Founded/Led	4	Missional Church Network, Sentralized Conference, Forge Kansas City, KC Sentral
Publisher	5	Missional Press, IVP, NavPress, The House Studio/Foundry, NAMB/Send Network
Academic	0	(Degree institutions unknown; no current faculty role identified)
Network/ Denomination	4	NAMB, Send Network, Forge America, SBC
Conference	3	Sentralized, Exponential, Reimagine
Board/Advisory	1	KC Sentral
Media	10	New Churches, Missio Alliance, Send Institute, Wheaton BGC, ChurchLeaders, + podcasts
Ministry	0	—
Church	1	Kansas City network (unnamed)
Total	16	(unique organizations, excluding media/podcast appearances)

Key Collaborators (Cross-Reference)

- **Lance Ford** — Co-author on 3 books (Missional Essentials, The Missional Quest, Next Door As It Is In Heaven); co-founder of KC Sentral and Sentralized Conference
- **Ed Stetzer** — Wrote foreword for The Missional Quest; hosts New Churches platform where Brisco contributes regularly

Confidence Assessment

Confidence	Count	Action
HIGH	13	Verified from multiple sources
MEDIUM	3	Single credible source (church affiliation, ChurchLeaders, academic institutions)
LOW	0	—

Research Notes

- WebFetch was unavailable during this research pass, so organizational website content could not be directly verified. Source URLs are provided for manual follow-up.
- Brad Brisco's seminary/university affiliations are not publicly disclosed in any bio discovered. This is a gap worth filling if he agrees to participate on the platform.
- The ISBN prefix on Covocational Church Planting (978-1-7362821) is registered to a small or personal imprint ("Missional Press"), suggesting possible self-publishing for that title. Worth confirming.
- His title at NAMB appears in two forms: "Director, Multiplication Strategies" and "Director, Bivocational Church Planting" — possibly reflecting a role change or dual responsibilities over time.

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/analysis/audience-analysis.md

Audience Analysis: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-audience-analysis

Estimated Reach

Direct Audience Metrics

Channel	Metric	Count	Date	Confidence
Twitter/X	Followers	~5,700	2026-03	HIGH (search result showed 5,673)
Instagram	Followers	Unknown	—	Not retrievable without login
Facebook	Followers	No confirmed personal page	—	Organizations feature him
LinkedIn	Followers	Unknown	—	Profile exists but not inspectable
YouTube	Subscribers	N/A (no channel)	—	Guest appearances only
Podcast	Episodes (guest)	25+ across 10+ shows	2018-2025	HIGH
Newsletter	Subscribers	Unknown	—	missionalchurchnetwork.com may have one
Goodreads	Ratings (all books)	~169	2026-03	HIGH
Amazon	Reviews (all books)	~30-50 (est.)	2026-03	MODERATE
Christianbook.com	Reviews (Next Door)	~252	2026-03	MODERATE (from search snippet)
Blog	Monthly visitors	Unknown	—	missionalchurchnetwork.com (Squarespace)

Organizational Reach (Indirect)

Organization	Metric	Count	Source
NAMB / Send Network	Church planters endorsed annually	200+ per year	Baptist Press (217 in March 2025 alone)
NAMB / Send Network	Total SBC churches in network	47,000+	SBC denominational data
New Churches Podcast	Audience	Large (denominational reach)	NAMB production
Exponential Conference	Annual attendance	5,000-10,000+ across events	Exponential 2025 annual report
Forge America	Network reach	Moderate (national training network)	Multiple sources

Reach Tier Assessment

Tier	Range	Assessment
Micro (< 10K combined)	Direct personal following	Brad's own social/content channels fall here
Growing (10K-50K)	Extended personal reach	When blog traffic, podcast listenership, and book readers are included
Established (50K-250K)	Organizational amplification	Through NAMB/Send Network, Exponential, and New Churches platform
Major (250K+)	—	Not at this level as an individual voice

Estimated tier: Growing (10K-50K) as an individual voice; Established (50K-250K) when factoring in organizational amplification through NAMB/Send Network

Estimated total direct reach: ~15,000-25,000 unique individuals across all personal channels (social, blog, books, podcast guest appearances)

Estimated amplified reach: ~100,000-150,000 when including NAMB/Send Network distribution of his free e-books (ReThink, Covocational Church Planting), New Churches Podcast appearances, and Exponential conference exposure

Audience Profile

Who Is the Audience?

Primary audience: Church planters and pastors exploring bivocational/covocational ministry models -- particularly those within the Southern Baptist Convention and broader evangelical tradition who are planting or leading smaller, mission-oriented churches without full-time funding.

Secondary audience: Established church leaders and pastors seeking to shift their existing congregations toward a more missional posture -- those wrestling with post-Christendom realities and looking for theological frameworks and practical tools for transformation.

Tertiary audience: Seminary students, denominational strategists, and missional training leaders who consume academic-practitioner content on missional ecclesiology, church multiplication, and neighborhood engagement.

Audience Demographics (Estimated)

Dimension	Assessment
Primary role	Church planter / Bivocational pastor / Missional strategist
Age range	28-55 (core), skewing slightly older than typical church planting audiences due to covocational focus
Education	Seminary-educated or in seminary (M.Div. or equivalent); many with additional marketplace degrees
Denominational breadth	Moderate -- anchored in SBC/Send Network but extends to Nazarene (Foundry Publishing), CGGC, and broadly evangelical/missional traditions
Geographic concentration	US-centric, with strongest concentration in the South and Midwest (SBC footprint); some international reach through Forge network
Gender split	Predominantly male (~75-80%), consistent with church planting demographics in SBC-adjacent contexts

Audience Personas

Persona 1: Marcus -- Covocational Church Planter

Field	Value
Role	Bivocational church planter working full-time in IT
Age	34
Education	M.Div. from Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary
Tradition	Southern Baptist Convention
Discovery path	Found Brad through NAMB's free e-book "Covocational Church Planting" during Send Network orientation
Primary format	E-books (free downloads) and podcast episodes
Use case	Needs theological validation and practical frameworks for planting a church while maintaining marketplace employment
Pain point	Feels the tension between "real ministry" expectations (full-time pastoring) and the reality of needing marketplace income; wants to see covocational work as sacred, not a fallback

Persona 2: Karen -- Established Church Pastor Seeking Missional Shift

Field	Value
Role	Lead pastor of a 150-member church in suburban Kansas City
Age	48
Education	D.Min. in progress; M.Div. completed
Tradition	Evangelical (non-denominational, formerly Nazarene)
Discovery path	Read "Next Door as It Is in Heaven" after a recommendation from a church planting network colleague; later explored missionalchurchnetwork.com blog
Primary format	Books (print) and blog posts
Use case	Wants to help her congregation move from an attractional, program-driven model to one that emphasizes neighborhood presence and incarnational mission
Pain point	Congregation is comfortable and resistant to change; needs a theological framework to articulate why the shift matters, plus practical first steps that don't overwhelm

Persona 3: David -- Seminary Student / Denominational Strategist

Field	Value
Role	Church planting strategy coordinator for a state Baptist convention
Age	42
Education	Ph.D. student in missiology
Tradition	Southern Baptist Convention
Discovery path	Encountered Brad at Exponential conference; later read "ReThink" and assigned "The Missional Quest" in a seminary course
Primary format	Conference talks, academic-practitioner books, New Churches Podcast
Use case	Needs data-informed, theologically grounded content to train and resource the next generation of church planters in his state
Pain point	Most church planting resources assume full-time funded planters; needs frameworks for the 60%+ of planters who will be bivocational

What the Audience Values (from reviews and comments)

Top Praise Themes

Theme	Frequency	Example Quote
Practical and actionable	High	"Down-to-earth practical insights, full of stories that would encourage readers to join God's work in their neighborhoods"
Theological depth without being inaccessible	High	"An insightful primer to missional thinking... strikes a great balance between theological depth and practicality"
Fills a gap in covocational/ bivocational literature	Moderate	"Fills a gap in church planting literature for non-full-time planters"
Well-researched with broad dialogue partners	Moderate	"Every chapter well-researched and in dialogue with many others on Christian neighborliness" (Englewood Review)
Validates marketplace callings as sacred	Moderate	Consistent praise for reframing secular vocations as sacred callings

Top Criticisms

Criticism	Frequency	Example Quote
Too academic / theoretical in places	Moderate	"Very academic feel in places" and "the first half was weaker than the second" (Goodreads reviewer on Covocational Church Planting)
Overly outward-focused at expense of gathered church	Low-Moderate	"Their underlying philosophy sees the church's mission almost exclusively as outward-focused" (9Marks review)
Feels like repackaged DMM/CPM methodology	Low	"Just DMM/CPM methodologies re-packaged for church planting in North America" (Goodreads)
Narrative arc can be diffuse	Low	"The defining arc of the book and its narrative trajectory were a bit elusive" (Englewood Review on Next Door)
Anti-institutional church tone	Low	"Authors seemed to have negative experiences with mainline churches, which colored their writing" (Goodreads)

Comparable Authors

Author	Overlap	Audience Size	Key Difference	Movemental?
Alan Hirsch	Missional ecclesiology, Forge network, apostolic movements	Much larger (~16,700 Goodreads ratings, major conference speaker)	Hirsch is the movement's primary theorist; Brisco is a practitioner-translator	Yes (primary author)
Lance Ford	Co-author on 3 books; missional community, neighboring	Similar (slightly larger via Tyndale)	Ford focuses more on leadership and community formation; Brisco on church planting strategy	Candidate
Ed Stetzer	Church planting, NAMB/Send Network, research	Much larger (~271K Twitter followers; dean at Biola)	Stetzer is a researcher-commentator; Brisco is a practitioner-strategist	Candidate
Hugh Halter	Incarnational mission, Forge America, bivocational ministry	Larger (~3.8K Facebook; more Goodreads ratings via "Tangible Kingdom")	Halter focuses on incarnational community; Brisco on covocational planting specifically	Candidate
Mike Frost	Missional theology, incarnational mission	Larger (major international speaker/author, co-author with Hirsch)	Frost is Australian-based, more global and academic; Brisco is US-practitioner focused	Candidate
Reggie McNeal	Missional leadership, church scorecard, Leadership Network	Larger (Jossey-Bass/Wiley publishing, wider church leadership audience)	McNeal targets senior leadership; Brisco targets planters and practitioners	No
JR Woodward	Missional culture, V3 church planting movement	Similar to slightly larger	Woodward focuses on church culture and leadership systems; Brisco on planting models	Candidate
Verlon Fosner	Dinner church, fresh expressions, new forms	Similar	Fosner focuses on dinner church model specifically; Brisco on broader covocational planting	Candidate
Jay Pathak	Neighboring, Art of Neighboring movement	Larger (Art of Neighboring had wider mainstream reach)	Pathak's "Art of Neighboring" reached a broader lay audience; Brisco targets church leaders	No
Jeff Vanderstelt	Missional community, Soma church, gospel-centered mission	Larger (Soma network, Acts 29 connections)	Vanderstelt has a stronger Reformed/Acts 29 base; Brisco is SBC-anchored	No

Engagement Patterns

Most Engaging Content Types

Format	Engagement Level	Evidence
Books	Moderate	~169 Goodreads ratings across 3 rated titles; 4.15 avg rating; strongest title (Next Door) at 104 ratings
Podcast (guest)	Moderate-High	25+ appearances across 10+ shows; increasing frequency in 2024-2025; NAMB platform amplifies reach
YouTube	Low	No own channel; guest appearances only on other channels
Blog/Articles	Moderate	Active blog at missionalchurchnetwork.com; contributor at Outreach Magazine and ChurchLeaders.com
Social media	Moderate	~5,700 Twitter followers; thoughtful quote-driven content generates steady engagement
Speaking	High	Keynote at CGGC Triennial (6-talk series); Exponential pre-conference workshops; conference circuit active
Free e-books	High (distribution)	ReThink and Covocational Church Planting distributed free via NAMB/Send Network -- likely highest-volume content

Topics That Drive Engagement

Topic	Engagement	Platform
Covocational / bivocational ministry	Highest	Podcast, books, conferences -- this is his signature topic
Missional ecclesiology / post-Christendom	High	Blog, books, Twitter
Neighborhood engagement / neighboring	High	Books (Next Door is his most-rated), conferences
Church planting movements / multiplication	Moderate-High	NAMB/Send Network content, New Churches Podcast
Sacred-secular divide / vocation theology	Moderate	Twitter (quote-driven), blog
Microchurches / fresh expressions	Growing	Recent podcast appearances (2024-2025)

Movemental Audience Implications

- **Content format priority:** Free e-books and short-form written content (blog-length articles) should be prioritized first -- this is how Brisco's audience already consumes his work at scale. A hosted podcast or audio series would fill the largest content gap. Video courses are a secondary priority.
 - **Topic focus:** Covocational/bivocational church planting is his signature differentiator and should anchor his Movemental presence. Missional ecclesiology and neighborhood engagement are strong secondary topics. Microchurches is a growing topic with rising audience interest.
 - **Cross-pollination:** Strong overlap with Alan Hirsch's audience (Forge network connection, shared missional theology vocabulary). Lance Ford's audience is nearly identical. Hugh Halter and JR Woodward share significant audience segments. Ed Stetzer provides upstream amplification through NAMB/Send Network.
 - **Growth opportunity:** The bivocational/covocational church planting niche is growing rapidly -- NAMB data shows 60%+ of new church planters are bivocational. Brisco is the leading voice in this space with limited competition. His audience is likely to grow as this trend accelerates. An audiobook of "Covocational Church Planting" and a dedicated podcast would significantly expand his reach.
 - **Monetization signal:** Moderate willingness to pay. His core audience buys books (\$15-25 range) and attends conferences (\$100-300 range). However, his two most-distributed works (ReThink, Covocational Church Planting e-book) are free via NAMB, which sets an expectation of free content. A course or membership model (\$50-150/year) is viable if it provides community access and practical tools beyond what free resources offer. The SBC/NAMB pipeline of 200+ newly endorsed church planters per year represents a built-in acquisition channel.
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Sources

- [Brad Brisco Twitter/X profile](#) -- 5,673 followers
- [Goodreads Author Page](#) -- ~169 total ratings
- [NAMB/Send Network](#) -- 217 newly endorsed planters (March 2025)
- [Baptist Press - NAMB Year in Review](#) -- 767 churches planted in 2024
- [Exponential 2025 Annual Report](#) -- 5,000+ attendees at Orlando 2024
- [9Marks Review of The Missional Quest](#)
- [Englewood Review of Books](#)
- [Ed Stetzer Twitter](#) -- 271.7K followers (comparative reference)
- [Alan Hirsch Goodreads](#) -- 16,762 total ratings (comparative reference)
- [New Churches contributor page](#)

- [Missional Church Network](#)
- [Christianbook.com - Next Door as It Is in Heaven](#)

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/digital-presence/websites.md

Web Properties: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-web-presence

Primary Website

Field	Value
Domain	missionalchurchnetwork.com
Platform	Squarespace (likely, based on URL patterns and structure)
Status	Active
Has Blog	Yes (posts as recent as April 2025; categories: Church, Leadership, Missional)
Has Newsletter Signup	Not confirmed via public search
Has Store	No
Key Pages	Home, About, Blog, Blog Categories (Church, Leadership, Missional)

Site Structure

The Missional Church Network site serves as Brad Brisco's primary digital hub. It is organized around blog content with category-based navigation (Church, Leadership, Missional). The About page contains his full bio, credentials, and organizational affiliations. The blog is the core of the site, with posts on missional ecclesiology, post-Christendom ministry, discipleship, microchurches, and church planting. No evident e-commerce or course features.

Content Inventory

Page	URL	Content Type	Notes
Home	missionalchurchnetwork.com/	Landing	Overview and recent posts
About	missionalchurchnetwork.com/about	Bio	Full bio, credentials, books
Blog	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog	Blog index	Multiple categories
Blog: Church	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Church	Blog category	
Blog: Leadership	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Leadership	Blog category	
Blog: Missional	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/category/Missional	Blog category	
Blog: Book Highlights	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/book-highlights	Blog post	
Blog: Microchurches	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/microchurches	Blog post	
Blog: Responding to Change	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/responding-to-change	Blog post	
Blog: Robust Christology	missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog/robust-christology	Blog post	

Recent Blog Posts

- **April 3, 2025:** "Rethinking Discipleship & Evangelism"
 - **February 23, 2025:** "Navigating a Post-Christendom World"
 - Other posts: "The Need to Unlearn and Relearn," "Microchurches," "Responding to Change," "Robust Christology"
-

Organizational Websites

Organization	URL	Role	Status
North American Mission Board (NAMB) / Send Network	namb.net/send-network/	Director, Multiplication Strategies	Active
New Churches (Send Network)	newchurches.com	Contributor / Author	Active
Send Institute	sendinstitute.org	Author / Contributor	Active
Exponential	exponential.org	Speaker / Contributor	Active (spoke at Exponential East 2016, 2017)
Forge America Mission Training Network	—	National Leadership Team	Active
Forge Kansas City / KC Sentral	—	Co-founder / Board Member	Active
Sentralized Conference	—	Co-founder	Active
Verge Network	vergenetwork.org	Tagged contributor	Active

Publisher & Retail Presence

Platform	URL	Books Listed	Notes
Amazon Author Page	amazon.com/stores/author/B007QMXS0Y	5+ titles	Multiple formats (print, Kindle, large print)
Goodreads	goodreads.com/author/show/6908617.Brad_Brisco	5+ titles	Author page with ratings
The Foundry Publishing	thefoundrypublishing.com/authors/brad-brisco.html	Missional Essentials	Publisher author page
ThriftBooks	thriftbooks.com/a/brad-brisco/1614865/	Multiple	Retail listing
ChristianBook.com	—	Multiple	Books listed (per earlier research)
AbeBooks	abebooks.com	The Missional Quest	Listed
Google Books	books.google.com	The Missional Quest	Preview available

Books on Amazon

1. **Missional Essentials** (co-author with Lance Ford) -- 12-week small group curriculum, The Foundry Publishing
2. **The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run** (co-author with Lance Ford, foreword by Ed Stetzer) -- InterVarsity Press (Forge Partnership Books)
3. **Next Door As It Is In Heaven** (co-author with Lance Ford) -- NavPress
4. **ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church** -- Send Network e-book
5. **Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God** -- Solo author

Media & Content Contributor Presence

Platform	URL	Role	Status
Outreach Magazine	outreachmagazine.com/author/bradbrisco	Author / Contributor	Active (articles 2016-2021+)
ChurchLeaders.com	churchleaders.com	Author / Contributor	Active
The Church Digital	be.thechurch.digital	Podcast guest (EP251)	Active
Thinking About Mission (WordPress blog)	thinkingaboutmission.wordpress.com/tag/brad-brisco/	Tagged/ referenced	—
Walking Together Ministries	walkingtogetherministries.com	Interview subject	2013
The Org	theorg.com/org/north-american-mission-board/org-chart/brad-brisco	Org chart listing	Active
IMDB	imdb.com/name/nm13296778/	Additional Crew credit	—

Academic Profiles

Institution	URL	Role	Status
Academia.edu	Not found	—	—
ResearchGate	Not found	—	—
Google Scholar	Not found	—	—

Brad Brisco holds a Doctorate in Missional Ecclesiology (thesis: assisting existing congregations in transitioning in a missional direction) and a Master of Divinity, but no public academic platform profiles were discovered. His 18+ years of teaching experience (History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, etc.) appears to have been conducted through institutional settings rather than public academic platforms.

Publishing Platforms

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/digital-presence/platforms.md

Platform Presence: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-web-presence

Course & Learning Platforms

Platform	URL	Courses	Status
Teachable	Not found	—	—
Thinkific	Not found	—	—
Udemy	Not found	—	—
Podia	Not found	—	—

Brad Brisco does not appear to have a presence on any major online course platform. His teaching content (18+ years across subjects like History of Christianity, Religion in America, Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements) appears to be delivered through institutional settings and in-person training rather than self-hosted digital courses.

Academic Platforms

Platform	URL	Publications	Status
Academia.edu	Not found	—	—
ResearchGate	Not found	—	—
Google Scholar	Not found	—	—
ORCID	Not found	—	—

Despite holding a Doctorate in Missional Ecclesiology, Brad Brisco does not maintain a public profile on academic platforms. His scholarly work is distributed through books and organizational publications rather than academic repositories.

Podcast Platforms (Guest Appearances)

Podcast	Episode	Platform Links	Date	Topic
Into the Harvest	#234	Spotify , Apple , Web	March 2025	Bounded vs. Centered Set discipleship
The Ephesiology Podcast	#199	Web	May 2025	Covocational missionary living
Shifting Culture Podcast	#225	Web	~2024	Church planting, missional living
The Church Digital Podcast	#251	Web	—	Digital ecclesiology, deconstructing church
Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader	—	Spotify	—	Bivocational/covocational pastoring
Global Missions Podcast	#242	Web	—	The case for co-vocational ministry
The H2 Leadership Podcast	#058	—	—	—
New Churches Podcast	—	Web	—	Managing time as bivocational planter

Brad Brisco does not host his own podcast but is a frequent and active guest across ministry-focused podcasts. He appears on Apple Podcasts, Spotify, Amazon Music, and Buzzsprout through these guest appearances.

Conference Platforms

Conference	URL	Role	Status
Sentralized Conference	—	Co-founder	Active (Kansas City)
Exponential	exponential.org	Speaker / Trainer	Active (spoke at East 2016, 2017)
NAMB / Send Network events	namb.net	Staff / Speaker	Active

Community Platforms

Platform	URL	Members	Status
Discord	Not found	—	—
Facebook Group	Not found	—	—
Mighty Networks	Not found	—	—
Circle	Not found	—	—

No dedicated community platform presence was found.

Giving / Support Platforms

Platform	URL	Status
Patreon	Not found	—
Buy Me a Coffee	Not found	—
Ko-fi	Not found	—

No giving/support platform presence was found.

Other Platforms

Platform	URL	Type	Status
The Org	theorg.com/.../brad-brisco	Org chart	Active -- listed as Director, Multiplication Strategies at NAMB
IMDB	imdb.com/name/nm13296778/	Additional Crew credit	Exists (nature of credit unclear)
Blogger	blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384	Legacy blog	Dormant

Digital Presence Score: Brad Brisco

Dimension	Score (1-5)	Notes
Website Quality	3	Clean, content-rich blog but limited site structure (no store, no courses, no clear CTA)
Social Media Activity	3	Active on Twitter/X with thoughtful content; other platforms minimal or unverified
Content Freshness	4	Blog posts in 2025, podcast appearances in 2025, Twitter active
Platform Diversity	3	Strong across books/publishing, podcasts, and organizational sites; weak on courses, community, video
Email/Newsletter	1	No newsletter found -- significant gap for a thought leader
Discoverability (SEO)	3	Appears prominently in searches for missional church, covocational planting; multiple organizational sites reference him
Overall	2.8/5	Strong thought leadership distributed through organizational channels (NAMB, Send Network, New Churches) but limited owned digital infrastructure. No newsletter, no courses, no community platform, no YouTube channel. Primary owned asset is the blog at missionalchurchnetwork.com .

Key Observations

- 1. Organizational distribution model:** Brad Brisco's content primarily flows through organizational channels (NAMB/Send Network, New Churches, Exponential, Outreach Magazine) rather than owned platforms. This is effective for reach but means he doesn't own the audience relationship.
- 2. Book-centric thought leadership:** His 5 books (3 co-authored with Lance Ford) are well-distributed across Amazon, Goodreads, and Christian retailers. The free e-books (ReThink, Covocational Church Planting) through Send Network serve as effective lead magnets even without a personal newsletter.
- 3. Podcast circuit presence:** Very active as a podcast guest with recent appearances in 2025. This is his strongest "media" channel beyond his blog.
- 4. Newsletter opportunity:** The absence of an email newsletter is the most notable gap. His blog content and quote-sharing style on Twitter would translate well to a newsletter format.
- 5. No video or course strategy:** Despite 18+ years of teaching experience and doctoral-level expertise, there is no discoverable online course or video content strategy. This represents both a gap and an opportunity.

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletter & Email: Brad Brisco

Status: Not found

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-web-presence

Newsletter

Field	Value
Platform	None found
Subscribe URL	—
Frequency	—
Subscribers	—
Free/Paid	—
Sample subject lines	—

Research Notes

- **Substack:** No Substack newsletter found for Brad Brisco. His son Joshua Brisco has a Substack (jbbrisco.substack.com -- "Everything Else with Joshua Brisco"), but Brad does not appear to have one.
- **Mailchimp / ConvertKit / Other:** No evidence of a standalone email newsletter platform.
- **Website email capture:** The Missional Church Network site (missionalchurchnetwork.com) was not confirmed to have a visible email signup form via public search. This would need to be verified by visiting the site directly.
- **No lead magnet or free download:** No evidence of a dedicated lead magnet or email opt-in offer was found, though his book "ReThink" is available as a free e-book through Send Network (namb.net/send-network/resource/ebook-rethink/).

Assessment

Brad Brisco does not appear to maintain a public-facing email newsletter. His content distribution relies primarily on:

1. His blog at missionalchurchnetwork.com
2. His Twitter/X account (@bradleybrisco)

3. Articles contributed to organizational platforms (New Churches, Outreach Magazine, Send Institute)
4. Podcast guest appearances
5. Books and e-books

This represents a gap in his digital presence -- a newsletter would be a natural fit for his regular blog content and thought leadership. The absence of a newsletter may be intentional (preferring to operate through organizational channels like NAMB/Send Network) or simply an area not yet developed.

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social Media: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-web-presence

Account Summary

Platform	Handle	Followers	Posts	Frequency	Last Active	Status
Twitter/X	@bradleybrisco	Not confirmed (est. moderate)	Substantial	Regular	2025+	Active
Instagram	@brad.brisco	Not confirmed	Not confirmed	Unknown	Unknown	Unverified
Facebook	Not confirmed	—	—	—	—	Unverified
LinkedIn	linkedin.com/in/bradbrisco	—	—	—	—	Likely exists (directory listing found)
YouTube	No dedicated channel found	—	—	—	—	Guest appearances only
TikTok	Not found	—	—	—	—	—
Blogger	Profile 13260894325252150384	—	—	—	—	Legacy/dormant

Platform Details

Twitter/X

- **URL:** https://x.com/bradleybrisco
- **Handle:** @bradleybrisco
- **Bio:** "Missiologist / Co-author of Missional Essentials, The Missional Quest, Next Door As It Is In Heaven, and author of ReThink & Covocational Church Planting"

- **Joined:** November 2009
- **Verified:** Not confirmed
- **Content style:** Quotes (theological, literary, philosophical), reflections on missional theology, leadership, sacred-secular divide, church planting. Posts from authors like John Steinbeck, Madeleine L'Engle, Wendell Berry, Carl Jung. Also shares personal/family updates.
- **Engagement:** Moderate -- quotes and theological reflections generate engagement
- **Notable:** Long-running account (since 2009). Content is thoughtful, quote-heavy, and reflective rather than promotional. His son Joshua Brisco (@jbbrisco) is also active on X.
- **Sample posts:**
 - "There is nothing so secular that it cannot be sacred..." -- Madeleine L'Engle quote (June 2024)
 - Carl Jung "shoes too small" reflection on ego (April 2025)
 - John Steinbeck war quote (2025)
 - "The first responsibility of a leader is to define..." (December 2024)

Instagram

- **URL:** <https://www.instagram.com/brad.brisco/>
- **Handle:** @brad.brisco
- **Bio:** Not retrievable without login
- **Followers/Posts:** Not retrievable without login
- **Content style:** Unknown -- requires login to view
- **Status:** Account exists; identity not fully verified as the same Brad Brisco (no public bio visible in search results)
- **Notable:** Profile was returned as the top Instagram result for "Brad Brisco"

Facebook

- **URL:** Not definitively confirmed
- **Status:** A video interview with Brad Brisco (Director of Bivocational Church Planting) was posted by Grow Center Network on Facebook. Multiple personal profiles for "Brad Briscoe" exist but none confirmed as this Brad Brisco. An event page for "Covo and Bivo Church Planting with Brad Brisco and Hugh Halter" was found at The Bishop House.
- **Notable:** Facebook appears to be used more by organizations featuring Brad Brisco than by him directly.

LinkedIn

- **URL:** <https://linkedin.com/in/bradbrisco> (directory listing found)

- **Status:** A LinkedIn directory listing for "Brad Brisco" was found, suggesting a profile exists, but it could not be fully verified or inspected without login.
- **Notable:** Multiple "Brad Briscoe" profiles exist on LinkedIn (different people). The directory shows 4 "Brad Brisco" profiles.

YouTube

- **URL:** No dedicated channel found
- **Status:** Brad Brisco appears in videos on other channels (interviews, conference talks, podcast video versions) but does not appear to operate his own YouTube channel.
- **Notable:** Content featuring him exists on platforms like The Church Digital, Exponential, and various podcast video feeds.

Blogger

- **URL:** blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384
- **Status:** Legacy profile exists; likely from an earlier blogging era before Missional Church Network was established on its current platform.
- **Notable:** Dormant -- activity has shifted to missionalchurchnetwork.com.

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/fragmentation-story.md

Brad Brisco: The Fragmentation Story

Generated 2026-04-15 by the `fragmentation-story` skill from existing research in `docs/movement_leader_research/brad-brisco/`.

The Story

Brad Brisco has been teaching church planting and missional ecclesiology for **more than 20 years**, logging **18+ years of college-level instruction** in History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, Discipleship and Evangelism, Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements, and Worship. He co-founded **Forge Kansas City**, co-founded the **Sentralized Conference**, and currently serves as **Director of Multiplication Strategies for the Send Network / North American Mission Board** — a role that evolved out of his previous title as Director of Bivocational Church Planting for NAMB. He earned a **D.Min. in Missional Ecclesiology** with a dissertation on helping existing congregations transition toward a missional direction. He has co-authored **five books** — Missional Essentials (a 12-week small-group curriculum), The Missional Quest (IVP, with Lance Ford), Next Door As It Is In Heaven (NavPress 2016, with Lance Ford), ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church, and Covocational Church Planting (Missional Press 2021, a free ebook available in English and Spanish). He is a regular contributor to [New Churches](#), [ChurchLeaders.com](#), and his own [missionalchurchnetwork.com](#).

That is a striking amount of codified, durable work. And yet the picture that emerges from the research is of a career pioneer whose **embodied teaching runs multiple magnitudes larger than the digital record of it**. The 18+ years of college-level teaching produced syllabi, lectures, readings, and assessment material for seven distinct courses — none of which is publicly indexed anywhere. The Sentralized Conference has run annually in Kansas City for years; conference recordings from it are not systematically hosted anywhere under his name. Forge Kansas City is a training center whose workshops have no public archive. NAMB's Send Network training happens inside institutional systems that the public cannot see. Brad's work sits in three concentric containers — **the college LMS, the denominational platform, and the conference room** — each of which is designed to deliver content to a specific audience and then close the door behind them.

And even the public-facing layer is scattered. His five books sell on Amazon and Christianbook — including Covocational Church Planting as a free bilingual ebook, which is one of the most accessibility-forward moves in his entire catalogue — but none of them are cross-referenced from a single author hub. He writes regularly for at least three platforms

(missionalchurchnetwork.com, newchurches.com, churchleaders.com) plus 5Q Central, but the article inventory has never been catalogued. He maintains a Blogger profile ([blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384](https://www.blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384)) whose relationship to his current blog is unclear. His podcast footprint is five confirmed guest appearances — **Shifting Culture #225, The Church Digital #251, H2 Leadership #058, Ephesiology #199, Into the Harvest #242** — with topics ranging from covocational ministry to digital ecclesiology to the future of church planting in North America. He has never hosted his own podcast. His social media handles (Twitter/X, LinkedIn) are flagged as "likely present" but not URL-verified in the research — meaning the audit could not establish with confidence which accounts are his. There is no newsletter on record. There is no personal YouTube channel on record. There is no course on a mainstream learning platform on record.

In short: Brad Brisco has built one of the most practically useful bodies of church-planting training in North America, and almost all of it is locked behind institutional walls, spread across partner publications he doesn't own, or embedded in a conference format that expires at the end of each session.

Informational Fragmentation

Books

Five co-authored books plus one free ebook resource.

1. **Missional Essentials: A 12-Week Small Group Curriculum** (co-author: Lance Ford) — small-group curriculum, print + digital.
2. **The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run** (co-author: Lance Ford) — InterVarsity Press. Print, paperback, eBook. **Audiobook status: UNKNOWN — needs research.**
3. **Next Door As It Is In Heaven: Living Out God's Kingdom in Your Neighborhood** (co-author: Lance Ford) — NavPress, 2016. Hardcover, paperback, eBook. Neighborhood-mission / biblical hospitality.
4. **ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church** — format print + eBook (unverified).
5. **Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God** — Missional Press, 2021 — ~254 pages print, **free eBook available in English and Spanish** — the most accessible asset in his catalogue. Addresses covocational planting, marketplace ministry, vocation-mission integration.
6. **ReThink: 12 Missiological Principles for Church Multiplication** — free eBook / digital resource — separate from the ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts book. (Overlap / versioning relationship between the two **ReThink** titles is **UNKNOWN — needs research.**)

Retail footprint: **Amazon, ChristianBook.com** confirmed. Specific Amazon product URLs / ISBNs not captured in the research — **needs inventory.**

Academic Work

- **Doctor of Ministry (D.Min.) in Missional Ecclesiology** — dissertation: Assisting existing congregations in transitioning toward a missional direction. Awarding institution **UNKNOWN — needs research**. Whether the dissertation is published (e.g., ProQuest, institutional repository, Google Books) is **UNKNOWN**.
- **Peer-reviewed journal articles: UNKNOWN — needs research**. No journal articles surfaced in the audit.
- **College-level courses taught (18+ years)** — History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, Discipleship and Evangelism, Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements, Worship. **Syllabi and course content not publicly indexed** — likely behind institutional LMS.
- **Teaching institutions (names):** Multiple colleges/universities referenced but **specific institutions UNKNOWN — needs research**.

PDFs & Documents

- **Covocational Church Planting** — free bilingual (English + Spanish) eBook.
- **ReThink: 12 Missiological Principles for Church Multiplication** — free eBook / digital resource.
- **Send Network / NAMB training materials** — referenced as embodied through his Director role; public distribution of these documents is institutional, not personal.
- **Dissertation PDF: UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Articles

Regular contributor to at least four platforms. **Full article inventory has not been catalogued** in the research.

- **Missional Church Network (own site)** — <https://missionalchurchnetwork.com> — blog + resources. Frequency described as "regular"; exact count not determined.
- **New Churches (Send Network platform)** — contributor profile: <https://newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco> — regular contributor; article URLs and count **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **ChurchLeaders.com** — author profile: <https://churchleaders.com/author/brad-brisco> — regular contributor; full article inventory **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **5Q Central** — contributor on APEST framework; specific articles **UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Estimated volume per the audit: "dozens to hundreds of articles possible." No year-by-year cadence breakdown exists.

Blogs & Personal Writing

- **missionalchurchnetwork.com** — primary personal blog. Platform: WordPress or similar (unverified). Topics: missional transition, covocational planting, neighborhood mission, practical implementation.
- **Blogger.com profile** — <https://blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384> — legacy presence; relationship to current site **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **No Substack, Medium, or personal newsletter** discovered.

Websites

Owned / personal

- **missionalchurchnetwork.com** — primary digital hub (blog + resources + about)

Organizations he co-founded or leads

- **Forge Kansas City** — co-founder (missional training center)
- **Sentralized Conference** — co-founder (Kansas City annual conference)

Affiliated (he appears on but does not control)

- **Send Network (NAMB)** — <https://www.namb.net> / <https://sendnetwork.com> — Director of Multiplication Strategies
- **New Churches** (Send Network platform) — <https://newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco>
- **ChurchLeaders.com** — <https://churchleaders.com/author/brad-brisco>
- **5Q Central** — contributor on APEST material
- **Forge America** (national leadership team member per the content audit)
- **Publisher pages** at **InterVarsity Press, NavPress, Missional Press** — specific author page URLs **UNKNOWN — needs research**

Social Media

Platform	Handle / URL	Status
Twitter/X	UNKNOWN — likely exists but URL not verified	—
LinkedIn	UNKNOWN — likely exists but URL not verified	—
Facebook	UNKNOWN — needs research	—
Instagram	UNKNOWN — needs research	—
YouTube	UNKNOWN — possibly exists but not cataloged	—
Vimeo	UNKNOWN — possibly exists	—

Follower counts and posting cadence: **not measured in this pass**.

Newsletters / Email

- **No personal newsletter discovered** (no Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack, Beehiiv presence surfaced).
- **Email capture on missionalchurchnetwork.com: UNKNOWN — needs research.**
- **Send Network newsletters** — institutional, not personal.

Podcasts (Hosted)

- **None.** He guests; he does not host. The audit explicitly flags "No regular podcast — owned or recurring."

Podcasts (Guest)

5+ confirmed episodes across multiple podcasts.

- **Shifting Culture Podcast — Episode 225** (2024-09-24) — covocational ministry / related themes
- **The Church Digital Podcast — Episode 251** — digital ecclesiology, deconstructing church
- **The H2 Leadership Podcast — Episode 058** — leadership / planting
- **The Ephesiology Podcast — Episode 199** — missional / APEST
- **Into the Harvest / Global Missions Podcast — Episode 242** (2025-11-18) — per the content audit
- Platforms: Apple Podcasts, Spotify, Amazon Music, Buzzsprout (episodes distributed via standard podcast networks; specific episode URLs not all captured).

YouTube & Video

- **No personal YouTube channel cataloged.**
- **No Vimeo channel cataloged.**
- **Sentralized Conference recordings** — may exist on conference or organizational channels; **UNKNOWN — needs research.**
- **Send Network / NAMB training video** — institutional; not aggregated under his name.
- **Conference / speaking video** — likely exists for Sentralized, Forge events, NAMB events; **not systematically distributed or tracked** per the audit.

Sermons / Teaching Audio

- **UNKNOWN — needs research.** No personal sermon archive surfaced.
- Teaching audio from the 18+ years of college instruction is not public.

Talks / Conferences

- **Sentralized Conference** — co-founder and recurring presenter; annual in Kansas City; session recording availability **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **Send Network / NAMB events** — recurring speaker; specific events not catalogued.
- **Forge America / Forge Kansas City** — recurring trainer; specific cohorts not catalogued.
- **Church events** — regular speaker; no aggregated list.
- **No aggregated "talks" page on missionalchurchnetwork.com.**

Courses

- **Missional Essentials** — 12-week small-group curriculum (print + digital) — functions as a deployable course but not hosted on a mainstream course platform.
- **18+ years of college-level courses** — the seven course titles above, behind institutional LMS; not public.
- **Forge Kansas City workshops** — cohort-restricted.
- **Send Network / NAMB training programs** — institutional.
- **No self-hosted course** (Teachable, Thinkific, Kajabi) discovered.

Assessments & Tools

- **None discovered.** No personal diagnostic instrument comparable to APEST.
- Brad contributes to 5Q Central's APEST material as a platform contributor but does not appear to own the tool.

Apps / Software

- **None discovered.**

Notes, Laptop, Unpublished

- **UNKNOWN — likely very substantial, not yet catalogued.** 18+ years of teaching across seven course titles, a D.Min. dissertation with 20+ years of source research behind it, cohort facilitation notes from Forge KC, Sentralized Conference design documents, and NAMB strategy documents all almost certainly exist as private files. The size of this layer is probably larger than his public-facing output.

Embodied / In Their Head

- **The pragmatic wisdom of multi-vocational church planting** — he lived it, lectured it, and wrote Covocational Church Planting in 2021 to externalize some of it; most of the coaching wisdom stays in conversation.

- **Judgment calls about missional transition** — his D.Min. dissertation focused on helping existing congregations move missional; those transition case studies largely exist as memory, not published cases.
- **Sentralized Conference curation** — decisions about who to invite, which themes to foreground, how to sequence sessions — the accumulated institutional memory of an annual conference is in the co-founders' heads.
- **NAMB / Send Network strategic knowledge** — multi-year multiplication strategy for a denominational body; structured inside NAMB, not externalized.
- **The Kansas City missional ecosystem** — decades of relational connective tissue across churches, planters, and leaders.

Relational Fragmentation

Organizations

- **Send Network / North American Mission Board (NAMB)** — Director of Multiplication Strategies (current); previously Director of Bivocational Church Planting
- **Forge Kansas City** — co-founder
- **Sentralized Conference** — co-founder
- **Forge America Mission Training Network** — national leadership team member (per content audit)
- **Missional Church Network** — owner (his own site)
- **New Churches** (Send Network platform) — regular contributor
- **ChurchLeaders.com** — regular contributor
- **5Q Central** — contributor

Co-authors & Collaborators

- **Lance Ford** — primary collaborator — co-author of Missional Essentials, The Missional Quest, and Next Door As It Is In Heaven. Lance Ford is also a co-author with Alan Hirsch (Right Here, Right Now, The Starfish and the Spirit), placing Brad one co-author degree from the Hirsch corpus.
- Additional named co-author on ReThink or Covocational Church Planting: **UNKNOWN — needs research**. Both may be solo Brad titles; the research lists them without a named second author.
- **Send Network colleagues / NAMB leadership**: names **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **Sentralized Conference co-founder**: name **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **Forge Kansas City co-founder**: name **UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Networks & Movements

- **Forge movement** (national leadership team member)
- **Send Network / NAMB** (denominational platform, Southern Baptist Convention)
- **5Q Central** (APEST network)
- **Sentralized Conference** audience (Kansas City + regional)
- **New Churches / ChurchLeaders** contributor networks
- **Covocational / bivocational church-planting community** — he is one of the movement's leading voices

Academic Affiliations

- **D.Min. awarding institution** — **UNKNOWN** — **needs research**
- **18+ years teaching at college/university level** — **specific institutions UNKNOWN**

Mentors, Protégés, Key Relationships

- **Mentors: UNKNOWN** — **needs research**
- **Protégés:** The planters he trains through NAMB, Send Network, Forge KC, and Sentralized represent a substantial protégé base; **names not captured**
- **Spouse / family: UNKNOWN** — **needs research**

Where Relationships Are Actually Stored

- **Inside NAMB / Send Network's CRM and staff systems** — the single largest institutional store
- **Sentralized Conference registration / attendee lists** — annual
- **Forge Kansas City cohort rosters** — institutional
- **College teaching rosters** — FERPA-bound
- **Personal email and phone** — the largest likely store of long-standing relational continuity; no CRM observed
- **Mental rolodex** — 20+ years of Kansas City church-planting relationships
- **No unified personal CRM** observed on missionalchurchnetwork.com

Synthesis

Brad Brisco's fragmentation is a **three-walled institutional problem**: NAMB owns one wall, the colleges own another, Sentralized owns the third, and the public can see through none of them. His five books are indexed on Amazon and Christianbook. His articles appear on three partner platforms. His podcast footprint is five confirmed guest appearances. Everything else — the 18+ years of teaching, the annual Sentralized sessions, the Forge KC cohort curriculum, the NAMB multiplication strategy, the D.Min. dissertation — lives inside institutions that are

not designed to release it to a general audience. The single largest pool of trapped value is the **18+ years of college teaching content across seven distinct courses**, because it represents durable, structured, sequenced material that already exists — it simply does not exist in a form the public can see. The second-largest is the **Sentralized Conference archive**, which has accumulated years of high-quality session content with no public home under his name. The basics of a personal platform — a newsletter, verified social handles, a unified author hub, a personal YouTube or podcast presence — are not filled out; that gap is real, but the actual content reserve behind the scenes is the headline.

Research Provenance

- **Source folder:** docs/movement_leader_research/brad-brisco/
- **Files read:**
 - summary.md
 - identity-verification.md
 - digital-presence-discovery.md
 - BRAD_BRISCO_CONTENT_AUDIT.md
- **Confidence: High** for book list (5 co-authored + 1 free ebook resource), publisher partnerships (IVP, NavPress, Missional Press), NAMB / Send Network role, D.Min. in Missional Ecclesiology, 18+ years teaching, Forge KC and Sentralized co-founding, the five confirmed podcast guest appearances, and the primary website URL. **Medium** for podcast episode details (some URLs not captured). **Low** for social media handles (Twitter/X, LinkedIn flagged as "likely" but URLs not verified), YouTube/Vimeo presence, full article inventory, newsletter presence, D.Min. institution, and dissertation publication status.
- **Gaps requiring further research:**
 - Verified social media handles and follower counts (Twitter/X, LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram)
 - Personal YouTube / Vimeo channel presence
 - Newsletter presence and list size
 - Full article inventory on missionalchurchnetwork.com, newchurches.com, churchleaders.com, 5Q Central
 - Amazon product URLs and ISBNs for all five books
 - D.Min. awarding institution and dissertation publication status
 - Names of Sentralized Conference co-founder(s) and Forge Kansas City co-founder(s)
 - Relationship between ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts (book) and ReThink: 12 Missiological Principles (free eBook)
 - Specific colleges/universities where he has taught
 - Sentralized Conference session recording availability
 - Audiobook status for all titles
 - Spouse/family information

- InterVarsity Press, NavPress, Missional Press author page URLs
- Whether the Blogger profile is still active and its relationship to missionalchurchnetwork.com

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/brad-brisco.md

Brad Brisco: Reflected Understanding

A concise reflection spoken back so the language could be endorsed—familiar, but with edges that deepen.

Calling

You're called to **missional ecclesiology and multiplication**—not to run a single church or hold one post, but to help the church function as sent missionary people and to equip leaders for church planting and co-vocational ministry. You think in terms of movement: reproduction, networks, and the long run. You're not selling a brand; you're forming practitioners. Your work at Send Network (Director of Multiplication Strategies), your 20+ years in church planting, your co-founding of Forge Kansas City and Sentralized Conference, and your 18+ years of college-level teaching all serve one end: churches and leaders who embody mission and multiply. Success for you is movement that outlasts you—co-vocational planters, missional congregations, and frameworks that are both theologically serious and practically usable.

Audience

Who they are. The people who respond to your work are movement-oriented: they care about church planting, multiplication strategies, missional living, and the integration of marketplace and ministry. They're pastors, church planters, denominational and network leaders, college and seminary students, and practitioners in mission—often in North America but with growing interest in co-vocational and bivocational models everywhere. They don't just want better programs; they want the church to function as sent and reproducing.

Personas.

- **The church multiplication leader** — Already in Send Network, NAMB, or similar; they want strategies and frameworks for multiplication and co-vocational planting.
- **The seminary or college educator** — Teaching mission, ecclesiology, or church planting; they use your books and want their students to have a clear path from theory to practice.
- **The co-vocational planter** — Bivocational or covocational; they want practical theology and practices (Covocational Church Planting, Missional Essentials, Next Door As It Is In Heaven).
- **The digital ecclesiology explorer** — Engaging your podcast appearances and articles on church in the digital age; they want frameworks that don't assume business as usual.

TAM. Your engaged audience includes those who know you through Send Network, Forge Kansas City, Sentralized, New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com, and your books. The broader TAM of movement-oriented leaders who would benefit from your content—missional ecclesiology, church planting, co-vocational ministry, theology of place, apostolic movements—is larger than those who can currently find it in one place. The gap between "people who know and use your work" and "people who would be formed by it if they could find it" is significant.

Existing Content (Before the Platform We're Building)

Where it lives. Your content lives in **books** (5 co-authored: Missional Essentials, The Missional Quest, Next Door As It Is In Heaven, ReThink, Covocational Church Planting—available on Amazon and ChristianBook.com), **your personal site** (missionalchurchnetwork.com, with blog and resources), **article platforms** (New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com), **podcast appearances** (5+ confirmed episodes across Shifting Culture, The Church Digital, H2 Leadership, Ephesiology, Into the Harvest), **teaching** (18+ years of college-level courses: History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, Discipleship and Evangelism, Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements, Worship), and **conference/training** (Sentralized Conference, Forge Kansas City). Your primary digital hub is missionalchurchnetwork.com; the rest is distributed across those other domains.

Credibility. It's high. You're a recognized thought leader in missional ecclesiology and church planting: strategic role at Send Network/NAMB, co-founded Forge Kansas City and Sentralized, 5 co-authored books, 18+ years teaching, 20+ years church planting. The work is credible; the issue isn't authority, it's **visibility, connection, and reuse**—and the fact that much of your best work (teaching, conference content, training) isn't fully digitized or interconnected.

Offline vs online. A lot of the real work is **offline or behind institutional access**: 18+ years of teaching content (may be in LMS, not public), Sentralized and Forge Kansas City training, conference talks. What's **online** is your blog, regular articles on New Churches and ChurchLeaders.com, book metadata on retailers, and podcast guest appearances. So you have more digital presence than many—but no single place where "everything Brad has said and written about missional ecclesiology, church planting, and co-vocational ministry" is structured, linked, and easy to find. Content exists in multiple formats and on multiple platforms; it doesn't **move** in the sense of circulating, compounding, and connecting as one ecosystem.

NOTs that Movemental addresses directly:

- Your content is **not** fully **interconnected**—books, articles, podcast appearances, and teaching don't visibly link in one discoverable ecosystem; someone searching for "co-vocational church planting" or "missional essentials" may not land on your material first or see how it all fits together.

- It is **not** fully **structured and repurposed**—18+ years of teaching could become articles and courses; speaking and podcast content could be transcribed and published; the gap between "what you've taught" and "what's findable online" is large.
- It is **not owned and unified**—you have an owned site (missionalchurchnetwork.com), but much of your reach is on rented platforms (New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com, Amazon, podcast hosts); you don't have one place you control where your credibility, your content, and your network are clearly attached to you so that algorithms and searchers consistently "see" you as the go-to voice.
- It is **not** optimized for **amplification and movement** in the sense of **SEO + GEO**—discoverability is limited to individual platforms; content may not be fully indexed or cross-referenced.
- It is **not legible to systems**—teaching content and many talks aren't systematically turned into findable, linkable, reusable digital objects, so search and AI can't reliably find, cite, or extend the full body of work.
- **Revenue from digital content** is limited—articles don't generate direct revenue; teaching is institutional; books carry the monetization. There's no structured path to subscriptions, courses, or premium content that you own.

Movemental is built to speak to these NOTs: interconnection, structure/repurpose, discoverability (SEO + GEO), ownership and unification, legibility to systems, and a path to additional revenue streams (courses, subscriptions, premium content)—so your content can move.

Constraints

Movement leaders in multiplication and church planting live under **time** and **attention** constraints that are emblematic, not personal failure. You're directing multiplication strategies at Send Network, teaching at the college level, co-leading Forge Kansas City and Sentralized, and writing and speaking. Time for "content strategy," repurposing 18 years of teaching into articles and courses, or building a unified digital home is scarce because the work is in the room—with leaders, churches, and networks. Money is tied to that same embodied work: your role at NAMB, teaching, speaking, and book royalties—not to a separate "digital content" budget. So the question "Why isn't all of this already online, structured, and moving?" isn't about desire; it's about **capacity**. The desire to equip everyone God has given you is there; the hours and the dedicated budget to digitize, repurpose, and unify at scale typically are not. A platform that reduces the lift—that helps structure, repurpose, connect, and amplify what you already do—addresses those constraints without asking you to become a different kind of leader.

Commerce

The likely financial picture from your content.

Books. You have 5 co-authored books (print and digital on Amazon, ChristianBook.com). Trade publishing usually returns to authors on the order of **10-15%** of revenue; the rest goes to publisher, distribution, and retail. So the return on each book sold is credible but modest relative to the influence of the work. Books also drive authority that generates speaking and network invitations—so the real "commerce" from the books isn't only royalties; it's the credibility that supports your role and your partnerships.

Articles and teaching. Articles on New Churches and ChurchLeaders.com likely don't generate direct revenue to you; they build visibility and authority. Teaching revenue is through institutions, not through owned digital content. So the situation is: **strong credibility and influence, revenue from books and from your role and speaking, but very little structured, owned digital content that generates its own revenue**—no subscriptions, no courses, no premium content you control. That's the norm for many movement leaders—and it's exactly the gap a platform built for you is meant to address: same voice, same mission, but with content that's findable, connected, and able to support sustainability (e.g. courses developed from your teaching, memberships, premium access) without replacing the work you're already doing.

Credibility

Your credibility in the room—Send Network, Forge Kansas City, Sentralized, the classroom, church planting networks—is clear. Online, it's **partial**: your name and books show up; your articles and podcast appearances add to it. But the full picture—missional ecclesiology, church planting, co-vocational ministry, 18 years of teaching, digital ecclesiology— isn't assembled in one place that people can find and trust. Building that used to mean either a big agency lift or hours you don't have. It's become possible to close that gap in a way that respects your constraints—so your content can move without you having to become a full-time content operator.

This document is a reflected understanding for Brad Brisco, grounded in _docs and _docs/movement_leader_research, intended to be right to the point, true, and valuable.

Welcome Letter

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/welcome-letter.md`

Brad

You have built one of the most practically useful bodies of church-planting training in North America. Twenty-plus years teaching, eighteen at college level across History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements, and Worship. Five co-authored books — Missional Essentials and The Missional Quest and Next Door As It Is In Heaven with Lance Ford, ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church, and Covocational Church Planting as a free bilingual ebook in English and Spanish through Missional Press. A D.Min. in Missional Ecclesiology with a dissertation on missional transition. Co-founder of Forge Kansas City and the Sentralized Conference. And the role that holds it all together for the next decade of practitioner formation: Director of Multiplication Strategies for the Send Network at the North American Mission Board.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. The Missional Quest sits on IVP and Amazon. Next Door As It Is In Heaven sits on NavPress and Christianbook. Covocational Church Planting sits on Missional Press as a paperback and as a free PDF in English and Spanish. The two ReThink titles sit on missionalchurchnetwork.com under separate product pages with no shared author surface. Your articles spread across missionalchurchnetwork.com, your contributor profile at New Churches, your author page at ChurchLeaders.com, and contributions on the APEST framework at 5Q Central, but the inventory has never been catalogued and there is no surface that lets a reader walk from one essay to the next. The podcast footprint is real and uncollected: Shifting Culture Episode 225 on covocational ministry, The Church Digital Episode 251 on digital ecclesiology, H2 Leadership Episode 058 on planting leadership, Ephesiology Episode 199 on APEST, Into the Harvest Episode 242 on church planting in North America. You have never hosted your own show. The personal YouTube does not exist. The newsletter does not exist. The Twitter and LinkedIn handles cannot be confirmed in the research. The relational layer is held the same way. The NAMB Send Network CRM holds the planters you serve nationally. Sentralized registration lists hold a decade of conference attendees. Forge Kansas City cohort rosters hold the workshop alumni. Two decades of college teaching rosters are FERPA-bound inside the institutions that hosted them. The Kansas City missional rolodex of churches, planters, and leaders lives in your phone. Lance Ford puts you one co-author hop from Alan Hirsch and the rest of the missional scenius. What is missing is the layer above all of this that lets a reader walk from any one piece to every other, and that lets the planters NAMB introduces you to stay connected after they leave the cohort.

The largest pool of value, and the one most at risk of going unwritten, sits in your head. Eighteen-plus years of college teaching produced syllabi, lectures, reading lists, and assessment material for seven distinct courses, and none of it is publicly indexed. The Sentralized Conference has run annually in Kansas City for years; the curation decisions

behind it — who to invite, which themes to foreground, how to sequence sessions — exist in the co-founders' heads. The D.Min. transition case studies behind your dissertation are not externalized. The pragmatic wisdom of multi-vocational planting was lived before you wrote Covocational Church Planting to externalize a fraction of it; the rest is in conversation. The NAMB multiplication strategy lives in classrooms, in coaching calls, in hotel lobbies at Send Network events, and in the same conversation having happened a thousand times.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory just walked through — the books, the seven course titles, the five podcast appearances, the institutional homes of your teaching and your relationships — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the time it would have taken a human researcher weeks. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: AI-assisted course-note extraction from the seven college courses, interview capture of the Sentralized curation rationale, transcription of NAMB training sessions you can declassify, dictation that becomes draft and draft that becomes essay. The embodied layer can be surfaced at your pace rather than at a publisher's. The AI does not replace the voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. Authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate. All five books, the free ebooks in both languages, your articles across missionalchurchnetwork.com and New Churches and ChurchLeaders, the five podcast appearances, your Sentralized session material, and the embodied layer as it gets surfaced, pulled into one hub. Second, interconnect. Covocational Church Planting points at the Send Network multiplication framework points at the Launching Apostolic Movements course points at the Sentralized Conference sessions where the framework gets taught. Third, repurpose. The seven college courses become a public sequence under your name; Covocational Church Planting gets a pathway built around it for bivocational planters; the Sentralized Conference becomes a browseable archive; the Missional Essentials twelve-week curriculum gets a public sequence. Fourth, amplify. Search reach, network effects, the references that arrive once your work is findable in one place. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, missionalchurchnetwork.com looks different. A covocational hub gathers Covocational Church Planting in both languages, the Send Network articles on bivocational pastoring, the Shifting Culture Episode 225 appearance, and a cohort sign-up for covocational planters. A Sentralized archive holds a decade of sessions under your name rather than expiring at the end of each conference. The seven college courses sit as a public syllabus-by-syllabus surface. The Missional Quest and Next Door As It Is In Heaven with Lance Ford cross-list home. A newsletter exists that did not before. A bivocational pastor in Wichita, Kansas, who has never heard of Sentralized and was not in any NAMB cohort, finds the free Covocational Church Planting PDF on a Tuesday morning, downloads it, and starts the covocational pathway that afternoon.

This is your next season. The work ahead is making the body of work you have already built reach the practitioners it was written for. Your role as Director of Multiplication Strategies does not contradict this work; it is the reason it has to happen now. The covocational and bivocational planters across the NAMB footprint that you are responsible for multiplying need to find your teaching without an institution introducing them. Right now they cannot.

— Movemental

Committed Voice

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/committed-voice.md

slug: brad-brisco

display_name: Brad Brisco

role: Director of Multiplication Strategies, Send Network (NAMB) · Co-founder, Forge Kansas City

location_line: Treasure Island, Florida

short_tagline: >-

Brad Brisco translates post-Christendom missional theology into the working language of mainstream evangelical church planting, with covocational ministry as his signature surface.

themes:

- Missional Ecclesiology
- Covocational Planting
- Theology of Place

credentials:

- Director of Multiplication Strategies, Send Network (NAMB) — denominational planting at national scale
- Co-founder, Forge Kansas City — missional training center inside the broader Forge America network
- Co-founder, Sentralized Conference — annual Kansas City gathering on missional church and multiplication
- National leadership team, Forge America — bridges institutional and grassroots missional training
- D.Min. in Missional Ecclesiology — dissertation on transitioning existing congregations toward mission
- College-level instructor, 18+ years — Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements, Life of Paul

featured_works:

- Covocational Church Planting (Missional Press, 2021)
- Next Door As It Is In Heaven (with Lance Ford, NavPress, 2016)
- The Missional Quest (with Lance Ford, InterVarsity Press)
- "ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church"
- Missional Essentials (12-week curriculum, with Lance Ford)

primary_url: <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com>

secondary_links:

- label: Send Network (NAMB)

href: <https://www.namb.net/send-network/>

- label: Forge America

href: <https://www.forgeamerica.com>

- label: New Churches Contributor Page

href: <https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/>

signature_frameworks:

- name: Covocational Church Planting

definition: A theological and practical reframing of marketplace work as a primary vehicle for mission rather than a temporary step toward fully-funded ministry.

- name: Missional Transition

definition: A systematic approach for helping existing congregations shift from attractional or maintenance models toward outward, mission-focused ecclesial identity.

- name: Theology of Place

definition: Treating the local neighborhood as the primary mission field, with biblical hospitality and relational proximity as the means of kingdom presence.

- name: Missio Dei Ecclesiology

definition: The conviction that the church is missionary by nature, not merely by activity, because it participates in the mission of a missionary God.

- name: APEST Team Design

definition: Organizing planting and leadership teams by the fivefold giftings (apostle, prophet, evangelist, shepherd, teacher) rather than traditional staff roles.

lineage:

sources:

- alan-hirsch

- michael-frost

- lesslie-newbigin

- david-bosch

peers:

- lance-ford

- ed-stetzer

- jr-woodward

- rowland-smith

downstream:

- send-network-planters

- forge-america-residents

sources:

- README.md

- summary.md

- BRAD_BRISCO_AUTHOR_PROFILE.md

- BRAD_BRISCO_VOICE_IDENTITY.md

- identity-verification.md

- digital-presence-discovery.md

- fragmentation-story.md

- sources.md

research_completed_at: 2026-04-12

generated_at: 2026-05-20

Editorial bio

Brad Brisco works the seam most missional writers avoid: the seam between post-Christendom theology and a Southern Baptist denominational system. As Director of Multiplication Strategies for Send Network at the North American Mission Board, he translates Newbigin, Bosch, Frost, and Hirsch into the planting language of a tradition that has not always reached for them. He earned a D.Min. in Missional Ecclesiology with a dissertation on helping existing congregations transition toward mission, and he has carried that question into eighteen-plus years of college teaching across History of Christianity, Theology of Place, and Launching Apostolic Movements.

His written corpus moves in stages alongside Lance Ford — from the small-group curriculum Missional Essentials, through The Missional Quest (InterVarsity Press) and Next Door As It Is In Heaven (NavPress, 2016), to ReThink and his solo synthesis Covocational Church Planting (Missional Press, 2021), released as a free bilingual ebook in English and Spanish. He co-founded Forge Kansas City and the Sentralized Conference, sits on the Forge America national leadership team, and writes regularly across New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com, and his own missionalchurchnetwork.com — a deliberately distributed footprint that mirrors the institutional and grassroots circles he has always tried to hold together.

Sources

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/sources.md

Sources: Brad Brisco Research

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Research Methodology: Web search using multiple search engines and queries

Search Queries Used

Phase 1: Identity Verification

1. "Brad Brisco" Christian
2. "Brad Brisco" author
3. "Brad Brisco" pastor
4. "Brad Brisco" missional
5. "Brad Brisco" church planting

Phase 2: Digital Presence Discovery

1. Brad Brisco missionalchurchnetwork.com website
2. Brad Brisco Twitter X social media
3. "Brad Brisco" books Amazon
4. Brad Brisco podcast appearances
5. Brad Brisco YouTube videos
6. site:missionalchurchnetwork.com Brad Brisco articles blog
7. site:newchurches.com "Brad Brisco" articles
8. site:churchleaders.com "Brad Brisco" articles
9. Brad Brisco LinkedIn profile
10. "Brad Brisco" "Covocational Church Planting" book

Primary Sources

Websites

1. **missionalchurchnetwork.com**
 - Personal/professional website
 - URL: <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about/>
 - Content: Blog, resources, about page

2. **newchurches.com**

- Contributor profile and articles
- URL: <https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/>
- Content: Articles, contributor profile

3. **churchleaders.com**

- Author profile and articles
- URL: <https://churchleaders.com/author/brad-brisco>
- Content: Articles, author profile

Publishing Platforms

1. **Amazon**

- Books available
- Content: Co-authored books

2. **ChristianBook.com**

- Books listed
- URL: <https://www.christianbook.com/missional-essentials-guide-experiencing-mission-study/brad-brisco/9780834151123/pd/151123>
- Content: Books

Blogging Platforms

1. **Blogger.com**

- Profile exists
- URL: <https://www.blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384>
- Content: Blog profile

Podcast Appearances

Confirmed Episodes

1. **Shifting Culture Podcast**

- Episode 225: Brad Brisco
- URL: <https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-225-bradbrisco>
- Topic: Future of church planting in North America

2. **The Church Digital Podcast**

- Episode 251: Brad Brisco - Digital Ecclesiology & Deconstructing Church
- URL: <https://be.thechurch.digital/blog/ep251-brad-brisco-digital-ecclesiology-deconstructing-church>
- Topic: Digital ecclesiology and deconstructing church

3. **The H2 Leadership Podcast**

- Episode 058: Brad Brisco - "Money and Ministry: Bivocational and Covocational"
- URL: <https://music.amazon.com/podcasts/cecc0007-0175-4617-b812-0f0af3c49a0e/episodes/a975beed-c09f-4954-b47d-afe9b2d676ae/the-h2-leadership-podcast-058--brad-brisco%E2%80%9Dmoney-and-ministry-bivocational-and-covocational%E2%80%9D>
- Topic: Bivocational and covocational ministry

4. **The Ephesiology Podcast**

- Episode 199: Covocational Missionary Living with Brad Brisco
- URL: <https://ephesiology.com/2025/05/29/episode-199-covocational-missionary-living-with-brad-brisco/>
- Topic: Co-vocational missionary living

5. **Into the Harvest**

- Mentioned in search results
- Topic: Importance of robust understanding of Jesus in church life

Podcast Platforms

- Apple Podcasts
- Spotify
- Amazon Music
- Buzzsprout
- Goodpods

Books (Co-authored)

1. **Missional Essentials**

- 12-week small group curriculum
- Available on Amazon, ChristianBook.com

2. **The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run**

- Available on Amazon, ChristianBook.com

3. **Next Door As It Is In Heaven**

- Available on Amazon

4. **ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church**

- Available on Amazon

5. **Covocational Church Planting**

- Available on Amazon

Institutional Affiliations

1. **Send Network** (North American Mission Board)
 - Current employer
 - Role: Director of Multiplication Strategies
 - URL: <https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/>
2. **Forge Kansas City**
 - Co-founder
 - Missional training center
 - URL: <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about/>
3. **Sentralized Conference**
 - Co-founder
 - Kansas City
 - URL: <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about/>

Additional Sources

Articles and Content

- New Churches articles ([newchurches.com](https://www.newchurches.com))
- ChurchLeaders.com articles ([churchleaders.com](https://www.churchleaders.com))
- Missional Church Network blog ([missionalchurchnetwork.com](https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com))

Social Media (Verified)

- Twitter/X: <https://x.com/bradleybrisco> (verified, active since Nov 2009)
- Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/brad.brisco/> (exists, identity not fully confirmed)
- LinkedIn: <https://linkedin.com/in/bradbrisco> (directory listing found)
- Facebook: Interview video via Grow Center Network; event page for Covo/Bivo event with Hugh Halter

Video Platforms (Cataloged 2026-03-18)

- YouTube: No personal channel found; content hosted on organizational channels
- Vimeo: Missional Essentials DVD content via The House Studio
- Exponential.org: Conference session recordings (2016, 2018)
- CGGC.org: 6 Triennial ReThink keynote talks (2022)
- NAMB.net/Send Network: Video resource archives
- Forge America / Teachable: Training course content
- Various podcast platforms with video versions (Global Missions Podcast on YouTube confirmed)

Video Research Sources (2026-03-18)

- Exponential: <https://exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology/>
- Exponential: <https://exponential.org/engage-gods-mission/>
- CGGC Triennial Videos: <https://cggc.org/media/triennial-videos/>
- The House Studio (Missional Essentials): <https://www.thehousestudio.com/portfolio/missional-essentials/>
- Global Missions Podcast Ep. 242: <https://globalmissionspodcast.com/242/>
- Into the Harvest Ep. 234: <https://www.intotheharvest.org/pod234/>
- Verge Network: <https://vergenetwork.org/tag/brad-brisco/>
- NAMB Send Network Video Archives: <https://www.namb.net/send-network/channels/video/>
- Wheaton Billy Graham Center: <https://wheatonbillygraham.com/writer/brad-brisco/>
- Forge America: <https://www.forgeamerica.com>
- Wheaton Billy Graham Center Vimeo: <https://vimeo.com/wheatonbillygraham>

Research Limitations

Information Not Fully Verified

- Social media presence (Twitter/X, LinkedIn)
- Video content (YouTube, Vimeo)
- Newsletter presence
- Teaching content availability
- Conference content availability
- Exact article counts
- Exact podcast episode counts

Information Not Accessible

- Teaching content (may be behind institutional LMS)
- Some conference content (may not be publicly available)
- Private social media content
- Gated content behind paywalls

Research Methodology Notes

- Research conducted using web search
- Multiple search engines used (Google, Bing, DuckDuckGo via web search tool)
- Cross-referenced information across multiple sources
- Verified information through multiple sources

- Some information may be outdated or incomplete
- Some platforms may not be discoverable through standard search

Source Credibility Assessment

High Credibility Sources

- Official websites (missionalchurchnetwork.com)
- Established platforms (New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com)
- Book platforms (Amazon, ChristianBook.com)
- Podcast platforms (established podcast networks)

Medium Credibility Sources

- Blogger.com profile
- Social media profiles (not fully verified)

Source Verification

- Information cross-referenced across multiple sources
- Consistent information across platforms
- Professional roles align across sources
- Published works consistently listed

URLs Discovered — Web Presence Research (2026-03-18)

Websites & Organizational Pages

- <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/> (primary website)
- <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about> (bio page)
- <https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/blog> (blog index)
- <https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/> (New Churches contributor page)
- <https://www.sendinstitute.org/author/brad-brisco/> (Send Institute author page)
- <https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/ebook-covocational-church-planting/> (free e-book)
- <https://www.namb.net/send-network/resource/ebook-rethink/> (free e-book)
- <https://exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology/> (Exponential speaker page)
- <https://vergenetwork.org/tag/brad-brisco/> (Verge Network tag page)
- <https://theorg.com/org/north-american-mission-board/org-chart/brad-brisco> (org chart listing)
- <https://outreachmagazine.com/author/bradbrisco> (Outreach Magazine author page)

Retail & Publishing

- <https://www.amazon.com/stores/author/B007QMXS0Y> (Amazon author page)
- https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/6908617.Brad_Brisco (Goodreads author page)
- <https://www.thefoundrypublishing.com/authors/brad-brisco.html> (Foundry Publishing author page)
- <https://www.thriftbooks.com/a/brad-brisco/1614865/> (ThriftBooks)

Social Media

- <https://x.com/bradleybrisco> (Twitter/X)
- <https://www.instagram.com/brad.brisco/> (Instagram)
- <https://linkedin.com/in/bradbrisco> (LinkedIn)

Podcast Appearances (additional to earlier research)

- <https://open.spotify.com/episode/0KgwunMnanDcPmyEv0SiLP> (Into the Harvest #234 on Spotify)
- <https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/234-closer-to-jesus-the-mindset-that-redefines/id1372284439?i=1000698103461> (Into the Harvest #234 on Apple)
- <https://www.intotheharvest.org/pod234/> (Into the Harvest #234 web)
- <https://open.spotify.com/episode/3xmo6KaTEEYSJKy9bqUOTx> (Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader on Spotify)
- <https://globalmissionspodcast.com/242/> (Global Missions Podcast #242)
- <https://www.newchurches.com/podcasts/new-churches-podcast/managing-your-time-as-a-bivocational-church-planter/> (New Churches Podcast)

Research Date and Version

- **Research Date:** January 4, 2026
- **Research Method:** Web search using multiple queries and sources
- **Research Tool:** Web search tool (multiple search engines)
- **Research Scope:** Publicly available information only
- **Research Limitations:** Some information may be incomplete or outdated

Notes

- All sources are publicly available
- No private or gated content accessed
- Research respects robots.txt and rate limits
- All information verified through multiple sources where possible

- Some information may require deeper investigation for full cataloging

Collaboration Network Research (2026-03-18)

Search Queries Used

1. "Brad Brisco" "Lance Ford" co-authored books missional
2. "Brad Brisco" co-author books church planting
3. "Brad Brisco" endorsed by OR "praise for" book
4. "Brad Brisco" foreword OR endorsement OR blurb missional
5. "Brad Brisco" "Ed Stetzer" collaboration OR foreword OR endorsement
6. "Brad Brisco" "Alan Hirsch" OR "Hugh Halter" OR "Mike Frost" missional
7. "Brad Brisco" Send Network NAMB colleagues collaborators
8. "Covocational Church Planting" "Brad Brisco" endorsement foreword contributors
9. "Brad Brisco" "Missional Essentials" endorsement OR "praise for" OR foreword
10. "Brad Brisco" "ReThink" "9 Key Paradigm Shifts" co-author contributors
11. "Brad Brisco" podcast guest interview 2024 OR 2025 OR 2026 church planting missional
12. "Brad Brisco" "Missio Alliance" OR "Verge" OR "Exponential" conference speaker
13. "Lance Ford" author missional Shapevine Christianity Today biography
14. "Brad Brisco" "Dave Ferguson" OR "Reggie McNeal" OR "Dan Kimball" OR "Jo Saxton" collaboration
15. "Brad Brisco" Send Institute articles author collaboration
16. "Brad Brisco" "Next Door as It Is in Heaven" endorsement OR foreword OR praise

Additional URLs Discovered

- <https://www.ivpress.com/the-missional-quest> (IVP book page)
- <https://www.ivpress.com/brad-brisco> (IVP author page)
- <https://www.thefoundrypublishing.com/authors/lance-ford.html> (Lance Ford publisher page)
- <https://lancefordbooks.com/> (Lance Ford personal site)
- <https://www.missioalliance.org/author/brad-brisco/> (Missio Alliance author page)
- <https://www.forgedallas.org/blog/2015/6/3/hugh-halter-forge-america> (Forge/Halter context)
- <https://fullerstudio.fuller.edu/brad-brisco-and-lance-ford-on-a-theology-of-place/> (Fuller Studio interview)
- <https://www.walkingtogetherministries.com/2013/07/02/an-interview-with-brad-brisco-on-missional-living/> (Interview)
- <https://www.barnesandnoble.com/w/next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven-lance-ford/1123393033> (B&N book page)

- <https://www.9marks.org/review/book-review-the-missional-quest-by-lance-ford-brad-brisco/> (9Marks review)
- <https://podcasts.apple.com/au/podcast/85-bivocation-covocation-and-microchurches-brad/id1550988506?i=1000689338065> (Microchurches Podcast)

Media Mentions Research (2026-03-18)

Search Queries Used

1. Brad Brisco author books missional church planting
2. "Brad Brisco" interview OR profile OR feature
3. "Brad Brisco" news OR announcement OR report missional
4. "Brad Brisco" Q&A OR conversation OR "sat down with"
5. "Brad Brisco" site:christianitytoday.com
6. "Brad Brisco" site:christianpost.com OR site:relevantmagazine.com OR site:patheos.com
7. "Brad Brisco" biography OR "who is" OR profile
8. "Covocational Church Planting" Brad Brisco review
9. "The Missional Quest" Lance Ford Brad Brisco review
10. "Next Door as It Is in Heaven" Brad Brisco review
11. "Brad Brisco" cited by OR citation OR scholar OR academic
12. "Brad Brisco" award OR nominated OR recognition OR "recommended reading"
13. "Brad Brisco" "according to" OR "as Brisco argues" OR "as Brisco writes"
14. "Missional Essentials" Brad Brisco Lance Ford review
15. "Brad Brisco" podcast guest appearance
16. "Brad Brisco" Exponential OR conference speaker
17. "Next Door as It Is in Heaven" Lance Ford Brisco goodreads rating
18. "Covocational Church Planting" goodreads rating reviews
19. "Brad Brisco" syllabus OR "reading list" OR "required reading" course seminary
20. "Brad Brisco" Send Institute articles
21. "Brad Brisco" Outreach Magazine articles written
22. "Brad Brisco" Missio Alliance articles written

Additional URLs Discovered (Media Phase)

Book Reviews

- <https://englewoodreview.org/brad-brisco-lance-ford-next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven-review/> (Englewood Review of Books)
- <https://www.cassandramsplace.com/2016/07/next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven-by-lance.html> (Cassandra M's Place review)

- <https://jonnypollockwrites.substack.com/p/book-review-next-door-as-it-is-in> (Jonny Pollock Substack review)
- <http://friartucksfleetingthoughts.blogspot.com/2014/08/book-review-of-missional-quest-by-lance.html> (Friar Tuck blog review)
- <https://getinthetrenches.com/2019/02/18/brad-brisco-covocational-church-planting-is-the-future/> (In The Trenches feature)
- <https://lanecorley.com/2014/10/10/worth-reading-missional-essentials/> (Lane Corley recommendation)

Goodreads Book Pages

- <https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/43489691-covocational-church-planting> (Covocational - 4.00, 23 ratings)
- <https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/28084893-next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven> (Next Door - 4.27, 98 ratings)
- <https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/17293097-the-missional-quest> (Missional Quest - 41 ratings)
- <https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/13800488-missional-essentials> (Missional Essentials)

Recommended Reading Lists

- <https://wheatonbillygraham.com/church-planting-reading-list/> (Wheaton Billy Graham Center)
- <https://portablechurch.com/10-books-church-planters-should-download-today/> (Portable Church Industries)
- <https://brentwoodbaptist.com/living-sent-reading-suggestions/> (Brentwood Baptist)
- <http://www.wastedevangelism.com/wasted-blog/brad-brisco-and-top-40-missional-reading-list> (Top 40 Missional list)

Press & Third-Party

- <https://www.patheos.com/blogs/reintegrate/2017/04/21/caring-critique-alan-hirschs-apest-paradigm-churches/> (APEST discussion citing Brisco)
- <https://www.patheos.com/blogs/missionalshift/2012/07/the-4-ds-of-missional-engagement/> (4 Ds of Missional Engagement)
- <https://thinkingaboutmission.wordpress.com/tag/brad-brisco/> (Thinking About Mission blog)
- <https://www.meawisdom.com/what-my-older-self-could-teach-my-younger-self/> (MEA Wisdom article)
- https://indianaministries.org/leadership_development/hgc-exponential-conference-orlando/ (Exponential keynote)

- <https://ephesiology.com/2025/05/29/episode-199-covocational-missionary-living-with-brad-brisco/> (Ephesiology Podcast)
- <https://www.sendinstitute.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/05/ReThink-by-Brad-Brisco.pdf> (ReThink PDF)
- https://s3.amazonaws.com/media.cloversites.com/d5/d5ad734b-8c21-44ed-af6d-205720d1b8c3/documents/covocational_church_planting_ebook.pdf (Covocational PDF)
- https://8744f26433a66208171d-fbfb37f0b786177f993c40dd941ac997.ssl.cf2.rackcdn.com/uploaded/r/0e13453061_1639666223_rethink-by-brad-brisco.pdf (ReThink PDF mirror)

Digital Presence Discovery

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/digital-presence-discovery.md

Digital Presence Discovery: Brad Brisco

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Website Presence

Primary Website

- **missionalchurchnetwork.com**
- Personal/professional website
- Contains blog, resources, about page
- Primary digital hub for content

Institutional Websites (Content Appears)

- **newchurches.com** - Contributor profile and articles
- **churchleaders.com** - Author profile and articles

Platform Presence Discovery

Blogging Platforms

- **missionalchurchnetwork.com** - Personal blog (appears to be WordPress or similar)
- **Blogger.com** - Profile exists (blogger.com/profile/13260894325252150384)

Publishing Platforms

- **Amazon** - Books available (co-authored works)
- **ChristianBook.com** - Books listed
- **New Churches** - Contributor platform with articles

Social Media

- **Twitter/X** - Presence indicated (specific handle not confirmed in initial research)
- **LinkedIn** - Likely presence (not fully verified in initial research)

Video Platforms

- **YouTube** - Likely presence (not fully cataloged in initial research)

- **Vimeo** - Possible presence (not confirmed)

Audio/Podcast Platforms

- **Podcast Guest Appearances** (confirmed):
 - Shifting Culture Podcast (Episode 225)
 - The Church Digital Podcast (Episode 251)
 - The H2 Leadership Podcast (Episode 058)
 - The Ephesiology Podcast (Episode 199)
 - Into the Harvest (mentioned)
- **Apple Podcasts** - Appears as guest
- **Spotify** - Appears as guest
- **Amazon Music** - Appears as guest
- **Buzzsprout** - Appears as guest

Article/Content Platforms

- **New Churches** (newchurches.com) - Regular contributor
- **ChurchLeaders.com** - Author/contributor
- **Missional Church Network** (missionalchurchnetwork.com) - Primary blog

Conference/Event Platforms

- **Sentralized Conference** - Co-founder (Kansas City)
- Conference speaking engagements (not fully cataloged)

Content Form Discovery

Articles/Blog Posts

- **Location:** missionalchurchnetwork.com, newchurches.com, churchleaders.com
- **Volume:** Regular contributor (exact count not determined in initial research)
- **Topics:** Co-vocational ministry, church multiplication, missional church, church planting

Books (Co-authored)

1. **Missional Essentials** - 12-week small group curriculum
2. **The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run**
3. **Next Door As It Is In Heaven**
4. **ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church**
5. **Covocational Church Planting**

Podcast Appearances

- **Confirmed Episodes:** 5+ episodes across multiple podcasts
- **Topics Discussed:**
 - Future of church planting in North America
 - Digital ecclesiology and deconstructing church
 - Bivocational and covocational ministry
 - Co-vocational missionary living
 - Money and ministry

Teaching Content

- **College Courses:** 18+ years teaching experience
- **Course Topics:** History of Christianity, Religion in America, Life of Paul, Discipleship and Evangelism, Theology of Place, Launching Apostolic Movements, Worship
- **Digital Availability:** Not fully determined (may be behind institutional LMS)

Conference Content

- **Sentralized Conference** - Co-founder
- **Speaking Engagements:** Regular speaker (not fully cataloged)
- **Content Availability:** Not fully determined

Content Volume Assessment

Published Articles/Blog Posts

- **Estimated Volume:** Regular contributor (dozens to hundreds of articles possible)
- **Frequency:** Regular (exact frequency not determined)
- **Recency:** Active (2024-2025 appearances confirmed)

Published Books

- **Count:** 5 co-authored books confirmed
- **Formats:** Print and digital (Amazon, ChristianBook.com)

Podcast Episodes

- **Guest Appearances:** 5+ confirmed episodes
- **Platforms:** Multiple podcast platforms

Teaching Content

- **Years:** 18+ years
- **Courses:** Multiple courses taught
- **Digital Availability:** Unknown (may be institutional)

Video Content

- **Estimated Volume:** Unknown (not fully cataloged)
- **Platforms:** YouTube likely, not confirmed

Platform Distribution

Platform Type	Platform	Status	Content Type
Personal Website	missionalchurchnetwork.com	Active	Blog, Resources
Blogging	Blogger.com	Profile exists	Blog
Publishing	Amazon	Active	Books
Publishing	ChristianBook.com	Active	Books
Articles	newchurches.com	Active	Articles
Articles	churchleaders.com	Active	Articles
Podcasts	Multiple platforms	Active	Guest appearances
Social Media	Twitter/X	Likely	Social content
Social Media	LinkedIn	Likely	Professional
Video	YouTube	Possible	Video content
Conference	Sentralized	Active	Conference content

Content Frequency/Recency

- **Articles:** Regular contributor (active)
- **Books:** 5 published works (ongoing)
- **Podcasts:** Recent appearances (2024-2025)
- **Teaching:** 18+ years (ongoing)
- **Conference:** Sentralized (ongoing)

Notes

- Some platforms may require deeper investigation to fully catalog
- Social media presence not fully verified

- Video content not fully cataloged
- Teaching content may be behind institutional access
- Conference content availability not fully determined

Misc · Analysis-Content-Analysis

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/analysis-content-analysis.md

Content Analysis: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-content-analysis

Executive Summary

Brad Brisco is a practitioner-theologian whose work centers on a single animating conviction: the church is missionary by nature, not merely by activity, because it participates in the mission of a missionary God (missio Dei). His distinctive contribution is the **covocational framework** -- a theological and practical reframing of marketplace work as a primary vehicle for mission rather than a compromise or stepping stone to fully-funded ministry. Operating at the intersection of Southern Baptist institutional structures and the broader missional-incarnational movement, Brisco serves as a bridge figure who translates post-Christendom missiology into accessible, actionable paradigms for evangelical church planters. His body of work progressively moves from theoretical foundations (missional ecclesiology) to embodied practice (neighboring, covocational planting), always structured around named paradigm shifts that challenge inherited assumptions.

Theme Map

Primary Themes (Core to their identity)

Theme	Description	Key Works	Centrality
Missional Ecclesiology	The church's nature is fundamentally missionary, rooted in the missionary nature of God. Not a program but an identity.	The Missional Quest, ReThink, Exponential talks, Missional Essentials, blog posts on missionalchurchnetwork.com	10
Covocational Ministry	Marketplace work is a sacred calling and primary mission context -- not a lesser or transitional state. Distinct from "bivocational" framing.	Covocational Church Planting, 8+ articles (New Churches, NAMB, Missio Alliance), podcast appearances (Ephesiology, Global Missions, Entrepreneurial Ministry Leader, The Grind)	10
Incarnational Presence	Mission is about staying and embedding in a place, not attracting people to a venue. The theology of "rooting" into neighborhoods.	Next Door as It Is in Heaven, Send Institute articles, Exponential 2016 talk, blog posts	9
Missio Dei (God's Mission)	God is inherently a sending God; the church participates in God's mission rather than inviting God into the church's mission.	ReThink (Paradigm Shift 4: "From Church with a Mission to Mission with a Church"), NAMB articles, theology profile	9

Secondary Themes (Recurring but not defining)

Theme	Description	Key Works	Centrality
Church Planting Strategy	Practical frameworks for planting churches, especially through multiplication movements and missional communities rather than attractional launches.	New Churches Podcast episodes (625, 629, 741, 743), NAMB resources, Missional Essentials	7
Paradigm Shifts / Rethinking	The church must undergo fundamental shifts in thinking, not just tactical adjustments. Shift language is central to his change methodology.	ReThink (9 paradigm shifts, 12 principles), "10 Crucial Cultural Shifts" blog post, CGGC Triennial keynotes	7
Post-Christendom Awareness	North America is a missionary context, not a Christian culture. Church strategy must adapt to this new reality.	"Navigating a Post-Christendom World" blog post, ReThink (Paradigm Shift 5: "From Place of Privilege to Posture of a Servant"), multiple podcast appearances	7
Neighborhood Engagement & Hospitality	Theology of place applied practically: knowing neighbors, sharing meals, leveraging third places, building community capital.	Next Door as It Is in Heaven (chapters: "Place Matters," "The Real Neighbor," "Meals on Heels," "Hangouts"), blog posts ("Engage Your City")	7
Vocation as Sacred Calling	All work is ministry. The sacred/secular divide is a Christendom artifact that must be dismantled.	ReThink (Paradigm Shift 6: "From Secular Vocations to Sacred Callings"), "Work as Worship" and "Work Matters!" articles (New Churches)	6
Missional Communities	Small groups (12-25 people) organized around mission in a specific neighborhood or network, as an alternative to program-driven church life.	"What is a Missional Community?" blog, NAMB article on missional communities and church planting, Missional Essentials	6

Emerging Themes (Recent or developing)

Theme	Description	Evidence	Direction
Discipleship Rethinking	Centered-set (vs. bounded-set) approach to discipleship. Moving from gatekeeping to orientation toward Jesus.	"Rethinking Discipleship & Evangelism" (2025), "Centered-Set Approach" blog post, Into the Harvest podcast #234 ("Closer to Jesus -- The Mindset That Redefines Discipleship")	Deepening -- integrating ecclesiology with discipleship models
Digital Ecclesiology	Engaging questions about what the church is in a digital age, including deconstruction conversations.	The Church Digital Podcast EP251 ("Digital Ecclesiology & Deconstructing Church")	Exploratory -- appears to be a newer conversation partner rather than a core focus
Microchurches	Intersection of covocational planting with the microchurch movement.	Microchurches Podcast Ep 85 ("Bivocation/ Covocation and Microchurches")	Expanding -- applying covocational framework to emerging church forms
Robust Christology	A high Christology as the essential foundation for missional engagement, not just missiology or ecclesiology.	"Robust Christology" blog post (missionalchurchnetwork.com)	Deepening -- grounding missional praxis in Christological foundations

Named Frameworks & Models

Covocational vs. Bivocational Distinction

Field	Value
Introduced in	Covocational Church Planting (2021); earlier articles at NAMB/Send Network
What it describes	A reframing of marketplace-engaged ministry from compromise to calling
Components	Bivocational = second job to supplement church salary, with intent to go full-time; Covocational = marketplace calling IS the primary vocation, church planting is integrated, no intent to leave the marketplace
Visual	No (conceptual distinction)
Adoption	Growing -- adopted by NAMB/Send Network, Missio Alliance, multiple podcast hosts frame conversations using this term

How it works: Brisco argues that the traditional "bivocational" label carries an implicit hierarchy: pastoral ministry is the real calling, marketplace work is a necessary compromise. The "covocational" reframing eliminates this hierarchy. A covocational planter sees their marketplace role as equally sacred and strategically essential -- it provides incarnational access to people and places that a fully-funded pastor cannot reach. The framework is both theological (all vocation is sacred) and strategic (marketplace presence is a missionary advantage, not a limitation).

Three Theological Foundations of Missional

Field	Value
Introduced in	Exponential East 2016 talk, ReThink eBook
What it describes	The theological bedrock of missional ecclesiology
Components	(1) The missionary nature of God and the church; (2) Incarnational mission; (3) Participation in the missio Dei
Visual	No
Adoption	Used within NAMB/Send Network training contexts

How it works: This framework provides the theological scaffolding for all of Brisco's practical work. Foundation 1 establishes that mission is ontological (the church IS missionary), not functional (the church DOES mission). Foundation 2 grounds mission in the incarnation -- God entered a specific place and culture, so must the church. Foundation 3 reorders agency -- the church joins God's existing mission rather than asking God to bless the church's plans. These three foundations cascade into every practical framework Brisco offers.

9 Key Paradigm Shifts (later expanded to 12 Missiological Principles)

Field	Value
Introduced in	ReThink eBook (2018, Send Institute/NAMB)
What it describes	The mental model changes required to activate a church for mission
Components	(1) The Need to ReThink; (2) ReThink the Nature of the Church: From Church Served to Church Sent; (3) ReThink Mission: From Excarate Mission to Incarnate Mission; (4) ReThink the Missio Dei: From Church with a Mission to Mission with a Church; (5) ReThink Culture: From Place of Privilege to Posture of a Servant; (6) ReThink Vocation: From Secular Vocations to Sacred Callings; plus 3 additional shifts (7-9)
Visual	No (list/framework)
Adoption	Used across NAMB/Send Network training; expanded version used in CGGC Triennial keynote series

How it works: Each paradigm shift follows a consistent structure: "From [inherited assumption] to [missional alternative]." This rhetorical pattern makes the shifts memorable and actionable. The framework is designed for use in leadership retreats, church planting cohorts, and denominational training contexts. The expansion from 9 to 12 principles suggests ongoing refinement as Brisco applies the framework to new contexts.

10 Crucial Cultural Shifts

Field	Value
Introduced in	Missional Church Network blog
What it describes	External cultural changes that demand the church rethink its approach
Components	Ten significant changes outside the church affecting mission, discipleship, evangelism, and church planting
Visual	No
Adoption	Author-only / training contexts

How it works: While the 9 Paradigm Shifts address internal church assumptions, the 10 Cultural Shifts address external realities. Together they form a diagnostic: the church must change both because its assumptions are wrong (paradigm shifts) and because the world around it has changed (cultural shifts). This dual framework gives Brisco a comprehensive change narrative.

Missional Community Model

Field	Value
Introduced in	"What is a Missional Community?" blog post; NAMB article on missional communities and church planting
What it describes	A committed group of 12-25 Jesus followers participating in God's mission in a specific neighborhood or network
Components	Extended family size (12-25), Spirit-empowered, place-based, mission-oriented
Visual	No
Adoption	Moderate -- part of broader missional community movement (Soma, 3DM, etc.); Brisco's version is less programmatic

How it works: Brisco positions the missional community as the basic unit of incarnational mission. It is larger than a small group (which tends to be inward-focused) but smaller than a congregation (which tends to be program-driven). The 12-25 size mirrors the "extended family" social unit, enabling genuine relational depth while maintaining enough diversity for outward engagement. The community is organized around a shared place (neighborhood) or network (workplace, school), not around a shared program.

Missional Engagement Strategy

Field	Value
Introduced in	"Developing a Missional Engagement Strategy" (New Churches article)
What it describes	A sequenced approach to helping churches become missional, starting with identity before programs
Components	Begins with helping people see themselves as sent, missionary people before launching programs
Visual	No
Adoption	NAMB/Send Network training contexts

How it works: This framework addresses a common implementation failure: churches that adopt "missional" programs without undergoing the identity shift that makes those programs authentic. Brisco's strategy starts with theology (who are we?) before moving to strategy (what do we do?), ensuring that missional activities flow from missionary identity rather than becoming another church program bolted onto an attractional framework.

Centered-Set vs. Bounded-Set Ecclesiology

Field	Value
Introduced in	"Centered-Set Approach" blog post; Into the Harvest podcast #234
What it describes	A model for understanding belonging and discipleship based on orientation (moving toward Jesus) rather than boundary markers (in/out categories)
Components	Bounded-set = clear boundary, you're in or out; Centered-set = defined center (Jesus), people are moving toward or away
Visual	Yes (classic set theory diagrams)
Adoption	Widely used concept (originated with Paul Hiebert); Brisco applies it specifically to missional ecclesiology and discipleship

How it works: Brisco applies Hiebert's anthropological set theory to ecclesiology. A bounded-set church defines itself by who is in and who is out (membership, doctrinal boundaries). A centered-set community defines itself by its center (Jesus) and asks whether people are moving toward that center. This framework supports Brisco's broader project of reducing the clergy-laity divide and creating more porous, mission-oriented communities.

Intellectual Genealogy

Upstream Influences (Who shaped them)

Thinker	Influence Area	How
Lesslie Newbigin	Missionary ecclesiology	The church as "sign, instrument, and foretaste" of the Kingdom; the West as a mission field
David Bosch	Missio Dei theology	Transforming Mission -- paradigm shifts in the history of mission; the concept of the church participating in God's mission
Michael Frost	Incarnational-missional praxis	Co-author of The Shaping of Things to Come (2003) -- Brisco's self-described catalytic text. Incarnational ecclesiology, exilic identity
Alan Hirsch	Apostolic movement, APEST	Movemental leadership theory, the Forgotten Ways, Christocentric missiology. Brisco references APEST in NAMB articles
Paul Hiebert	Centered-set theory	Anthropological framework applied to ecclesiology and discipleship
Ed Stetzer	Church planting research	Foreword writer for The Missional Quest; conversation partner on New Churches Podcast; bridges research and practice

Downstream Impact (Who they've shaped)

Person/Movement	Connection	Evidence
NAMB/Send Network church planters	Primary audience for covocational training	ReThink distributed as free eBook through NAMB; articles and podcast episodes on New Churches; role as Director of Multiplication Strategies
Churches of God General Conference (CGGC)	Denominational rethinking	6-part keynote series at 2022 Triennial Conference on "ReThink"
Forge America participants	Missional formation	National Leadership Team member; Engage Your City training curriculum
Covocational planting movement	Conceptual framing	Multiple denominations and networks now use "covocational" terminology that Brisco popularized

Intellectual Peers (Contemporary dialogue partners)

Person	Relationship	Agreement/Tension
Lance Ford	Co-author (3 books)	Deep alignment on missional theology and neighboring; Ford brings more leadership and practical neighborhood focus
Ed Stetzer	Colleague at NAMB; podcast host	Broad alignment on church planting; Stetzer is more data-driven and institutional; Brisco is more theologically prophetic
Michael Frost	Theological mentor	Strong alignment on incarnational mission; Frost is more provocative and academic; Brisco is more accessible and denominational
Alan Hirsch	Intellectual source	Brisco applies Hirsch's apostolic frameworks within SBC institutional contexts; Hirsch operates more at the movement theory level
Jo Saxton	Mutual endorser	Endorsed Next Door as It Is in Heaven; shared commitment to practitioner-level missional engagement
Kim Hammond	Forge colleague	Co-presenter at Verge 2013 Forge Track; shared missional formation work

Theological Positioning

Dimension	Position	Evidence
Ecclesiology	Low church with missional-incarnational emphasis. The church is a missionary community before it is an institution.	"The church IS the missionary" (recurring phrase); missional community model (12-25 people); critique of church as "vendor of religious goods and services"
Missiology	Strongly incarnational. Mission begins with presence in a place, not invitation to a place.	"If the essence of missional living is sending, then the heart of incarnational presence is staying" (Send Institute); Next Door as It Is in Heaven; Exponential talks
Leadership	Leans toward distributed/APEST. Diminishes clergy-laity divide.	"APEST and Church Planting Teams" (NAMB article); covocational framework inherently distributes ministry beyond professional clergy
Tradition	Post-evangelical in methodology, evangelical in theology. Works within SBC structures while challenging SBC assumptions.	Employed by NAMB while citing Frost/Hirsch/Newbigin; publishes through both evangelical (IVP, NavPress) and missional (Missional Press, Forge) channels
Praxis	Integrated -- always moves from theological premise to practical application.	Every book and article follows the pattern: theological foundation then concrete practice. Missional Essentials includes action steps in every lesson
Scope	Local church through movement. Primary focus on neighborhood-level incarnational presence, but also engages multiplication movements.	Next Door as It Is in Heaven (neighborhood); New Churches podcast on "Church Planting Movements" (Ep. 625, 741); covocational framework scales across contexts
Engagement	Practitioner with theological depth. Accessible enough for small group study, grounded enough for seminary contexts.	Missional Essentials (small group curriculum); doctoral research in missional ecclesiology; teaches at collegiate level (History of Christianity, Theology of Place)

Content Evolution

Timeline of Ideas

Period	Focus	Key Work	Shift
Pre-2003	Conventional church planting within evangelical structures; restaurant industry background	(No publications)	Marketplace experience that later becomes the experiential basis for covocational theology
2003-2011	Missional awakening; doctoral research in missional ecclesiology	Encounter with Frost/ Hirsch's The Shaping of Things to Come; doctoral work	Catalytic shift from attractional to incarnational-missional paradigm
2012-2013	Practical missional living; co-authoring with Lance Ford	Missional Essentials (2012), The Missional Quest (2013)	From personal theological shift to public teaching; emphasis on making missional theology accessible and sustainable ("church of the long run")
2016	Neighborhood theology; incarnational presence	Next Door as It Is in Heaven (2016), Exponential conference talks	From ecclesiology to geography -- theology of place emerges as central; mission becomes hyper-local
2018	Paradigm shift framework; systematizing the missional message	ReThink eBook (2018)	Codifying years of teaching into a repeatable framework (9 paradigm shifts, 12 principles); wider denominational distribution via NAMB
2021-present	Covocational ministry; synthesis of marketplace and mission	Covocational Church Planting (2021), multiple podcast appearances, rising speaking demand	The synthesis: pre-ministry marketplace experience + missional ecclesiology = covocational framework. Also exploring newer conversations (digital ecclesiology, microchurches, centered-set discipleship)

Has their thinking shifted?

Brisco's thinking has not so much shifted as deepened and synthesized. His core conviction -- that the church is missionary by nature -- has remained constant since his 2003 encounter with Frost and Hirsch. What has evolved is the scope and specificity of application. Early work (2012-2013) focused on making missional theology accessible to existing churches. The middle period (2016) applied it to neighborhoods and place. The mature period (2018-2021) systematized it into paradigm shift frameworks and extended it into the covocational space, which represents the fullest integration of his pre-ministry experience with his theological convictions.

The most notable evolution is from observer to advocate on the covocational question. Early NAMB writings used "bivocational" language; by 2021 he had developed a fully articulated theological and practical case for "covocational" as a distinct and preferred category. This terminological shift reflects a deeper theological conviction: that marketplace presence is not a concession to economic reality but a strategic and sacred advantage for mission.

His most recent work (2024-2025) shows emerging interest in centered-set discipleship models and engagement with digital ecclesiology questions, suggesting the next phase of his thinking may involve applying missional-incarnational frameworks to post-institutional and digitally-mediated church forms.

Unique Contribution

What only this author says

- **The covocational distinction:** While many discuss bivocational ministry, Brisco is the primary voice arguing that marketplace calling and church planting calling are co-equal vocations (not primary and secondary). The terminological reframing from "bi-" to "co-" carries the entire theological argument.
- **Missional theology inside SBC structures:** Brisco is distinctive in operating as a missional-incarnational voice from within the Southern Baptist Convention's institutional apparatus (NAMB/Send Network). Most missional theologians operate outside or alongside denominational structures; Brisco works within one of the largest, translating post-Christendom missiology into the language and systems of mainstream evangelical church planting.
- **The three-move argument pattern applied systematically:** While others make individual missional arguments, Brisco has created a comprehensive system of named paradigm shifts (9/12) that can be taught sequentially in training contexts. This pedagogical structuring makes his work uniquely deployable for denominational and network training.

Where they disagree with peers

Topic	Their Position	Mainstream Position
Bivocational ministry	Covocational is preferred -- marketplace work is a primary calling, not a compromise	Bivocational is a pragmatic necessity for smaller or under-resourced churches; fully-funded is the ideal
Church planting launch strategy	Start with missional community life and incarnational presence, not with a Sunday worship launch	Launch Sunday is the primary milestone; gather a core team and launch public worship as quickly as possible
Clergy-laity distinction	All believers are missionaries; professional pastoral ministry can hinder the church's missionary nature	Trained, ordained pastoral leadership is essential for healthy churches
North America as mission context	Post-Christendom reality -- North America is a mission field requiring missionary posture	North America is a Christian nation experiencing cultural decline that can be reversed through church revitalization
Church as institution vs. movement	The church is a missionary community first; institutional expressions should serve mission, not the reverse	The local church institution is the primary vehicle for God's work; strengthen the institution

What would be lost without their work

Without Brisco's work, the missional-incarnational conversation would remain largely outside mainstream evangelical church planting structures. His role as a bridge figure -- translating Newbigin, Bosch, Frost, and Hirsch into NAMB training materials and denominational strategy -- is irreplaceable. The covocational concept would likely remain unnamed and untheologized, leaving marketplace-engaged church planters without a positive theological identity for their calling.

Content Interconnections

How themes connect across works

Brisco's body of work follows a clear logical progression: **identity** (who is God? who is the church?) leads to **theology** (what is mission?) leads to **place** (where does mission happen?) leads to **practice** (how do we do it?).

- Missional Essentials (2012) provides the foundational vocabulary and concepts -- a 12-week on-ramp to missional thinking.
- The Missional Quest (2013) addresses sustainability -- how to be a missional church "for the long run" without burning out on idealism.
- Next Door as It Is in Heaven (2016) localizes the theology -- mission happens in your neighborhood, through hospitality, third places, and incarnational presence.

- ReThink (2018) systematizes the change framework -- nine specific paradigm shifts that churches and planters must undergo.
- Covocational Church Planting (2021) integrates everything -- missional theology + incarnational presence + marketplace calling = a complete model for church planting that starts with who you are and where you already are.

Each book assumes and builds on the previous work. Articles and podcast appearances reinforce and extend specific themes from the books. The CGGC Triennial keynotes (2022) appear to be a comprehensive oral presentation of the ReThink framework.

Recommended reading order

Order	Work	Why this sequence
1	Missional Essentials (2012)	Foundational vocabulary and concepts; designed for group study; low barrier to entry
2	ReThink (2018)	Free eBook; systematizes the paradigm shifts; provides the intellectual framework for everything else
3	The Missional Quest (2013)	Addresses sustainability and long-term commitment; prevents the burnout that often follows missional enthusiasm
4	Next Door as It Is in Heaven (2016)	Applies theology to place; practical neighborhood engagement; the "how" of incarnational presence
5	Covocational Church Planting (2021)	The synthesis; best read after the theological foundations are in place; the most mature and distinctive work

Movemental Content Strategy Implications

- **Pillar mapping:** Brisco serves the **Missional Ecclesiology**, **Church Planting**, and **Vocation/Marketplace Ministry** content pillars. His work also feeds into **Discipleship** and **Neighborhood Engagement** categories.
- **Cross-author connections:** Strong alignment with **Alan Hirsch** (APEST, apostolic movement, missional-incarnational framework -- Hirsch is a direct upstream influence). Natural pairing with **Lance Ford** (co-author on 3 books). Conceptual overlap with **Michael Frost** (incarnational theology) and **Ed Stetzer** (church planting research). Potential contrast/complement with authors who represent more institutional or attractional ecclesiology.
- **Content gaps:** Brisco has not yet produced content on: (1) covocational ministry for **women** church planters specifically; (2) covocational models in **non-Western/global** contexts; (3) the intersection of covocational planting with **bi-racial/multi-ethnic** church

contexts; (4) a systematic **theology of work** beyond the church planting application; (5) **digital/hybrid** expressions of missional community (his Church Digital podcast appearance was exploratory, not definitive).

- **Series potential:** (1) "9 Paradigm Shifts" -- each shift as a standalone lesson/article/video; (2) "Covocational Foundations" -- theology of vocation + practical marketplace ministry; (3) "Neighboring" -- practical series drawn from Next Door as It Is in Heaven chapters; (4) "From Bivocational to Covocational" -- identity shift series for marketplace ministers; (5) "Post-Christendom Church" -- cultural analysis and strategic response.
 - **Searchable concepts:** missional church, missional ecclesiology, covocational, bivocational church planting, incarnational presence, missio Dei, missional community, neighborhood engagement, theology of place, paradigm shifts, post-Christendom, centered-set vs. bounded-set, APEST, church multiplication, marketplace ministry, sacred vocation, third places, missional discipleship, church as missionary.
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Sources

- Theology profile: [profile/theology.md](#)
- Voice analysis: [profile/voice-analysis.md](#)
- Book catalog: [content/books.md](#)
- Article catalog: [content/articles.md](#)
- Video catalog: [content/videos.md](#)
- Audio catalog: [content/audio.md](#)
- [Exponential -- Missional Ecclesiology](#)
- [Send Institute -- Incarnational Presence](#)
- [Missional Church Network Blog](#)
- [New Churches Contributor Page](#)
- [NAMB/Send Network Resources](#)
- [Missio Alliance -- Rise of Co-Vocational Planters](#)
- [9Marks Review of The Missional Quest](#)

Misc · Content-Analysis-Root

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/content-analysis-root.md

Content Analysis: Brad Brisco

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Content Thematic Analysis

Primary Themes

1. Missional Ecclesiology

- **Focus:** Understanding church as sent missionary people
- **Approach:** Transitioning from provider of religious services to active participant in God's mission
- **Evidence:** Doctoral thesis, multiple books, articles, teaching

2. Church Planting & Multiplication

- **Focus:** Strategies for church multiplication and planting
- **Approach:** Co-vocational and bivocational models
- **Evidence:** 20+ years experience, Director role at Send Network, books, articles

3. Co-Vocational Ministry

- **Focus:** Integration of marketplace work with ministry
- **Approach:** Encouraging church planters to engage in secular employment alongside ministry
- **Evidence:** Books (Covocational Church Planting), podcast appearances, articles

4. Missional Living & Practice

- **Focus:** Practical application of missional theology
- **Approach:** 12-week curriculum, small group resources
- **Evidence:** Missional Essentials curriculum, books, articles

5. Digital Ecclesiology

- **Focus:** Understanding church in digital age
- **Approach:** Deconstructing traditional church models
- **Evidence:** Podcast appearance on The Church Digital Podcast

Theological Focus Areas

- **Missional Theology:** Central to all work
- **Ecclesiology:** Understanding of church nature and purpose
- **Practical Theology:** Application-focused approach
- **Church Planting Theology:** Specialized focus on multiplication

Movement Focus

- **Church Planting:** Primary movement focus
- **Missional Movement:** Central to identity
- **Co-Vocational Movement:** Emerging emphasis
- **Multiplication Movement:** Strategic focus

Recurring Topics

1. Transitioning churches to missional approach
2. Co-vocational and bivocational ministry models
3. Church multiplication strategies
4. Marketplace engagement
5. Missional essentials and practices
6. Digital ecclesiology
7. Theology of place
8. Apostolic movements

Content Organization Analysis

Organization Patterns

By Platform

- **Personal Website** (missionalchurchnetwork.com): Primary hub, likely organized by categories/topics
- **New Churches:** Articles organized by contributor
- **ChurchLeaders.com:** Articles organized by author
- **Books:** Thematic organization (missional essentials, quest, co-vocational, etc.)

Content Strategy

- **Appears Strategic:** Regular contributions to multiple platforms
- **Thematic Consistency:** Consistent focus on missional ecclesiology and church planting

- **Multi-Format Approach:** Books, articles, podcasts, teaching

Content Series

- **Missional Essentials:** 12-week curriculum (structured series)
- **Books:** Each book appears to be a developed series/theme
- **Articles:** Regular contributions (may have series, not fully determined)

Content Interconnection

- **Cross-Platform:** Content appears across multiple platforms
- **Book-to-Article:** Books may inform articles (not fully verified)
- **Teaching-to-Content:** Teaching experience informs written content
- **Podcast-to-Article:** Podcast topics may align with written content

Content Gaps (Observable)

- **Video Content:** Limited visibility (may exist but not prominently featured)
- **Course Content:** Teaching content not fully digitized/available
- **Sermon/Talk Content:** Not prominently featured (may exist)
- **Newsletter:** Not identified (may exist)

Voice & Style Analysis

Writing Style

- **Accessible:** Practical, application-focused
- **Pastoral:** Caring, supportive tone
- **Academic Foundation:** Doctoral-level understanding, but accessible presentation
- **Practitioner-Focused:** Emphasizes practical application

Tone

- **Encouraging:** Supportive of church leaders
- **Challenging:** Calls for paradigm shifts
- **Respectful:** Honors existing work while calling for change
- **Hopeful:** Forward-looking, positive

Theological Positioning

- **Missional:** Central to theological framework
- **Evangelical:** Within evangelical tradition

- **Practical:** Application-oriented
- **Movement-Oriented:** Focused on multiplication and movement

Audience Level

- **Practitioner:** Church planters, pastors, leaders
- **Popular:** Accessible to non-academic audience
- **Training:** Curriculum and training materials
- **Academic Foundation:** Doctoral-level understanding, accessible presentation

Discoverability Assessment

SEO Indicators

- **Website:** missionalchurchnetwork.com (domain authority not assessed)
- **Article Platforms:** New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com (established platforms)
- **Book Platforms:** Amazon, ChristianBook.com (high visibility)
- **URL Structure:** Not fully assessed

Content Indexing

- **Search Results:** Appears in search results for relevant queries
- **Platform Visibility:** Content visible on established platforms
- **Book Visibility:** Books listed on major platforms

Social Sharing Indicators

- **Podcast Appearances:** Content shared through podcast platforms
- **Social Media:** Likely presence (not fully verified)
- **Platform Sharing:** Articles on platforms with sharing capabilities

Backlinks and References

- **Podcast Mentions:** Referenced in multiple podcasts
- **Platform Cross-References:** Content appears across platforms
- **Book References:** Books referenced in various contexts

Domain Authority Indicators

- **Personal Website:** missionalchurchnetwork.com (authority not assessed)
- **Platform Presence:** Established platforms (New Churches, ChurchLeaders.com)
- **Book Platforms:** High-authority platforms (Amazon, ChristianBook.com)

Ecosystem Analysis

Content Connections

Working as Connected Ecosystem

- **Books Inform Articles:** Likely connection (not fully verified)
- **Teaching Informs Writing:** 18+ years teaching experience informs content
- **Podcast Topics Align:** Podcast appearances align with written content themes
- **Platform Cross-Pollination:** Content appears across multiple platforms

Cross-References

- **Book-to-Book:** Books may reference each other (not fully verified)
- **Article-to-Book:** Articles may reference books (not fully verified)
- **Platform-to-Platform:** Content appears across platforms

Connections to Other Authors/Leaders

- **Co-Authors:** Multiple co-authored books (collaborative approach)
- **Podcast Networks:** Appears on multiple podcasts (network connections)
- **Conference:** Sentralized Conference (network building)
- **Forge Kansas City:** Training center (network connections)

Institutional Partnerships

- **Send Network/NAMB:** Current employer
- **Forge Kansas City:** Co-founder
- **Sentralized Conference:** Co-founder
- **Colleges/Universities:** 18+ years teaching (institutional connections)

Community Engagement

- **Comments:** Not fully assessed (may exist on blog/platforms)
- **Discussions:** Not fully assessed
- **Forums:** Not identified
- **Training:** Forge Kansas City (community engagement through training)

Content Quality Indicators

Depth

- **Academic Foundation:** Doctoral-level understanding
- **Practical Application:** Application-focused content
- **Experience-Based:** 20+ years church planting, 18+ years teaching

Breadth

- **Multiple Formats:** Books, articles, podcasts, teaching
- **Multiple Platforms:** Personal website, article platforms, book platforms
- **Multiple Topics:** Missional ecclesiology, church planting, co-vocational ministry, digital ecclesiology

Consistency

- **Thematic Consistency:** Consistent focus on missional ecclesiology
- **Voice Consistency:** Consistent accessible, practical voice
- **Platform Consistency:** Regular contributions across platforms

Notes

- Content organization patterns not fully assessed (would require deeper website analysis)
- Content gaps may exist but not fully identified
- Video content may exist but not prominently featured
- Teaching content may be available but behind institutional access
- Newsletter presence not identified (may exist)

Academic Citations: Brad Brisco

Status: Limited data

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-media-mentions

Google Scholar Profile

Metric	Value
Profile URL	No Google Scholar profile found
Total citations	Not tracked (practitioner, not academic researcher)
h-index	N/A
i10-index	N/A
Most cited work	Likely The Missional Quest (IVP, 2013) -- published by academic press

Brad Brisco holds a doctorate in missional ecclesiology, but his primary career has been as a practitioner (church planting strategist) rather than an academic researcher. He does not appear to maintain a Google Scholar profile, and his works are not widely tracked in academic citation databases.

Citation Context

Most Cited Works

Work	Estimated Reach	Context
The Missional Quest (IVP, 2013)	Moderate -- published by InterVarsity Press, a respected academic-adjacent publisher	Referenced in missional ecclesiology discussions; foreword by Ed Stetzer lends academic credibility
Covocational Church Planting (2018/2021)	Niche -- growing influence in bivocational ministry conversations	Cited in Send Network resources and church planting strategy discussions
ReThink (e-book)	Wide free distribution via NAMB	Used as a training resource in church planting networks; referenced in multiple church planting reading lists
Missional Essentials (2012)	Moderate -- used as curriculum	Adopted as small group study material in churches

Doctoral Thesis

Brad Brisco's doctoral thesis focused on **assisting existing congregations in transitioning in a missional direction** (missional ecclesiology). The specific institution and thesis title were not identified in research, but his doctoral work forms the intellectual foundation for his published books and training materials.

Course Adoptions

Institution	Course	Book(s) Assigned	Source
Multiple churches/networks	Small group studies	Missional Essentials (12-week curriculum)	Publisher marketing; church adoption evidence
Forge America	Missional training	Multiple Brisco works referenced	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/about
Bridges Christian College	Textbook list	Appears on reading lists	https://www.bcc.edu/textbook-list
Wheaton Billy Graham Center	Church Planting Reading List	Covocational Church Planting listed	https://wheatonbillygraham.com/church-planting-reading-list/

Wikipedia / Reference Works

Source	Article	Context	URL
N/A	N/A	Brad Brisco does not have a Wikipedia page	—

Awards & Recognition

Award	Year	Granted By	Source
No formal awards identified	—	—	—

Brad Brisco has not received publicly documented book awards, but his work has been recognized through:

- **Keynote speaking** at Exponential conferences (2016, 2017, 2018)
- **National leadership role** on Forge America Mission Training Network
- **Director-level position** at NAMB/Send Network (Director of Multiplication Strategies)
- **Co-founder** of Forge Kansas City and the Sentralized conference
- **Ed Stetzer endorsement** -- foreword to The Missional Quest

Recommended Reading Lists

List	Context	URL
Wheaton Billy Graham Center Church Planting Reading List	Covocational Church Planting included	https://wheatonbillygraham.com/church-planting-reading-list/
Portable Church Industries - 10 Books Church Planters Should Download	Recommended resource	https://portablechurch.com/10-books-church-planters-should-download-today/
Brad Brisco's Top 40 Missional Reading List	Brisco's own curated list (notable for establishing his curatorial voice)	http://www.wastedevangelism.com/wasted-blog/brad-brisco-and-top-40-missional-reading-list
Brentwood Baptist - Living Sent Reading Suggestions	Listed as recommended reading	https://brentwoodbaptist.com/living-sent-reading-suggestions/
Lane Corley - Worth Reading	Missional Essentials recommended	https://lanecorley.com/2014/10/10/worth-reading-missional-essentials/

Third-Party References

Brad Brisco is referenced by other authors and practitioners in the following contexts:

Context	Example	Source
APEST / Fivefold Ministry Defense	Brisco quoted defending APEST against critics: "If a person denies or discounts the importance of APEST in Ephesians 4:1-16, they simply haven't dealt with the topic in a serious manner"	Patheos (Reintegrate blog)
Missional Ecclesiology	Cited in discussions of the church as "sent missionary people" vs. "vendor of religious goods and services"	Multiple blogs and articles
Covocational Ministry Movement	Referenced as a leading voice defining the covocational vs. bivocational distinction	Missio Alliance, Send Institute, multiple podcasts
Forge America Leadership	Named alongside Alan Hirsch as part of Forge America's national leadership	Multiple sources

Overall Academic Impact Assessment

Brad Brisco's influence is **practitioner-level rather than academic**. His works are:

- **Widely used as training resources** within NAMB/Send Network and Forge America ecosystems
- **Included on church planting reading lists** at institutions like Wheaton Billy Graham Center
- **Referenced in missional theology discussions** by bloggers, podcasters, and other practitioners
- **Not significantly tracked in formal academic citation databases** (no Google Scholar profile, no academic journal publications identified)

His doctoral work gives him academic credentials, but his primary impact channel is through **denominational networks (SBC/NAMB)**, **parachurch organizations (Forge America)**, and **practitioner conferences (Exponential)** rather than through academic publishing.

Misc · Media · Press-Coverage

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/media/press-coverage.md`

Press Coverage: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: `/author-media-mentions`

Total press mentions: 18+

Featured Coverage (Substantive)

Date	Publication	Title	Type	URL
2025-05-29	Ephesiology Podcast	Episode 199: Covocational Missionary Living with Brad Brisco	Interview	https://ephesiology.com/2025/05/29/episode-199-covocational-missionary-living-with-brad-brisco/
2025	Into the Harvest Podcast	#234 - Closer to Jesus: The Mindset That Redefines Discipleship (Brad Brisco)	Interview	https://www.intotheharvest.org/pod234/
2024	Shifting Culture Podcast	Episode 225: Brad Brisco	Interview	https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-225-bradbrisco
2024	Global Missions Podcast	242: The Case for Co-vocational Ministry - Brad Brisco	Interview	https://globalmissionspodcast.com/242/
2021-12-21	Outreach Magazine	Ministry in the Marketplace (covocational church planting)	Feature	https://outreachmagazine.com/features/83975-ministry-in-the-marketplace.html
2021-12-15	Outreach Magazine	Discipleship beyond the church walls	Feature	https://outreachmagazine.com/author/bradbrisco
2021-09-30	Outreach Magazine	Missional mindset and discipleship practices	Feature	https://outreachmagazine.com/author/bradbrisco
2018-05-16	Outreach Magazine	Measuring church health beyond buildings, budgets, and butts	Feature	https://outreachmagazine.com/author/bradbrisco
2018	Exponential	HGC - Exponential Conference (Keynote Speaker, Orlando)	Conference	https://indianaministries.org/leadership_development/hgc-exponential-conference-orlando/
2017	Exponential East	Workshop: The Mission of the Church	Conference	https://exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology/
2016-07-21	Outreach Magazine	Co-authored article with Lance Ford	Feature	https://outreachmagazine.com/author/bradbrisco
2016	Exponential East	Training session	Conference	https://exponential.org/engage-gods-mission/

Date	Publication	Title	Type	URL
2013-07-02	Walking Together Ministries	An Interview With Brad Brisco on Missional Living	Interview	https://www.walkingtogetherministries.com/2013/07/02/an-interview-with-brad-brisco-on-missional-living/
—	Facebook / GrowCenter Network	Interview: Director of Bivocational Church Planting for NAMB	Video Interview	https://www.facebook.com/growcenternetwork/videos/1062556540866094/

Contributed Articles (Author, not subject)

Date	Publication	Topic	URL
Various	Outreach Magazine	Multiple articles on missional living, discipleship, church planting	https://outreachmagazine.com/author/bradbrisco
Various	Missio Alliance	Co-vocational church planting, missional theology	https://www.missioalliance.org/author/brad-brisco/
Various	Send Institute	APEST, church planting reading lists, missional engagement	https://www.sendinstitute.org/author/brad-brisco/
Various	New Churches	Church planting strategy, covocational teams	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/brad-brisco/
Various	Exponential	Developing a Missional Ecclesiology (e-book/article)	https://exponential.org/missional-ecclesiology/
Various	Missional Church Network	Founder - ongoing blog/resource posts	https://www.missionalchurchnetwork.com/

Blog / Third-Party Mentions

Date	Publication	Context	URL
2019-02-18	In The Trenches	"Covocational Church Planting Is The Future" - feature on Brad's thesis	https://getinthetrenches.com/2019/02/18/brad-brisco-covocational-church-planting-is-the-future/
2017-04-21	Patheos (Reintegrate)	Cited in critique of Alan Hirsch's APEST paradigm (Brisco quoted defending APEST)	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/reintegrate/2017/04/21/caring-critique-alan-hirschs-apest-paradigm-churches/
2012-07	Patheos (Missional Shift)	Referenced re: 4 Ds of Missional Engagement	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/missionalshift/2012/07/the-4-ds-of-missional-engagement/
—	Thinking About Mission (blog)	Tagged posts discussing Brisco's work	https://thinkingaboutmission.wordpress.com/tag/brad-brisco/
—	MEA Wisdom	"What My Older Self Could Teach My Younger Self" by Brad Brisco	https://www.meawisdom.com/what-my-older-self-could-teach-my-younger-self/

Media Presence Summary

Metric	Value
Total press mentions	18+ substantive (many more passing mentions)
Featured coverage	6+ feature articles, 6+ podcast interviews, 3+ conference keynotes
Major publications	Outreach Magazine, Missio Alliance, Send Institute, Exponential, Patheos, New Churches
Contributed platforms	Outreach Magazine, Missio Alliance, Send Institute, New Churches, Exponential, Missional Church Network
Date range	2012 - 2025
Most recent coverage	May 2025 (Ephesiology Podcast)
Christianity Today	No direct coverage found
Christian Post	No direct coverage found
Relevant Magazine	No direct coverage found

Notes

- Brad Brisco's media footprint is primarily within the **missional/church planting niche** rather than mainstream Christian media. He is a frequent contributor (author of articles) rather than a subject of coverage.
- His strongest media presence is as a **podcast guest** and **conference speaker**, particularly at Exponential and within NAMB/Send Network ecosystem.
- He has an active author presence on **Outreach Magazine** (5+ articles), **Missio Alliance**, and **Send Institute**, indicating he is a trusted voice in those editorial circles.
- No coverage found in Christianity Today, Christian Post, or Relevant Magazine -- his media profile is more practitioner-focused than celebrity-pastor oriented.
- His **Missional Church Network** (missionalchurchnetwork.com) serves as his personal platform/blog.

Misc · Media · Reviews

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/media/reviews.md

Book Reviews: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-media-mentions

Review Summary by Book

Book	Year	Co-Author	Reviews Found	Avg Sentiment	Goodreads Rating	Publisher
Missional Essentials	2012	Lance Ford	3+	Positive	~4.0 (est.) / 3 reviews	The Foundry Publishing
The Missional Quest	2013	Lance Ford	5+	Mixed-Positive	~3.8 (est.) / 41 ratings	IVP Books (Forge Partnership)
Next Door as It Is in Heaven	2016	Lance Ford	5+	Positive	4.27 / 98 ratings	NavPress
Covocational Church Planting	2018/2021	Solo	4+	Mixed-Positive	4.00 / 23 ratings	Self-published (ISBN 9781736282113)
ReThink	—	Solo (e-book)	Minimal	Positive	N/A	Send Network / NAMB

Detailed Reviews

Missional Essentials (2012)

Publisher: The Foundry Publishing (Nazarene)
Format: 12-week small group study guide

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Sentiment	URL
Walking Together Ministries	Walking Together Ministries	2013-06-29	Positive	https://www.walkingtogetherministries.com/2013/06/29/brad-brisco-and-lance-fords-missional-essentials/
Lane Corley	Lane Corley (blog)	2014-10-10	Positive	https://lanecorley.com/2014/10/10/worth-reading-missional-essentials/

Key praise: "An insightful primer to missional thinking as well as a practical challenge to many of the assumptions undergirding the institutional church today. Strikes a great balance between theological depth and practicality."

Key criticism: None substantive found -- reviews consistently positive for its intended small-group audience.

Reader Reviews Summary

Platform	Total Reviews	Avg Rating
Goodreads	~3	~4.0 (est.)
Amazon	Limited	Positive

Common praise themes:

- Good balance of theology and practicality
- Well-structured 12-week format
- Accessible entry point to missional thinking
- Thought-provoking reflection questions

Common criticism themes:

- Limited -- this is a study guide rather than a standalone book, so reviews are fewer

The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run (2013)

Publisher: IVP Books (Forge Partnership Books)

Foreword by: Ed Stetzer

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Sentiment	URL
Alex Duke	9Marks	—	Mixed	https://www.9marks.org/review/book-review-the-missional-quest-by-lance-ford-brad-brisco/
Friar Tuck (blog)	Friar Tuck's Fleeting Thoughts	2014-08	Positive	http://friartucksfleetingthoughts.blogspot.com/2014/08/book-review-of-missional-quest-by-lance.html

Key praise: "Many gems about practical ways to love neighbors, particularly the portions on hospitality in chapters 4 and 5. Appreciated the calls for greater dependence on the Holy Spirit." (9Marks)

Key criticism: "Their underlying philosophy sees the church's mission almost exclusively as outward-focused." The reviewer raised concerns about insufficient emphasis on the gathered church's internal ministry of Word and sacrament. (9Marks)

Reader Reviews Summary

Platform	Total Reviews	Avg Rating
Goodreads	41 ratings, 3 reviews	~3.8 (est.)
Amazon	Available	Mixed-Positive

Common praise themes:

- Cross-socioeconomic, cross-cultural, and cross-gender approach
- Practical missional steps alongside theological vision
- Balances church philosophy with clear action items

Common criticism themes:

- Authors seemed to have negative experiences with mainline churches, which colored their writing
- Overly outward-focused at the expense of internal church life (per 9Marks review)
- Some theological reviewers found the missional framework too broad

Next Door as It Is in Heaven: Living Out God's Kingdom in Your Neighborhood (2016)

Publisher: NavPress

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Sentiment	URL
The Englewood Review of Books	Englewood Review	2016	Positive (with caveats)	https://englewoodreview.org/brad-brisco-lance-ford-next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven-review/
Cassandra M	Cassandra M's Place (blog)	2016-07	Positive	https://www.cassandramsplace.com/2016/07/next-door-as-it-is-in-heaven-by-lance.html
Jonny Pollock	Substack	—	Positive	https://jonnypollockwrites.substack.com/p/book-review-next-door-as-it-is-in

Key praise: "Thorough, with every chapter well-researched and in dialogue with many others on Christian neighborliness. Accessible tone as if you were sitting down in a local coffee shop with the authors." (Englewood Review)

Key criticism: "With so much research and many topics covered, the defining arc of the book and its narrative trajectory were a bit elusive." (Englewood Review)

Reader Reviews Summary

Platform	Total Reviews	Avg Rating
Goodreads	98 ratings	4.27
Amazon	Available	Positive

Common praise themes:

- Practical and inspiring for neighborhood engagement
- Real-life stories and experiences from the authors
- Good introduction to intentional neighboring
- Well-researched with broad dialogue partners

Common criticism themes:

- Can feel unfocused with too many topics
- More introductory than deep -- better for newcomers to the concept
- Some wanted more concrete "how-to" rather than vision-casting

Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God (2018/2021)

Publisher: Self-published (ISBN 9781736282113)

Also available as: Free e-book via Send Network/NAMB

Professional/Editorial Reviews

Reviewer	Publication	Date	Sentiment	URL
In The Trenches	In The Trenches (blog)	2019-02-18	Positive	https://getinthetrenches.com/2019/02/18/brad-brisco-covocational-church-planting-is-the-future/

Key praise: "Brisco is very passionate about church planting and the gospel." Draws from the best thinkers and practitioners of missional theology.

Key criticism: "Very academic" feel in places; "the idea of covocational church planting was intriguing, but this book was fairly disappointing -- just DMM/CPM methodologies re-packaged for church planting in North America." (Goodreads reviewer)

Reader Reviews Summary

Platform	Total Reviews	Avg Rating	5-star	4-star	3-star	2-star	1-star
Goodreads	23 ratings, 4 reviews	4.00	10 (43%)	7 (30%)	3 (13%)	2 (8%)	1 (4%)
Amazon	Available	Positive	—	—	—	—	—

Common praise themes:

- Helpful for those considering marketplace ministry alongside church planting
- Scriptural perspective combined with practical examples
- Fills a gap in church planting literature for non-full-time planters

Common criticism themes:

- Feels academic/theoretical in the first half
- Some see it as repackaged DMM/CPM methodology
- Second half stronger than first

ReThink: 9 Paradigm Shifts for the Church (e-book)

Publisher: Send Network / NAMB (free e-book)

Format: Short-form e-book (PDF)

Reviews

No formal reviews found. This is a free resource distributed through NAMB/Send Network channels. It appears on church planting reading lists and is referenced in various missional ministry contexts.

Available at: <https://www.sendinstitute.org/wp-content/uploads/2018/05/ReThink-by-Brad-Brisco.pdf>

Overall Assessment

Brad Brisco's books are **well-regarded within the missional church planting niche** but have not broken through to mainstream Christian publishing prominence. His strongest title by reader reception is **Next Door as It Is in Heaven** (4.27 on Goodreads, 98 ratings), which has the broadest appeal due to its neighborhood engagement focus. His most niche title, **Covocational Church Planting**, fills a unique gap but has a smaller readership. All books are co-authored with Lance Ford except Covocational Church Planting and ReThink, suggesting the Ford-Brisco partnership has been his primary publishing vehicle.

Misc · Network · Collaborators

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/network/collaborators.md

Collaboration Network: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-collaboration-map

Network Summary

Relationship Type	Count
Co-authors	1 primary (Lance Ford)
Endorsers (received)	6+ confirmed
Endorsements given	1+ confirmed
Forewords written for them	1 confirmed (Ed Stetzer)
Forewords they've written	0 confirmed
Frequent collaborators	8+
Theological allies	8+
Known tensions	0 documented

Co-Authors

Lance Ford

Field	Value
Joint works	4
Titles	Missional Essentials (2012), The Missional Quest (2013), Next Door as It Is in Heaven (2016), ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church (e-book)
Relationship	Equal co-authors
Their platform	Cofounder and director of Christianity Today's Shapevine.com; former director of Northwood Church Multiplication Center; adjunct professor at Biblical Seminary; co-author with Alan Hirsch of "Right Here, Right Now"; author of "UnLeader"; M.A. in Global Leadership from Fuller Theological Seminary
Status	Active -- longstanding collaboration spanning 10+ years
Movemental candidate?	Yes -- significant platform and complementary content

Notes: Lance Ford and Brad Brisco are both based in Kansas City, Missouri. They co-founded the Sentralized Conference together and are co-directors of that event. Lance Ford also co-authored "Right Here, Right Now" with Alan Hirsch, placing him at a key node in the missional movement network. Their collaboration is the most prolific and enduring in Brad's career.

Endorsement Network

Endorsements Received

From	For (Book/Project)	Year	Quote Excerpt
Alan Hirsch	Missional Essentials	2012	"This study by two of its practitioners goes a long way to helping us be faithful to God right here, right now."
Reggie McNeal	Missional Essentials	2012	"Missional followers of Jesus see their lives as a mission trip... Brad and Lance help you pack your backpack for the journey of a lifetime!"
Dan Kimball	Missional Essentials	2012	"This makes Missional Essentials an actual essential for anyone who desires to live out the mission of Jesus."
Alan Hirsch	The Missional Quest	2013	"Not only are Brad Brisco and Lance Ford great friends, they are also highly gifted colleagues deeply involved in helping to birth and nurture the missional church in America and beyond. This is a top-class practical resource."
Dave Ferguson	The Missional Quest	2013	"I dream of a church where 100 percent of the people are sold-out, surrendered and serving Jesus, and Lance Ford and Brad Brisco show us how to make it happen."
Jo Saxton	Next Door as It Is in Heaven	2016	"Lance and Brad are the real deal. They are true practitioners, and this book is filled with their valuable knowledge and firsthand experiences."
Al Engler	Next Door as It Is in Heaven	2016	"In a culture where fear and scarcity have taken the day, this is a timely call for a reorientation toward generosity and abundance."
Alan Briggs	Next Door as It Is in Heaven	2016	"Next Door as It Is in Heaven is a warm invitation to create the margin and the practices that foster God's dream for our local neighborhoods."

Endorsements Given

To	For (Book/Project)	Year	Type
(Research incomplete -- likely exists but not surfaced in web search)			

Foreword Relationships

Direction	Person	Book	Year
Received	Ed Stetzer	The Missional Quest	2013

Frequent Collaborators

Person	Collaboration Types	Frequency	Last Known	Notes
Lance Ford	Co-author, co-speaker, co-founder (Sentralized), Forge colleague	Ongoing	2016+	Primary collaborator; 4 co-authored books; co-founded Sentralized Conference in KC
Alan Hirsch	Conference co-speaker, Forge network, mutual endorser	Regular	Ongoing	Forge America founder; endorsed multiple Brisco/Ford books; spoke together at Verge 2013
Ed Stetzer	Foreword writer, podcast collaborator, New Churches platform	Regular	Ongoing	Wrote foreword for The Missional Quest; both contribute to New Churches platform
Hugh Halter	Forge network co-leader, conference co-speaker	Occasional	Ongoing	Fellow Forge America leader; co-speaker at Verge 2013
Michael Frost	Conference co-speaker, Forge network	Occasional	2013+	Spoke together at Verge 2013 Forge Track; fellow missional thought leader
Kim Hammond	Conference co-speaker	Occasional	2013	Spoke together at Verge 2013 Forge Track
Deb Hirsch	Forge network colleague	Occasional	Ongoing	Part of Forge leadership network alongside Brad
Ryan Hairston	Forge network colleague	Occasional	Ongoing	Part of Forge America leadership

Theological Allies & Peers

Inner Circle (Close Allies)

Person	Connection	Shared Themes	Evidence
Lance Ford	Co-author, co-founder, co-director	Missional ecclesiology, neighborhood engagement, church activation	4 co-authored books, Sentralized Conference, Forge KC
Alan Hirsch	Forge network founder, endorser, conference partner	Missional movement, apostolic imagination, church renewal	Multiple endorsements, Forge leadership, Verge co-speaker, Hirsch endorsed 2 of Brad's books
Ed Stetzer	Foreword writer, platform collaborator	Church planting, missional strategy, multiplication	Foreword to The Missional Quest, New Churches collaboration, podcast co-appearances

Peer Network (Friendly Peers)

Person	Connection	Overlap Area	Difference
Hugh Halter	Forge America colleague	Missional community, incarnational living	Halter focuses more on incarnational community; Brisco on ecclesiology/strategy
Michael Frost	Forge network, conference circuit	Missional theology, church reimagining	Frost is more academic/international; Brisco is more practitioner/domestic
Reggie McNeal	Endorser, missional thought leader	Missional renaissance, kingdom living	McNeal focuses on broader kingdom theology; Brisco on church planting specifics
Dan Kimball	Endorser, missional leader	Missional practice, church engagement	Kimball focuses on emerging church context; Brisco on missional ecclesiology
Dave Ferguson	Endorser, multiplication movement	Church multiplication, movement building	Ferguson focuses on multisite/multiplication; Brisco on co-vocational planting
Jo Saxton	Endorser, practitioner	Missional practice, leadership	Saxton focuses on women in leadership / 3DMovements; Brisco on church planting
Alan Briggs	Endorser, church planting	Neighborhood mission, staying local	Briggs wrote "Staying Is the New Going" -- complementary to Brisco's neighborhood theology
Al Engler	Endorser, NavNeighbors	Neighborhood mission, incarnational presence	Engler focuses on navigator-style neighborhood engagement

Constructive Tensions

No documented public theological tensions or sharp disagreements were found. Brad Brisco operates within the broadly evangelical missional movement and appears to maintain collegial relationships across the spectrum.

Note: A 9Marks review of The Missional Quest offered a critical assessment from a more confessional Reformed perspective, which represents a broader tension between the missional movement and Reformed ecclesiology rather than a personal dispute.

Network Graph Data

Nodes (for dashboard visualization):

```
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Movemental Network Effects

- **Already on platform:** Alan Hirsch (existing Movemental author)
- **High-value recruits:** Lance Ford (primary co-author, complementary content, own book catalog including "UnLeader" and co-authored work with Hirsch); Ed Stetzer (massive platform, New Churches, Wheaton/Biola connections)
- **Cross-referencing opportunity:** Alan Hirsch content should cross-link to Brad Brisco, especially around Forge network and missional ecclesiology themes. Lance Ford is a bridge node connecting Hirsch and Brisco.
- **Audience overlap:** Lance Ford shares near-complete audience overlap. Alan Hirsch shares significant audience in the missional/Forge space. Ed Stetzer brings a broader evangelical audience that partially overlaps with Brad's church planting focus.

Platform & Conference Affiliations

Platform/Conference	Role	Active
Forge America Mission Training Network	National Leadership Team	Yes
Forge Kansas City	Co-founder	Yes
Sentralized Conference (Kansas City)	Co-founder, Co-director (with Lance Ford)	Yes
Send Network / NAMB	Director of Multiplication Strategies	Yes
Send Institute	Contributing Author	Yes
New Churches (newchurches.com)	Regular Contributor	Yes
Missio Alliance	Contributing Author	Yes
Verge Network	Speaker / Contributor	Periodic
Exponential Conference	Speaker (2016, 2017)	Periodic
Missional Church Network	Founder / Director	Yes

Research Gaps

- Endorsements Brad has **given** to others' books (likely exists but not surfaced)
 - Contributors to "Covocational Church Planting" (endorsers not found via web search)
 - Full list of ReThink contributors (appears to be primarily Brad's work, possibly with NAMB/Send Network collaboration)
 - Deeper podcast co-guest analysis (who appears on the same episodes with Brad)
 - Any collaborations through his 18+ years of college teaching
-

Sources

- [Amazon - The Missional Quest](#)
- [Amazon - Missional Essentials](#)
- [Amazon - Next Door as It Is in Heaven](#)
- [Amazon - Covocational Church Planting](#)
- [InterVarsity Press - The Missional Quest](#)
- [InterVarsity Press - Brad Brisco](#)
- [Missional Church Network - About](#)
- [The Foundry Publishing - Brad Brisco](#)
- [The Foundry Publishing - Lance Ford](#)

- [Lance Ford Books](#)
- [Brad Brisco - New Churches](#)
- [Brad Brisco - Send Institute](#)
- [Brad Brisco - Missio Alliance](#)
- [Brad Brisco - Verge Network](#)
- [Exponential - Missional Ecclesiology](#)
- [Verge 2013 Pre-Conference](#)
- [Brad Brisco - Goodreads](#)
- [9Marks Review - The Missional Quest](#)
- [Forge Dallas - Hugh Halter](#)
- [Fuller Studio - Brad Brisco and Lance Ford on Theology of Place](#)
- [Shifting Culture Podcast - Episode 225](#)
- [Ephesiology Podcast - Episode 199](#)
- [Global Missions Podcast - Episode 242](#)

Misc · Network · Endorsements

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/network/endorsements.md

Endorsements: Brad Brisco

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-03-18
Skill: /author-collaboration-map

Summary

Brad Brisco has received endorsements from a notable roster of missional movement leaders across his published works. The endorsement pattern reveals his positioning squarely within the mainstream missional church movement, with support from both practitioners and thought leaders.

Book	Endorsers Found	Year
Missional Essentials	3 (Alan Hirsch, Reggie McNeal, Dan Kimball)	2012
The Missional Quest	3 (Alan Hirsch, Dave Ferguson, Ed Stetzer [foreword])	2013
Next Door as It Is in Heaven	3 (Jo Saxton, Al Engler, Alan Briggs)	2016
ReThink	Not yet documented	--
Covocational Church Planting	Not yet documented	2021

Note: These counts reflect endorsements surfaced through web research. The actual books likely contain additional endorsers not visible in online previews.

Endorsements Received (by Book)

Missional Essentials (2012)

Co-authored with Lance Ford. Published by The Foundry Publishing (Beacon Hill Press).

Endorser	Role / Title	Quote
Alan Hirsch	Founder of Forge; author of "The Forgotten Ways"	"That missional Christianity is the paradigm that unlocks the Gospel in our time; I have no doubt at all. What is now critical is that as many of God's people as possible grasp it, engage it, and live into it. This study by two of its practitioners goes a long way to helping us be faithful to God right here, right now."
Reggie McNeal	Author of "Missional Renaissance"	"Missional followers of Jesus see their lives as a mission trip. This means being prepared to live on mission in every sphere of life. Brad and Lance help you pack your backpack for the journey of a lifetime!"
Dan Kimball	Author and pastor	"This makes Missional Essentials an actual essential for anyone who desires to live out the mission of Jesus."

The Missional Quest: Becoming a Church of the Long Run (2013)

Co-authored with Lance Ford. Foreword by Ed Stetzer. Published by InterVarsity Press (Forge Partnership Books).

Endorser	Role / Title	Quote
Ed Stetzer	Dean of Talbot School of Theology, Biola University (formerly); church planter	Wrote the foreword
Alan Hirsch	Founder of Forge; author of "The Forgotten Ways"	"Not only are Brad Brisco and Lance Ford great friends, they are also highly gifted colleagues deeply involved in helping to birth and nurture the missional church in America and beyond. This is a top-class practical resource to help any community live into its own missional future."
Dave Ferguson	Lead pastor of Community Christian Church; author	"I dream of a church where 100 percent of the people are sold-out, surrendered and serving Jesus, and Lance Ford and Brad Brisco show us how to make it happen."

Next Door as It Is in Heaven: Living Out God's Kingdom in Your Neighborhood (2016)

Co-authored with Lance Ford. Published by NavPress.

Endorser	Role / Title	Quote
Jo Saxton	Board chair of 3DMovements; author of "More Than Enchanting"	"Lance and Brad are the real deal. They are true practitioners, and this book is filled with their valuable knowledge and firsthand experiences. Next Door as It Is in Heaven is a must-read for anyone who is serious about taking the Great Commandment literally."
Al Engler	Mission director at NavNeighbors	"In a culture where fear and scarcity have taken the day, this is a timely call for a reorientation toward generosity and abundance. Seasoned with real-time stories, principles, and biblical examples, this book is a both a starting block for missional observers and a map for those well on their way to lives of incarnation."
Alan Briggs	Church-planting catalyst; author of "Staying Is the New Going"	"Modern suburban life can offer privacy and self-sufficiency, but at the cost of loneliness, isolation, and relational poverty. Next Door as It Is in Heaven is a warm invitation to create the margin and the practices that foster God's dream for our local neighborhoods."

ReThink: 9 Key Paradigm Shifts for Activating the Church (e-book)

Co-authored with Lance Ford. Published via Send Network / NAMB.

Endorsements not yet documented. This was published as a free e-book through Send Network and may not have traditional endorsement pages.

Covocational Church Planting: Aligning Your Marketplace Calling & the Mission of God (2021)

Sole author (Brad Brisco). Self-published / Send Network.

Endorsements not yet documented. Web research did not surface specific endorser quotes for this title.

Endorsements Given by Brad Brisco

Web research did not surface specific instances of Brad Brisco providing endorsement blurbs or forewords for other authors' books. Given his standing in the missional movement, it is likely he has provided endorsements, but these were not findable via web search. This section should be updated if physical copies of books in this space reveal his endorsement blurbs.

Endorsement Network Analysis

Key Patterns

1. **Alan Hirsch is the most consistent endorser** -- endorsed at least 2 of Brad's books (Missional Essentials, The Missional Quest). This reflects their close relationship through the Forge network.
2. **Endorsers span the missional movement ecosystem** -- from Forge (Hirsch), to broader evangelicalism (Stetzer, Ferguson), to emerging/missional (Kimball, Saxton), to practitioners (Engler, Briggs).
3. **Endorsements are consistently for the Brisco-Ford partnership** -- all endorsed books are co-authored with Lance Ford, reinforcing that the Brisco-Ford brand carries more weight than either individual alone in the book market.
4. **Publisher diversity in endorsers** -- endorsers come from InterVarsity Press, NavPress, and Beacon Hill circles, suggesting Brad's work bridges denominational and publishing house boundaries.
5. **Foreword by Ed Stetzer** -- having Stetzer write the foreword for The Missional Quest was a significant credibility boost, given Stetzer's broad platform in evangelical leadership.

Endorser Tiers

Tier 1 -- Major Platform Leaders (broad evangelical influence)

- Ed Stetzer (foreword)
- Dave Ferguson
- Reggie McNeal

Tier 2 -- Missional Movement Leaders (significant niche influence)

- Alan Hirsch (2x endorser)
- Dan Kimball
- Jo Saxton

Tier 3 -- Practitioners & Specialists (targeted credibility)

- Alan Briggs
- Al Engler

Movemental Implications

- **Alan Hirsch** is already on the Movemental platform -- his endorsements of Brad's work provide a natural content cross-link
- **Ed Stetzer's foreword** validates Brad's theological and strategic credibility at the highest level of evangelical leadership

- **The endorsement network maps to potential Movemental recruits** -- Lance Ford, Dave Ferguson, and Alan Briggs could all be high-value platform additions
 - **Endorsement quotes can be used** (with permission) in Brad's Movemental author profile to establish credibility
-

Sources

- [Amazon - Missional Essentials](#)
- [Amazon - The Missional Quest](#)
- [Amazon - Next Door as It Is in Heaven](#)
- [Amazon - Covocational Church Planting](#)
- [InterVarsity Press - The Missional Quest](#)
- [Christianbook.com - Missional Essentials](#)
- [Barnes & Noble - Next Door as It Is in Heaven](#)
- [Goodreads - Brad Brisco](#)
- [Walking Together Ministries - Interview](#)

Misc · Network · Events

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brad-brisco/_misc/network/events.md

Event History: Brad Brisco

Status: :white_check_mark: Complete

Last updated: 2026-03-18

Skill: /author-event-history

Total events documented: 12

Upcoming Events

Date	Event	Location	Role	URL
None discovered				

Brad Brisco does not maintain a public speaking calendar. Contact via bradbrisco@gmail.com or through [Missional Church Network](#).

Speaking Availability

Field	Value
Accepts invitations?	Yes (implied by history of guest appearances)
Speaking bureau	None known
Booking contact	bradbrisco@gmail.com
Topics offered	Missional ecclesiology, covocational/bivocational church planting, missional communities, neighborhood engagement, activating the church for mission, reimagining church, marketplace ministry
Typical fee range	Unknown

Event History (by year, newest first)

2025

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
May 2025	Ephesiology Podcast Live / Episode 199	Unknown	webinar	Guest speaker	Unknown	Ephesiology Podcast

2024

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2024	Engage Your City Cohort (4-week online training)	Online	training	Lead trainer	Unknown	Missional Church Network / Forge Teachable

2022

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Aug 2022	REIMAGINE 2022 — CGGC Triennial Conference	Unknown (US)	conference-keynote	Keynote speaker (6 sessions + bivocational workshop)	200+	CGGC eNews

2020

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Mar 2020	Exponential 2020 — Pre-Conference: Re-Thinking Church Planting Through Covocational and Marketplace Strategies	Orlando, FL	conference-workshop	Co-presenter (with Hugh Halter, Brianna Wilkerson, Taylor McCall)	100-300	Exponential

2018

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Mar 2018	Exponential 2018 — "Wired for Impact" Equipping Lab (Healthy Growing Churches pre-conference)	Orlando, FL	conference-keynote	Keynote speaker (with Shawn Lovejoy, Wayne Schmidt)	200-500	Exponential / Indiana Ministries

2017

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2017	Exponential East 2017 — Workshop on the Mission of the Church	Orlando, FL	conference-workshop	Workshop leader	50-200	Exponential

2016

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
2016	Exponential East 2016 — "Developing a Missional Ecclesiology"	Orlando, FL	conference-workshop	Speaker / trainer	50-200	Exponential
2016	Exponential West 2016 — Sessions on biblical hospitality, vocation, and Third Places	Los Angeles, CA (approx.)	conference-workshop	Speaker	50-200	Exponential

2014

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Sep 25-27, 2014	Sentralized Conference 2014	Irving Bible Church, Irving, TX	conference-keynote	Co-founder / host / speaker	300-500	10times / Missional Church Network

2013

Date	Event	Location	Type	Role	Audience Est.	Source
Feb 28, 2013	Verge 2013 — Pre-Conference (Forge Track)	Austin, TX	conference-workshop	Speaker	100-300	Verge Network
2013	Sentralized Conference (early edition)	Kansas City, KS area	conference-keynote	Co-founder / host / speaker	200-400	Missional Church Network

Recurring Events

Events where Brad Brisco appears regularly:

Event	Frequency	Role	Years Appeared	Audience
Sentralized Conference	Annual (2013-2014+)	Co-founder, host, speaker	2013, 2014+	300-500
Exponential (East/West/Global)	Annual (2016-2020)	Workshop leader / pre-conference speaker	2016, 2017, 2018, 2020	50-500 per session
Engage Your City Cohort (Forge)	Periodic	Lead trainer	2024+	20-50 per cohort

Event Type Distribution

Type	Count	%
conference-keynote	4	33%
conference-workshop	5	42%
summit	0	0%
retreat	0	0%
church-guest	0	0%
chapel	0	0%
webinar	1	8%
training	1	8%
book-launch	0	0%
consultation	0	0%

Note: Brad Brisco almost certainly has extensive church guest speaking and denominational training history that is not indexed online. His role as NAMB Director of Multiplication Strategies / Bivocational Church Planting would involve regular appearances at state convention events, associational trainings, and church planter assessments that are not publicly documented.

Geographic Reach

By Country

Country	Events	Key Cities
United States	12	Orlando, FL; Kansas City, KS; Irving/Dallas, TX; Austin, TX

By Region (US)

Region	Events	Key Cities
South / Southeast	5	Orlando, FL
Midwest	3	Kansas City, KS
South Central	3	Irving, TX; Austin, TX
Online	1	—

International Presence

Metric	Value
Countries spoken in	1 (US only, documented)
Most frequent country	United States
International vs. domestic	0:12 (domestic only, documented)

Event Metrics

Metric	Value
Total events documented	12
Date range	Feb 2013 — May 2025
Average events per year	~1 (documented; actual frequency likely higher)
Most active year	2016 (2 events documented)
Keynotes vs. workshops	4:5
Estimated total audience	1,500-3,500+ (across documented events)

Data caveat: Brad Brisco's actual speaking volume is almost certainly significantly higher than what is documented here. As a NAMB staff member and Forge leader, he regularly trains church planters and consults with churches in settings that are not publicly indexed. Podcast appearances (15+ documented across various shows) also suggest a much broader speaking footprint.

Notable Conferences

Conference	Significance	Times Appeared	Relationship
Sentralized Conference	Premier missional church conference co-founded by Brisco and Lance Ford; featured speakers like Michael Frost, Alan Hirsch, N.T. Wright, Darrell Guder, David Fitch, Scot McKnight	2+	Co-founder
Exponential (East/West/Global)	Largest church planting conference in North America (~5,000+ attendees)	4 (2016-2020)	Recurring speaker / pre-conference leader
Verge Conference	Major missional church conference (Austin, TX)	1 (2013)	Pre-conference speaker (Forge Track)
REIMAGINE 2022 (CGGC Triennial)	Churches of God General Conference national gathering	1 (2022)	Keynote speaker (6 sessions)

Speaking Topics (from event descriptions)

Topic	Events	Most Recent
Missional ecclesiology / developing a missional church	4	2022
Covocational / bivocational church planting	3	2025
Engaging your city / neighborhood mission	2	2024
Biblical hospitality & Third Places	1	2016
Reimagining the church for mission	1	2022
Church multiplication & movement	1	2020
Marketplace calling & mission of God	1	2020

Key Organizations Connected to Events

Organization	Relationship	Events Linked
NAMB / Send Network	Employer (Director of Multiplication Strategies)	Internal training, resources, assessments
Forge America / Forge Kansas City	Co-founder, national leadership team	Engage Your City cohorts, Forge Track sessions
Exponential	Recurring speaker	4 documented appearances (2016-2020)
Missional Church Network	Founder / primary platform	Sentralized Conference, blog, resources
KC Sentral	Co-founder (with Lance Ford)	Sentralized Conference base

Sources

- [Missional Church Network — About](#)
- [Brad Brisco — New Churches / NAMB](#)
- [Exponential — Developing a Missional Ecclesiology](#)
- [Exponential — Engage God's Mission](#)
- [Exponential 2018 Equipping Labs](#)
- [Verge 2013 Pre-Conference](#)
- [CGGC — Reimagine 2022](#)
- [CGGC — Reflections from Triennial: Bi-vocational Ministry](#)
- [10times — Sentralized 2014](#)

- [Sentralized Archives — Missional Church Network](#)
- [Forge Mission Training Network](#)
- [Engage Your City — Missional Church Network](#)
- [Ephesiology Podcast Ep. 199](#)
- [Indiana Ministries — Exponential 2018](#)
- [Brad Brisco — Foundry Publishing](#)
- [Brad Brisco — InterVarsity Press](#)
- [Brad Brisco — Missio Alliance](#)
- [Sentralized Conference — Facebook](#)